



Lily

Devon Princeton

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A Shared Wife Tale

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AUTHOR'S NOTE

Warning: This story contains explicit content and is intended for adults only. All characters depicted are over the age of 18 and not related by blood. All sex is consensual.

Enjoy...

CHAPTER 1

The Beginning

Rollercoasters. I love everything about them. I love feeling the anticipation while you wait in line. I love the slow crescendo as you roll up the track to the peak, feeling gravity pull your back against the seat. I love falling faster and faster before bottoming out, only to be lifted again or hurled to one side or the other. I love the feeling of satisfaction mixed with the craving for more as you roll back to the platform. My favorite part by far, though—the one I love more than all the others—is that split second just as you edge over the crest before the fall. Time stops, and you're weightless. It's my drug—that singular moment when reality fades away and you look at the track below, knowing what is about to happen and that there is nothing you can do to stop it. You hold your breath and feel your stomach in your chest. To me, there was nothing better. I have literally given people money in line to let me trade places with them so I could ride in the front car to get the best fix. Sometimes I like it in the back, too. It's a different experience. Never in the middle. The middle is for amateurs. I'm a pro.

About once a month, except during the holidays, I made Will take me to an amusement park. There were a few good ones within a day's drive of our house. Three or four times a year, though, we had to fly to get my fix. Even our honeymoon trip to Europe was planned around touring that continent's best rollercoasters. We saw the Louvre, too, of course, but not until I'd dragged my new husband to every rollercoaster in a one-hundred-kilometer radius of Paris.

Will did not share my love of rollercoasters. I'd like to think he financed our trips and tolerated my addiction solely because he loved me. And to be fair, I'm sure he would have. He was a kind man and devoted husband. However, in exchange for him indulging me, he had his own

fetish that I catered to. On one particular June evening in Atlanta, that had involved me putting on a minidress and availing myself of the dance club down the street from our hotel while he lurked in the shadows, watching while I danced and flirted with another man.

"God, it was so hot when he put his hand on your ass," Will exhaled in my ear, pushing himself deeper inside of me.

"Did you like that?" I whispered.

He grunted. "Fuck yes."

I ran my fingers through his hair and pulled him closer for a kiss.

"Did you feel him?" Will panted. He was getting close.

"Yes," I whispered.

"You felt his cock?"

"Yes," I whispered. "I could feel it pressing against me."

We kissed again. Will moaned into my mouth.

"He was so hard for me," I teased. I knew exactly what Will wanted to hear, just like he knew all of my favorite things about every rollercoaster on two continents.

"Oh, fuck," Will grunted and then exhaled with one long moan. He pulled out, and I finished him with my hand. I had him well trained. We both hated condoms and agreed that pulling out was preferable. My birth control game was solid, but being a nurse, I knew it was not infallible. We planned on starting a family in a few years. But not yet. I felt bad, but I was militant about not letting Will come inside of me. He begged off and on for the first few years we were together but gave up after he finally realized he was going to have to wait until we were ready to have children to experience that particular splendor. His only consolation was that neither of my two previous boyfriends had, either. I was looking forward to it, too, but I was nowhere near as motivated by sex as Will – or most men, for that matter.

I wasn't able to orgasm from intercourse. I could get right to the edge, but never quite there. It was like getting so very close to the top of the roller coaster and getting stuck right before I could get my fix. For my own peace of mind, I quit trying. It wasn't Will. That poor man, bless him, had

tried everything. Neither of the two men I'd been with before him could make me come that way either. I knew other girls who were the same way. It wasn't a big deal to me. I loved having Will inside of me. It felt amazing. I loved the closeness. And I honestly didn't care anymore if I orgasmed with him that way or not. He always went down on me first. It was his way of guaranteeing that I was satisfied every time we were together. Sometimes, he even went down on me in random moments with no expectation of anything in return. "Random acts of cunnilingus," he called them. Shamefully, I couldn't say I returned the favor. Generally speaking, I tried not to take advantage of what people call "pretty privilege," but avoiding blowjobs was one of the perks I allowed myself.

"That was amazing," Will basked, settling on his back. "God, I love you."

I smiled, turning on my side, laying my head on his chest like I always did. We laid naked together, cuddling on the crisp white hotel sheets, catching our breath.

"I love you, too," I said, feeling as content as I ever had.

Will looked down at me. "You still think it's weird, don't you?"

"Not really," I shrugged. A little, harmless lie. "I don't even think about it anymore. It doesn't bother me, if that's what you mean. I like the dancing. You won't ever dance with me." I gave him a mischievous grin. "And if I'm being honest, which we always are..."

"...which we always are," Will echoed.

"...I don't hate the attention."

"Yeah, I bet you don't," he grinned. "But are you sure? I mean, even I think it's weird. Seriously, who gets off on watching their unbelievably beautiful wife flirt with other men?"

"Well...you do," I deadpanned with perfect comedic timing. When we finished laughing, I let the silence linger for a moment before prompting him for the story—the one that made it okay in my mind to flirt and dance so provocatively with men other than my husband. "Why do you think you like it so much?"

“You know why. I’ve told you already.”

“I know. I just like to hear it.”

Will took a deep breath. “Seriously? I feel stupid.”

I tickled his ribs. “It’s not stupid! It’s sweet! Now tell me!”.

Will’s expression turned serious. He always got a certain monk-like stare when he talked about it. “I’ve been in love with you my whole life, Lily. Since we were kids. You were so beautiful and so kind. But it was impossible. You were always with someone else. And even if you hadn’t been, you were who you were, and I was ...well...not an option.”

“Don’t say that,” I interrupted. I didn’t like hearing how he thought of himself when he was younger. It hurt my heart. No one should have to endure the things he did at such a young age.

“It’s okay. I was living in a different world from you. All I could do was watch you and wish that my life was different. Now, when I watch you dance with those other men, it brings that all back. All that craving. All those years of pining for you when you were with someone else. All that yearning. All that desire. It makes me absolutely crazy...in a good way. Because now I know that at the end of the night, you’re coming home with me. And that, my love, is the best feeling in the world.”

“I love you,” I whispered. My heart was full. Will’s monk-like stare was gone, replaced with blushing red cheeks. “Then again, maybe...” I tickled Will’s ribs again, “...you just think I’m really hot!”

“You are really hot!” Will teased back, flipping over on top of me.

“Is that why you married me? Because I’m so pretty?” I goaded.

Will got serious again. He shook his head and looked deep into my eyes. “You know damn well why I married you.”

I did know. And I knew that Will Bradford would love me long after my looks were gone. Of that I had no doubt. I was well aware that all of the boys and men that I had dated before him were really only interested in me for my looks. Who I was on the inside was a distant second. Will was different. And I was different with him. That’s why I married him.

The next morning, I woke up to my phone ringing. The bed was empty next to me. I heard the shower running. I knew Will would have let

me sleep longer. My schedule at the hospital didn't lend itself to early mornings. I looked at my phone. The caller ID said "Mom."

"Fuck," I sighed. I loved my mother, but she could be a bit much. And at six-thirty a.m., she could be a lot much. I answered the call to hear her having a coughing fit followed by a glug of what I knew was iced tea.

"Hi, Mom. Are you okay?"

"Are you at home, sweetheart?"

"No, Mom. I told you. We're in Atlanta this weekend."

"Oh, that's right. Is Will with you?"

"Yes," I answered, my tone dripping with irritation at the questions and the hour at which they were being asked.

"Sweetie, there's no good way to say it, so I'm just going to say it."

"Say what, Mom?"

"Your father died."

At first it didn't register. I had seen him exactly twice since I was seven years old. We didn't talk about him.

"What?"

"Your father died."

"Where was he?"

"Riverford."

"He was from there, right?"

"That's where his mama and daddy were from, yeah." I could hear the clinking of the ice in Mom's glass followed by the slosh of what surely was more iced tea. She didn't drink coffee. It was iced tea from sunup to sundown. Water was for washing.

"What happened?" I asked.

"They said it was his liver. All those years of drinking."

I sat up in the bed. I was blank. My mother's voice trailed off. My vision tunneled as I stared at the floor, noticing the pattern in the carpet for the first time.

“Lily, are you there?”

I jerked back into awareness and put the phone back to my ear.
“What?”

“Sweetheart, you’re the next of kin. They said you need to either claim the body or sign something turning him over to the state. Somebody told them that he had a daughter and that I was your mama. So, they called me when they couldn’t figure out how to get in touch with you.”

I sat motionless on the bed, saying nothing.

“Lily? Are you still there?”

“Yeah, Mom. Sorry. Who’s they?”

“The hospital in Riverton.”

“They have a hospital in Riverton?”

“Yeah. It’s small. And old.”

“Do you have a number?”

Mom read me the number and I wrote it down. “I’ll call on Monday.”

“Lily, are you okay?”

“Yeah. I’m okay. I guess I’m just surprised is all.”

“I know, baby. I was, too. I hadn’t seen the bastard in damn near twenty years. But he gave me you. That ain’t nothing.”

“I know, Mom. Listen, Will’s getting out of the shower. I need to go.”

“Okay, sweetheart. Call me when you know something, okay?”

“Okay, Mom. Bye. I love you.”

“I love you too, sweetheart.”

Will walked in, drying his hair with a towel, just in time to see me hang up the phone. “Good morning, babe. Who’s calling you at this hour?”

“Mom. My dad died.” My tone was far more detached than those words would have demanded from most people.

“Jesus, Lily. Are you okay?” Will sat down next to me and rubbed my back.

“Yeah. I’m fine.”

“When was the last time you saw him?”

“College. Right before we got together. He asked me for money,” I scoffed.

“I’m sorry, Lil’.” I could tell Will meant it. I think he felt sorrier than I did.

“I have to go claim the body or sign some stupid form.”

“Where?”

“Riverton.”

“That’s not too far. We can swing by there on the way home. We can get there before lunchtime if we hurry.”

“No,” I replied. “I’ll just call on Monday. I’m not gonna let this ruin our trip. We have rollercoasters to ride. And if you’re nice,” I smiled, “I’ll let you take me dancing again.”

“Are you sure?” The look on his face challenged my stoicism. I loved how much Will loved me. Sometimes, though, it was a pain.

“Of course, I’m sure. Let’s have fun. You work too hard. You need it.” I stood up and started getting on with the business of the day. “Are you done in the shower?”

“Yeah,” he replied. Despite my outward nonchalance, I could still see the concern on Will’s face. I ignored it.

“Let’s go early so it’s not so hot. And then I can take a nap this afternoon before we go out,” I said as I walked into the bathroom. Standing alone in the shower under the warm water, I felt an emptiness. It wasn’t new. It had always been there. Since I was a little girl. Hiding. Peeking its head out every now and then.

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Standing in line for the third time at the Goliath, I started feeling sick. I knew it wasn’t the ride. Rollercoasters never made me queasy. Will noticed and asked me if I was okay.

I dismissed it. "I'm fine. Just a little nauseous."

A bit ahead of us in line were a young couple with their daughter. She looked barely tall enough to ride. The mom and dad started bickering. From what I could hear, mom thought the ride would be too scary for their daughter, and dad was complaining that his wife was being too overprotective. I felt a huge wave of anxiety welling up inside me. I started to panic. Without saying a word, I stepped out of line and started walking away as fast as I could without actually running. Will chased after me.

"Lily, what's wrong?"

"I'm okay," I lied. "I thought I was going to throw up for a second. Maybe I drank more than I thought last night. Can we just go?"

"Sure," Will replied, sounding surprised. I had never asked to leave an amusement park early before.

He took my hand, and we made the long walk to the car. The walking helped. I'd only had one panic attack before, back in college, when I smoked pot for the first and only time. It was the worst feeling ever. As we made our way, a memory, long forgotten, started surfacing. I was at an amusement park with my father. I must have only been around six. He was arguing with an attendant about whether or not I was big enough for the ride. I could smell beer. He always smell like beer. I could feel the shame of being humiliated by my father screaming and cussing, making a fool of himself. I felt nauseous again. I barely managed to retain the contents of my stomach on the drive back to the hotel. Once there, I went straight to bed. Despite feeling much better after I woke up, Will doted on me like I was an invalid. Generally speaking, I liked attention but what I didn't like was being treated like I was fragile. My name is Lily, but I am anything but a delicate little flower.

"Are you sure you're okay?" Will asked again for n<sup>th</sup> time.

"Will, you're about to get on my damn nerves!" I snapped. "I'm fine. Now take me to dinner."

Will finally got the message. We went out to a very nice restaurant. We had nice restaurants at home, but we rarely went. For the most part, we were homebodies. When we were out of town, though, I liked to get dressed up. It was nice to pretend every now and then that we were actual grownups

instead of the small-town bumpkins we knew we really were. That night, I dressed in a stretchy, tight black dress that hugged my subtle curves and accentuated what cleavage I had. I wore my hair up, leaving a brown tendril to graze either side of my face, framing my doe eyes. Several people, men and women, glanced at me repeatedly during dinner. I had learned long ago to put people's stares in the background. Will loved it.

After dinner, Will took me to another dance club but only after asking me half a dozen more times if I felt up to it after feeling sick earlier. "I'm fine!" I finally barked at him. "I want to dance! You can watch or you can go back to the hotel by yourself and jerk off!"

As was our *modus operandi*, Will and I parted ways as soon as we entered the club. I headed straight for the bar. I usually couldn't see him, but I knew he was always watching. I paid for my first drink in the interest of expediency and sat alone, quietly seething about Will treating me like an invalid. It wasn't long before a few hopefuls made their approach. I usually shot down the first few offers. They were generally the cockiest, most aggressive, and most difficult to shake at the end of the night. They were exactly the kind of guys I had avoided in college. But that night, I was in a mood. Napping during the day always made me irritable to begin with, but Will's overattentiveness had edged me firmly into disagreeable territory. I accepted David and his wingman Peter's offer of another vodka cranberry. I smiled politely through the usual small talk. When I finished my drink, I declined David's invitation to dance, insisting on another drink first. I'd eaten like a bird and had a few glasses of wine at dinner, so by the time I finished a third vodka and cranberry at the club, I was feeling no pain. I excused myself to go to the bathroom, promising the guys that I would dance with them as soon as I returned. I spotted Will on my way to the ladies room. On my way back to the bar after using the restroom, I tucked my wadded-up panties into his back pocket, barely breaking stride as I passed by.

I grabbed David and Peter by their hands and pulled them to the dance floor. I danced between them. They kept a reasonable distance for the first song. It didn't take long into the second, however, for them to move closer. I started rolling my hips and subtly grinding on David behind me, while resting my hand on Peter's chest in front of me. I wasn't dancing with them as much as I was dancing *at* Will. I was still angry and out to test the

limits of just exactly how much flirting he cared to watch. Part of me wanted—had always wanted—him to charge the dance floor and stop me in the middle of indulging his fantasy. There was a balcony that looked out over the dance floor. I didn't look up to try and find him, but I knew he was there somewhere watching my every move.

David put his hands on my hips and pressed his crotch to my backside. I lowered my hands to Peter's waistline and ever so slightly tucked my fingers behind his belt. The three of us rolled our hips in time with the music. There was precious little space between us. David nuzzled my neck from behind. I tilted my head to one side, granting him access. I felt his lips plant one brief, soft kiss on my neck. It was nice. He seemed to know not to go too far too fast. He turned me to face him with my back to Peter. I reached back and put my hands behind Peter's head, my fingers petting his hair and the nape of his neck. Peter moved one hand to my hip and the other to my ribs, just below my breast. He nuzzled my neck and took his turn planting a kiss. I bent forward and tucked both hands just barely into the waistline of David's pants for balance as I blatantly pressed my ass against Peter's crotch and continued swaying with the music, stopping just shy of actually twerking. I imagined Will watching. Peter held my hips and pressed his crotch against me. I knew I would be soon telling my husband about feeling Peter's hard cock pressing against my backside.

David put his hands in his pockets. At first, I thought it was part of his dance. His real purpose, though, had been to adjust his erection. I felt his dick brush the fingertips of my hand as he moved it. Maybe David wasn't such a good judge of how far I was willing to go after all. I was there to taunt my husband, but I wasn't going to play with some random guy's dick in the middle of a club. I didn't protest, though. I simply straightened up and continued dancing with my back pressed to Peter's front. David stepped closer and sandwiched me between the two of them. I rested one hand on David's chest, the other close to his ass. Peter nuzzled my neck on one side and let his hands fall down to my hemline, his fingertips brushing the skin of my leg. David put his cheek to mine on the other side. Despite my distaste for club guys, I was getting turned on. David and Peter were both handsome and fit. Personalities aside, being pressed so closely between them wasn't exactly a hardship. I could feel Peter's breath on my neck and David's in my ear.

“You’re so beautiful,” David whispered.

I felt Peter kiss my neck, lingering a little longer than before. David kissed just below my ear. I exhaled into his. He slid his cheek back across mine and gently kissed my lips - one Mississippi - and then back to my ear. I could feel myself getting disoriented as I got more and more turned on. Peter ran his hand up my dress along the tops of my thighs. I knew he would be able to feel that I wasn’t wearing any panties. He worked his way inward until he embraced me from behind, one arm around my stomach, the other with his hand pressing upward into my breast. David took my hands and brought them to the middle of his belt. I tucked my fingers in. I could feel the tip of his cock between my index fingers inside his pants as my thumbs pressed into his bulge from outside. He lifted my chin and kissed me again. One Mississippi. We continued like that for a few moments, Peter holding me close and David with his hands in his pockets, teasing his cock with my fingertips. In my mind, I blamed the booze as I rested my head back on Peter’s shoulder. He took it as an invitation to kiss my neck again. And then again. It felt nice. I hazily opened my eyes and looked up to the balcony. I wasn’t looking for him, but almost immediately saw my Will looking down at us, watching Peter kiss my neck while I made circles with my thumb along the underside of David’s cock through his pants. The look on his face hit me like a splash of ice-cold water.

“I have to go,” I blurted out and hurriedly slid out from between David and Peter.

“What’s the matter?” David yelled above the music.

“I’m sorry,” I yelled back quickly making my way for the door in a panic.

A wave of hot summer air washed over me as I reached the outside. I knew Will wouldn’t be far behind. I started scanning for a ride. Just as Will exited the club, I hailed one of the cars that was waiting outside.

“Lily!” he called out as I stepped into the road for the cab. I ignored him and climbed in, leaving the door open for him. He stood there.

“Are you coming or not?” I snapped.

Will climbed into the cab next to me.

“Lily, what’s going on?” he asked, befuddled.

“I don’t want to talk,” I evaded. I looked at him, not bothering to hide how pissed off I was. I looked down at his lap and grabbed his dick with my hand, confirming my suspicion that he was hard as a rock. Grabbing his crotch so aggressively wasn’t part of my normal behavioral repertoire.

“What the hell, Lily?”

I released my less than gentle grip and turned my head toward the window. I was caught in a swirl of emotions. I was still mad at Will for treating me like a child. I was simultaneously both horny and disgusted with myself for grinding so wantonly on two douchebags for the past twenty minutes. I was even more disgusted with Will for being turned on by it. At the same time, however, I knew was going to fuck him the second we got to our room. There was one thing, though, that troubled me far more than the rest. It wasn’t the new level of anguish and shock on Will’s face that terrified me and made me run from the club. It was how much I loved that look of lustful anguish. Some dark corner of my brain reveled in it and wanted to make him suffer.

We rode in silence to the hotel. Fortunately, it wasn’t far. Not a word was spoken through the lobby, on the elevator, or in the hall. The second the door to our room closed, I walked backwards toward the bed, pulling Will with me. I shimmied up my skirt and rushed to get Will’s pants down. He was still hard. I turned around and got on all fours on the bed, looking back expectantly. Will looked stunned at first but didn’t waste time stepping forward and putting himself inside of me. I took a deep breath in. I bucked back against him, trying to get him to fuck me harder. Even after almost five years of marriage, he still had me on a pedestal and found it difficult to treat me less than gingerly. Normally I liked that but, in that moment, I wanted to be taken. I wanted to be fucked. He picked up his pace, but I still had to lead the way. I put my hand between my legs and played with my clit, something I had never done other than in solitude and rarely even then. Will had certainly never seen it. It wasn’t long before I was whimpering as I made myself come, my mind’s eye replaying the look on Will’s face as he watched another man kiss my neck while I teased yet another’s cock with my fingertips.

“Fuck,” I groaned.

Seeing me come so passionately must have worked for Will. He pulled out and dotted my ass and the back of my dress with his orgasm.

“Sorry,” he said meekly, looking at my dress.

His apology made me cringe. I got up awkwardly and took my dress off, making my way for the bathroom. I cleaned up and gave myself a moment to catch my breath. When I came out, Will started trying to speak.

“I don’t want to talk about it,” I interrupted. “Let’s just go to sleep. We can talk tomorrow.”

Will nodded and went into the bathroom. When he came out, I was pretending to be asleep. He knew I wasn’t, but dutifully played along. I was starting to sober up, which did little to help me sort through the morass of feelings I was experiencing. The narrative I came up with for justifying my behavior was that I was ill-tempered from having felt sick and taken nap earlier in the day. With the addition of being treated like a child by Will and then being overserved, I let myself get a little carried away with a couple of good-looking young men spurred on by the knowledge that I had a permissive husband who encouraged that sort of thing. Strangely, at the time, it never occurred to me to factor in the fact that my father had just passed away. Despite my juicy rationalizations and justifications, I was still ready to take responsibility for what I had done when we woke up in the morning. Will and I were both that way.

“I’m sorry, Will,” I said, hanging my head. “There’s no excuse for my behavior last night. I was mad at you. But that’s still no reason...”

“Lily,” Will stopped me. “I’m not mad. It’s fine. I just wish I understood why you were so mad at me.”

“Because you treat me like a child, Will! Just because I felt a little sick doesn’t mean you have to dote on me like I’m an invalid. I hate that. I’m not fragile. I’m a grown ass woman.”

“Okay,” he resigned. “I was just trying to be helpful.”

“I know,” I said much more calmly, taking his hand. “Just...you don’t need to be quite so helpful all the time. I’m a big girl.”

“Okay. Fair enough.”

I was glad the conversation went as well as it did. Inside, however, I was still irritated that my husband, the man who was supposed to love me for the rest of his days, didn't even make mention of the fact that I had my fingers in another man's pants. Buried deeper was my anger at myself for enjoying it. And deeper still, my self-loathing for how much I reveled in the pained look on my husband's face. I made the decision to dismiss all of it and get things back to normal as soon as possible.

The only logistical obstacle in my return to normalcy was the matter of dealing with my father's remains. Monday morning, I called the Riverford hospital. Just like my mother had explained, I had two options. I could either claim his remains and contact a funeral home or I could sign them over to the state. I hung up the phone and debated the issue for hours. I didn't talk to Will about it. I didn't talk to my mother. I didn't call my best friend Sally, who I had known since my father was actually in my life and was the only person I was close to besides my mother who had actually met the man. I called a few funeral homes in the area to inquire about the price of caskets, burial, tombstones and so on. I kept my cool with the voices on the other end of the line, but inside I scoffed at how much it would cost to have a funeral for a man who had abandoned me as a child. Still, something in me couldn't see turning him over to the state. I didn't understand why. I had barely thought of the man in the last ten years. It was just a gut feeling. I didn't have enough time to go see a shrink to figure it out. In the end, I decided to have him cremated and that I would figure out what to do with his remains later. The funeral home told me they would handle everything and that all I had to do other than pay, of course, was come pick up his ashes in a few days.

Friday morning, I got up at the same time as Will and left at 7:00 a.m. to make the drive to Riverford. Thanks to GPS, I found the funeral home with no problem. I sat in my car, doing the usual survey of things: purse, sunglasses, phone. Then I zoned out before I could open the door. I just sat there mindlessly for I don't know how long. I guess it's not every day you pick up your dead father's remains, even if you barely knew him. I pulled myself together and made my way into the funeral home and found someone to help me. His voice sounded the same as the one on the phone.

"Ah, yes. Mrs. Bradford. I trust you found us with no trouble."

"I did. Thank you."

He clicked away at his computer behind the desk for a moment, presumably pulling up my account.

“And we discussed the amount on the phone, correct?”

“Yes, we did.” I handed him an envelope with a check inside.

“Do you have any questions?”

“Um, no. I don’t think so.”

He smiled. He seemed like a kind old man. I couldn’t remember his name, though. And he wasn’t wearing a nametag.

“I’ll be right back,” he smiled solemnly.

A few moments later, he returned carrying in both hands a plain looking plastic urn with a screw top lid. He carefully handed it to me. I was numb.

“There you are, dear. I’m so sorry for your loss.”

“Thank you,” I replied. I stood up and shook his hand. I felt like I was standing on marshmallows. As I was walking away, the man addressed me again.

“Mrs. Bradford?”

I turned. “Yes.”

“I know it probably doesn’t help much, but I was in AA with your daddy for a while. He tried.” He looked at the floor, nodding his head, contemplating. He looked back up at me. “He really tried.”

I nodded silently, turned, and left. I got in my car and placed the urn in the seat next to me. Then, without warning, I began weeping uncontrollably. It was May 24th. My birthday.

# CHAPTER 2

## *Fourth of July*

“Hi, Mom.”

“Hey, baby. How are you?”

“I’m good.”

“How’s Will?”

“He’s good.”

“You’re lucky to have him, you know. His mom and daddy were such good people. Never looked down at folks like most of them rich assholes.”

“I know, Mom. You’ve told me a million times.”

“Speaking of assholes – have you figured out what you’re gonna do with your daddy yet?”

“Nope.”

“There’s a fishing spot in Riverton he used to go to. Maybe there?”

“I don’t know, Mom. I’ve been busy. I haven’t really thought about it much.”

“Well, okay. I just wanted to check on you and see how you’re doin’.”

“I’m okay, Mom. Listen, I gotta go. Will and I are going for a walk.”

“Okay, hon. Love you.”

“Oh, hey! Mom, wait! I almost forgot. Do you remember Dad ever taking me to an amusement park when I was little?”

“Boy, do I. That was the straw that broke the camel’s back. He was drunk as a skunk and tried to get them to let you ride some big rollercoaster you were nowhere near big enough to ride. When they wouldn’t let you, he punched some guy in the face and ended up getting arrested. I had to drive three hours to come pick you up from the police station. You don’t remember any of this?”

“A little,” I whispered, struggling to understand how I could have forgotten something like that. My only recollections were from my little flashback in Atlanta.

“We split up for good after that.”

I was silent on the other end.

“Baby?”

“Yeah. Sorry, Mom. Listen, I gotta go. Will’s waiting on me.”

“Okay, hon. Love you.”

“Love you, too, Mom.”

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“Are y’all coming to the cookout?” Nancy asked, wiping her brow with the back of a gloved hand. It was hot that morning, even for the South. “You know how much everybody loved your peach cobbler last year.”

Nancy was the quintessential neighborhood gossip. I’m pretty sure the real reason she spent so much time working in her yard was so she could keep an eye on all the goings on in the neighborhood. Will and I lived in a small development off a two-lane highway. We were far enough away from the main part of town to not be bothered much by noise and light pollution, but still close enough for both of us to have easy commutes to work. It was a newer development, populated mostly by young professionals. The yards were big, with small, wooded areas separating the lots, allowing for privacy. There was also a small park with playground equipment for kids, a tennis court that doubled as a basketball court, and a pool. On one end of the pool was a picnic shelter. On the other side was a

building with two sets of large sliding glass doors that housed a hot tub and a small sauna. Just past the park, nestled in one corner of the development, there were a half dozen or so one-story duplexes. They seemed a little out of character with the rest of the neighborhood, but they were tastefully done and sort of tucked away where they weren't much noticed.

"We're planning on it," Will answered. "Is everything pretty much the same as last year?"

"Pretty much. We've got a few new neighbors. And, of course, you know Darla passed a month ago."

"I heard a few weeks ago. So sad. I was sorry to hear that," I lamented. I barely knew Darla, but she hadn't been much older than me.

"I know. Poor thing," Nancy agreed, her southern drawl in full effect.

Will pulled me gently by the hand as he started edging us further down the road. "We'll see you on the Fourth," he smiled.

"Bye, y'all."

We made it about another quarter mile before Derrick spotted me.

"Here he comes," Will teased me under his breath. "Dude never says a word to me when I'm walking by myself. Just waves. I wonder why?"

"Shut up," I teased back, smiling politely at our neighbor as he approached.

"So, you guys coming to the cookout?"

"Yup," Will replied.

"Lily, I want some more of that peach cobbler. That was amazing. You're gonna have to tell Jill your secret. Not that I need to eat any more of it." Derrick grabbed his belly. "I need to be out exercising like you guys." Derrick's wife, Jill, saw us and made her way up the driveway.

"Nonsense! You look just fine," she joined in. "Lily, you look so pretty in that outfit! Where did you get it?"

"I really don't remember but thank you."

"Are y'all coming to the cookout? Derrick just couldn't stop talking about you and your cobbler after last year."

Jill was a master of passive-aggressive southern charm. An artist, really. I was so tired of the neighborhood men flirting with me and their wives hating me for it. All I was trying to do was take a walk where I live. Nothing more.

“We were just talking about that,” I smiled. “I’ll make sure to save a little something for him.” I’m no stranger to the artform myself.

“Good,” Jill smiled. Derrick seemed oblivious, perhaps willfully blind, but Jill’s cattiness was practically dripping off her tongue. “We’ll see y’all there,” she concluded, and started pulling Derrick back down the driveway.

I hated catty women. At the cookout the year before, I wore boring khaki shorts and a pink polo shirt, not wanting to draw attention to myself by taking advantage of the pool in a swimsuit. Women like Jill made me want to parade around half naked in a bikini and flirt with their husbands through the whole cookout just to piss them off. As a bonus, Will would probably love it.

Once we were a safe distance from Derrick and Jill, Will joked, “You know the only people that get as much attention as you in this neighborhood are the babies in strollers. And they have a much different demographic than you.”

“Hush,” I chided.

“I like the way you handled Jill back there. I bet Derrick would pay good money to get ahold of your cobbler, if you know what I mean.”

“Will!” I scolded him again, slapping his arm. Generally speaking, I couldn’t have cared less about hearing how pretty I was from anyone else, but I liked it when Will found a way of pointing it out. We ran into three more husbands and three more very southern wives before we were able to circle back home.

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The Fourth arrived. Will and I showed up fashionably late, guitar and cobbler in our respective hands. Everything was the same as the previous year until I looked up from spooning a bit of cobbler for the cutest little boy. Standing in front of me was a man I had never seen before. I had an immediate, and what I can only describe as visceral, reaction to him. It

was jarring. The feeling was reminiscent of something, but brand new at the same time. I couldn't place it.

"Would you mind if I got some of that cobbler, too, ma'am?" he asked. His voice was deep and boomy.

"Of course," I smiled, hoping my outsides weren't matching my insides. I spooned some cobbler onto his plate, keeping my head down, without saying anything more. I could tell he was looking at me.

"Thank you, ma'am."

I didn't like being called "ma'am."

"Lily," I corrected and extended my hand, trying to gather my composure and remember my manners like a good southern girl. I wanted to know his name.

He took my hand. It practically engulfed mine. His palm was rough. His grip was strong but gentle. "Tom."

Tom took a seat on one of the benches under the shelter to eat his cobbler. I couldn't help but monitor him out of the corner of my eye. I watched the same women who ran interference every time their husbands glanced in my direction find their way to him. I let myself breathe in the air of their hypocrisy as I watched them offering him more food, fluttering their eyelashes, and playing with their hair. Clearly, I wasn't the only one on whom he had made an impression. There was something about him, to be sure, but he wasn't what I would call traditionally handsome. Other than his stunning green eyes, he didn't have model good looks. He was tall. His face was gruff, not unlike that of a bulldog. His nose was off center, like a boxer's. He looked strong, but not chiseled, with meaty forearms and big thighs in his drab olive t-shirt and cargo shorts. His dark skin and features suggested some kind of blended ethnicity, but I couldn't discern anything more than that. His hair was cut short, so I couldn't glean any clues from it either, other than that he was starting to go gray. He wasn't really any of the things most women would check off on a dating profile. The only way I could explain it is that he was just plain masculine. Part stallion. Part junkyard dog.

The most confusing thing was the effect he was having on me. It bothered me. I caught him eyeing me a few times. He didn't look away like

most men when they were caught. He didn't stare, either. He simply acknowledged with a little smile that he knew I saw him looking at me. I was used to men staring, but the way Tom's eyes pierced mine was unsettling. I couldn't understand what I was feeling. Was it fear? Anger? Excitement? Lust? I wasn't used to feeling intimidated by a man, and I didn't like it. Part of me wanted to leave as soon as possible. Another part of me wanted to just stare at him until he made sense.

To avoid Tom and the catty neighborhood wives, I passed time playing with the neighborhood children. I loved kids, and I was looking forward to starting a family with Will, but not quite yet. We wanted a few more years of freedom and sleep. As it got later, the families with children steadily tapered off until there was nowhere left for me to hide. Will started taking requests on his guitar for people to sing along with. Tom played guitar as well, apparently, and took a few turns, which gave me an excuse to watch him and try to decipher what the hell was going on with me.

Even after having a few vodka cranberries with lots of ice, I was growing weary of the summer heat, not to mention my irritation with the Tom factor. Most people had cooled off in the pool, and despite the temptation to poke the bear, I had again opted to leave my suit at home. I didn't particularly want any more attention from the neighborhood men, and I definitely didn't need any more passive-aggressive southern charm coming my way from their wives.

I waited for a break between songs to whisper to Will, "Baby, I can't take much more of this heat. Let's go home."

There were a few protests from the remaining partygoers. Will handed Tom his guitar.

"Tom, why don't you take over? Just run it by the house when you're done. I can show you that twelve-string I was talking about."

"Sounds good," Tom nodded, settling Will's guitar across his leg. Tom looked at me. "As long as it's okay with your wife."

"Of course," I smiled politely.

"Fuck!" I thought to myself. "Now he's coming by the house." All I wanted in that moment was to get in the pool with a nice cold drink and forget about Tom and whatever the hell it was he stirred in me.

On the walk home, Will apologized. "Sorry if I sprang Tom on you. I guess I got excited about showing off my guitars. I should have asked you first."

"Yeah, you like showing things off, don't you?" I teased. Things had gotten mostly back to normal since Atlanta, at least for me. Honestly, I don't think Will was bothered by it much to begin with. Confused would probably be a better word. At any rate, we hadn't indulged Will's fetish since Atlanta, and it felt good to crack a joke about it. It felt oddly normal. It fit. We both chuckled.

"Honestly, that didn't even occur to me," Will denied.

"Sure, it didn't," I teased.

"I do love showing you off, though. I have the most beautiful wife in the whole neighborhood," he flirted.

"Well, you're gonna get your chance. I'm getting in the pool as soon as we get home. And if it weren't for your new friend coming over, I'd be doing it naked. It's so muggy out tonight," I complained.

Will looked at me mischievously. I knew what he was thinking. I knew it as soon as the word "naked" left my mouth. He smiled and started laughing. I reprimanded him. "You need to stop it!" I laughed when I said it, but the thought of being naked in front of Tom gave me butterflies. "Stop it!" I silently reprimanded myself.

Will and I both went straight to the bedroom to change into our swimsuits as soon as we got home. He watched me dig through the drawer, trying to pick one out.

"How about the white one?" he prodded, his tone conveying that he knew the chances of that were next to nothing.

The white one left little to the imagination. It was a string bikini that was practically transparent when it was wet. The bottom was somewhere between dental floss and a thong that left my backside almost completely uncovered. The top wasn't much better. I got it on one of our trips at Will's behest to show off my body to our fellow resort guests at the pool for Will's gratification. I rolled my eyes at Will's suggestion I do the same for Tom.

"Fine," I said. Outwardly, it sounded like I was relenting. On the inside, my butterflies started multiplying. "What the hell, Lily?" I thought

to myself. I wasn't shy about showing off my body, but it had always been out of town and to tickle Will's fetish. This time felt different. I felt like I was in some kind of power struggle with Tom, and he was winning. In my mind, my white bikini was a weapon to regain the upper hand. And it wasn't only that. Beneath everything else, if I was to be completely honest with myself, I wanted him to look at me. I wanted him to see me. It made no sense, but that's how it felt. The whole thing was confounding.

Will beat me to the kitchen. When I got there, he was fixing me another vodka cranberry. He handed it to me to test. It was a good bit stronger than the ones I had made myself at the cookout.

"Whew," I whistled.

"Too strong?"

"No, it's okay."

"More cranberry?"

"Nah. Just some more ice, please."

Will added a few cubes to my glass and I started my way to the pool. "You coming?" I asked.

"I'm gonna wait on Tom."

"Suit yourself." I continued sauntering toward the sliding glass doors, my G-string showing off my all but naked backside.

"Hey, Lily," Will called.

I looked over my shoulder back at Will.

"You have a perfect ass."

"I know," I smirked and carried on my way. I knew damn well how good I looked in that bikini. I was starting to look forward to turning the tables on Tom, despite the fact that he had no idea we were at odds. Regardless, his effect on me was starting to really piss me off, and for some inexplicable reason, I was taking it personally. I made my way down the steps of the pool without breaking stride. The combination of the cool water on the outside and the cold liquor and fruit juice on the inside was exactly what I needed. After a little while, my body felt reinvigorated after being in the heat for so long. By the time Will walked outside, I had finished my drink and was sucking on an ice cube, strategizing.

“Tom’s here. Are you feeling better?”

“Ready to show me off?” I replied.

Will grinned. “I left him in the kitchen.”

“Perfect,” I said. “I was just about to go fix myself another drink.”

Will offered his hand to help me up the steps of the pool. I dabbed myself with a towel. I could sense him watching me, likely wondering if I was going to cover myself with the towel before going inside. I tossed the towel on the chair and proceeded to walk into the house in my wet, white, translucent, barely-there bikini. I walked into the kitchen and saw Tom looking at the photos on the fridge.

“Hi Tom. Don’t mind me,” I smiled, trying not to let my gaze linger on his powerful-looking, tattooed bicep fingering one of the photos on the fridge, angling it for a better look.

“Hi Lily,” he replied. Just as I hoped, he couldn’t help but scan my body before his forebrain reminded him to be polite. I felt a pleasant tingle go down my spine.

“Just fixing another drink. Do you want one?” I offered.

“No thanks. I’m good,” he replied. “Your husband gave me a beer.”

“Let me know if you want anything.” I stood on my tiptoes with my back to Tom to fetch a fresh glass from the cabinet. For all intents and purposes, I was naked from that angle. I paused for a moment, acting as though I couldn’t find the particular glass I was looking for. The butterflies were going crazy. Then I opened the freezer to fill my glass with ice. I could feel my nipples perk up when the cold air hit my wet top. I not-so-accidentally dropped an ice cube on the floor and bent over to pick it up. I didn’t look, but I knew Tom was taking it all in.

Will walked into the kitchen just in time to catch him doing exactly that. I knew my husband was loving it.

“Tom, I was gonna get in the pool with Lily and cool off. You’re welcome to join us,” he offered.

“Sounds good, but I don’t have a suit,” Tom replied.

“Just go in your shorts. I’m sure we can find something dry for you to wear home,” Will offered.

“It would be nice to cool off,” he agreed.

Tom followed Will and I outside. I strolled back into the pool, drink in hand. Will followed. Tom took off his shirt and kicked off his shoes. He had several tattoos. In the hit or miss outdoor lighting, I thought I could almost make out some scars underneath the ink. I didn't normally care for tattoos on a man, but they added to Tom's gruffness and mystique. They suited him. He sat down on the steps with his beer. Will leaned against the pool wall, not far from him. I climbed into our float with the drink holder. He was trying to not be too obvious, but I could feel Tom's eyes on me. I steered the float to best take advantage of the underwater pool light and the outdoor lighting to give Tom the best view. My breasts weren't particularly large, but they were more than a handful and damn near perfect. My nipples were perky and small, but you could easily see them protruding from behind the thin, wet material of my top and clearly make out my areolas. I scooped up some water with my hand and dripped it over my body. Even though I complained about how hot it was while I was doing it, my real purpose was to draw attention to how easily you could see through my bikini. Will watched, knowing exactly what I was doing. I could tell he was loving it. It felt good to have a sense of control again after feeling so flustered at the cookout. In the corner of my eye, I could see Tom staring. I wasn't the only one that caught Tom looking. Will chuckled and tried to put Tom at ease when he realized he'd been caught.

“It's okay, Tom. Don't worry about it.”

“Sorry.”

“Seriously. Don't worry about it,” Will reiterated.

“He likes it,” I added. “Don't you, Will?” I enjoyed giving him a hard time. I was maybe even still a little angry about Atlanta. And maybe a little drunk. “He likes it when other men look at me. He likes it when I flirt.” I knew I was pushing the boundaries of what Will was comfortable with in our little game. Maybe it was the booze, but I was enjoying myself.

“It's not as bad as it sounds,” Will defended himself before Tom could even say anything. “I hate dancing. Lily loves it. So sometimes, when we're out of town, I take her out and let her dance with other guys. You think she looks good now? You should see her move. But I'm the one that

gets to take her home.” I could tell that Will was doing his best to make it sound a little less perverse than it really was.

“Well, you certainly are a beautiful woman,” Tom said politely.

I changed the subject. “So, what do you do, Tom?”

“I’m a Marine. Retired. Now I fix y’all’s toilets and paint your kitchens.”

“You’re a better man than me. I don’t know how to do any of that stuff. I’m useless around the house,” Will admitted. I could tell he was trying to be humble considering he was likely twenty years younger than Tom yet enjoying a much more comfortable living. Will was like that. He never let himself feel superior to anyone, despite how much success he had.

“What about you guys? How did you kids meet?” Tom asked.

Will fielded that one while I looked Tom over. He was built like a powerlifter. He wasn’t shredded, but he was visibly strong. In the light, concealed by the tattoo on his shoulder, I could definitely make out what looked like a bullet wound and its accompanying surgery scar. It looked similar to the one on Will’s hip and the ones I’d seen at work. The stubble on his face was thick. I could almost feel it on my skin. He was a built like a gladiator. I wondered if he’d ever killed anyone. My consciousness faded back in at the end of Will’s origin story.

“It wasn’t until after I dropped out of college and moved here that we started dating,” Will concluded.

“Why’d you drop out?” Tom asked, taking the last sip of his beer.

For some reason, I answered before Will had the chance. Maybe it was part of the pissing contest I had going on with Tom in my mind. I don’t know. But I did know that Will would make up some bullshit about how he didn’t feel school was challenging him and he didn’t feel like he could do his best work in that environment. Blah, blah, blah. He didn’t like telling people the real reason.

“He got shot,” I replied.

I couldn’t quite believe I had just said it out loud. I knew Will wouldn’t like it. He’d been shot in the hip while working at a convenience store his junior year of college. There was no sense in it. Will gave the guy

the money from the safe and the register. He shot Will just before leaving for seemingly no reason. The wound required multiple surgeries including a hip replacement. Will had to spend weeks in the hospital recovering followed by months of physical rehabilitation. He was lucky he didn't lose his leg. Will used the sizeable settlement he received from the convenience store to seed his business from his hospital bed. I slid off the float and made my way for the steps.

"Do you want another beer, Tom?" I offered.

"Sure," he replied.

I didn't ask Will if he wanted another beer. I placed a hand on Tom's shoulder to help balance myself as I started up the steps. I paused to pick up his empty bottle, leaning over slightly and putting my ass eye-level only a foot away. When I turned to continue up the steps, Tom didn't bother to pretend he wasn't looking. I went slowly so he could get a good view of my rear cheeks, dotted with water droplets, each reflecting the light. Tom continued staring as I dabbed myself with a towel again. I stared back, letting him know I didn't mind him looking, before walking into the house. Before I closed the sliding glass door behind me, I could hear his deep voice bellow, "I don't blame you for showing her off. She's fucking gorgeous."

When I returned, I took my time walking, letting Tom and Will get another unobstructed view of my barely covered body. I handed Tom his beer and told the gawkers that I was going to rinse off in the outdoor shower before going back inside. I let the water from the nozzle cascade over my skin while I posed for them, pretending to ignore the fact that they were staring. I took my time and reveled in Tom watching me. My little white bikini had done its job well. I turned off the shower and reached for the little bottle of coconut oil. I put on another show, spreading just a bit of the oil along my tan skin, leaving it glistening in the wavy light of the pool.

"Fuck," I heard Will whisper.

"God damn," Tom muttered under his breath.

I tried not to smile. I walked to the edge of the pool.

"Alright boys, I'll see you inside."

As I started walking back to the house, I heard Will and Tom making their way out of the pool. I walked to the bedroom and took off my wet bikini. I let myself air dry for a moment as I touched up my makeup and made my wet hair rest along my shoulders just so. I put on a pair of white lace panties before wrapping myself in a white satin robe with three-quarter sleeves that left most of my thighs exposed. Tom was a good bit thicker than my husband, but I grabbed a pair of Will's shorts with an elastic waistband that had the best chance of fitting and I thought I would enjoy seeing him in the most. I met the boys in the kitchen as they were fixing more drinks. I handed Tom the shorts.

"Baby, Tom's shirt got wet, too. Do you think I have anything that would fit him?" Will asked.

"I don't know," I replied, using the excuse to scan Tom's torso. "He's a good bit bigger than you. I'll go check."

Will walked into the bedroom as I was looking through his clothes. "I doubt we have any shirts that would fit him, babe."

Will got close and put his hands on my hips. "I can't wait to fuck you tonight," he whispered. He punctuated his point by taking my hand and guiding it to the bulge in his pants.

"Uh, uh, uh!" I chided and pulled away my hand. "I've got to get Tom's clothes dry first. And besides, I want to make you wait a little bit longer."

"So, you want to flirt some more?" Will asked suggestively, taking another swig of his beer.

I made myself sound reluctant. "What did you have in mind?"

"I was thinking maybe you could see if Tom wanted to dance a little bit. I'll act like I'm going to bed while you guys wait on the clothes to dry. I can make my way through the back yard and watch through the glass doors from outside."

"You're a sneaky little bastard, aren't you?"

"You don't have to if you don't want to."

"Is that what you want?"

Will looked at me mischievously. “Yes, please.” I could tell he was fairly drunk. We both were.

“So, you want me to let a half-naked man that we just met put his hands all over me in our living room?”

“It’s up to you. I trust you. You can stop at any point. And I’ll control the music with my phone. If I put on Motown, that will be my signal that I want you to stop.”

“I don’t know, Will. Remember Atlanta?”

“You were the one who was so upset about Atlanta. It was fine. And you have complete control here. It’s just dancing is all. Nothing you haven’t done before.” Will pulled me close and kissed me. “You don’t have to, baby. It’s fine if you don’t want to. I’m horny as hell already just from looking at you in that bikini all night.” He was letting me off the hook, but I knew he still wanted me to.

“What if he tries something?”

“I trust you. And besides, Tom seems nice enough. I’m not worried about him. I’ll be watching the whole time.”

“I know you will,” I said. “I know you, Will,” I thought.

My reluctance was genuine. But not for the reasons I led my husband to believe. Between walking around in a barely-there bikini and putting on my little shower show, I had become more than a little aroused. By the time Will and I stood in our bedroom debating if I should flirt even more, I was maybe as horny as I had ever been. It was becoming clear that something about Tom was triggering some foreign part of me that I didn’t understand and didn’t trust. At that moment, I had the upper hand. I wanted to keep it that way. And I wasn’t sure Will would be suggesting I get so cozy with Tom if he knew what was going on inside of me.

“I don’t know,” I repeated. “I’m not wearing much. I’m not even wearing a bra under this.” I opened my robe to reveal my lace panties and bare breasts.

“Oh fuck,” Will whispered and kissed me. He ran his hand down to my ass and took a nipple in his mouth.

I pushed him off. “Save it for later, cowboy,” I insisted.

“You look unbelievable. Tom couldn’t keep his eyes off of you. You are the sexiest woman I’ve ever seen.”

Those were the magic words. I knew I was pretty. I had been told so all of my life, but never had I felt like I was sexy. There’s a difference.

“Okay,” I pretended to relent. “Let’s go before I lose my nerve. Fix me another drink, okay?”

I grabbed a t-shirt for Tom at random from the closet. When I did, I accidentally knocked the one next to it off its hanger. It fell onto my father’s urn, covering it. For a split second, I felt the emptiness. I shut it out as quickly as it came on and followed Will out of the bedroom, letting the t-shirt lay where it fell. We met Tom in the living room. I didn’t waste any time.

“Tom, do you like to dance?” I asked.

“I don’t really dance,” he said. “I learned how to shag a little when I spent a summer in Myrtle Beach one year.”

I had never learned to shag and always kind of wanted to. I played up my excitement.

“Ooh, ooh, show me! I’ve always wanted to learn!”

I grabbed the shorts and t-shirt back from Tom and tossed them to the couch. Will put on some beach music. I sipped my drink while he and Tom cleared the coffee table out of the way so we could have more room. Tom took my hand and started fumbling through showing me the steps. The shag isn’t a particularly intimate dance. You basically hold hands while you move your feet. *Triple step. Triple step. Rock step.* Will went to the kitchen to toss his empty beer and returned, feigning disinterest in our dancing.

Just as Tom and I were getting the hang of things, Will announced, “Hey, guys. I’m beat. I’m gonna call it a night.”

“Yeah, I should go,” Tom said.

“No, no,” Will insisted. “Stay as long as you want. Your clothes are still wet. And besides, Lily loves to dance. She’ll blame me if you leave now.” Will kissed me goodnight. “I love you, baby. Good night. Goodnight, Tom.”

“I love you, too, baby,” I smiled.

Will walked down the hall, turning off the outside lights and most of the lights in the house on his way to the bedroom, while Tom and I continued working on the Shag in the now dimly lit living room. When the song ended, slow R&B started playing.

“We lost our beach music,” Tom noted.

“Will must have put it on autopilot,” I lied. “I don’t know how that damn thing works. I guess we’ll just have to make do.”

“I still need to go change clothes,” Tom reminded me.

“Oh, that’s right! The bathroom’s in the hall. You can change there. Just bring me your wet stuff and I’ll put it in the dryer.”

Tom returned a few minutes later. The shorts I had given him were Will’s light gray running shorts with a white drawstring in front. On Will, they were a little baggy. On Tom, they were snug, almost like boxer briefs. So snug, in fact, that they left little to the imagination. There was a prominent bulge in the front. It looked like Tom’s manhood was built like he was. I forced myself to not let my gaze linger. Tom handed me the shirt, saying there was no way it would fit him. I took his wet clothes and tossed them in the dryer with our towels. By the time I got back to the living room, I knew Will had discovered my R&B slow-grind mix.

“Is this the sort of stuff you normally dance to?” Tom asked.

“Sometimes,” I smiled.

“I don’t know if I can dance to this.”

“It’s easy,” I said. “Especially for the guy. All you really need to do is stand there and follow me with your hips.” I took Tom’s hands and lifted them over his head. “Watch.” I lifted my arms, exposing more of my legs and just a hint of my panties. I moved my hips in a circle in front of Tom. “See?”

Tom followed my hips carefully with his eyes. "I can live with that." I turned around and circled my hips some more, lifting my arms and letting Tom see the beginnings of my ass. "God damn," Tom mumbled. "Is this how you dance in the clubs?"

"Kinda, yeah. I usually have actual clothes on. Not just little lace panties and a robe," I said, letting him know exactly how close to naked I was. "Advantage, me," I thought to myself.

"And Will lets you do that?"

"He likes it."

"I think I like it, too."

I giggled my best girly giggle and turned around, stepping a little closer, centering myself over Tom's leg, and placing a hand on his bare chest. My heart was pounding, but I still felt very much in control. I knew I was getting to him, and I loved it. As I danced, hovering over Tom's leg, I looked down and saw that the bulge in Tom's shorts had grown. As he had become more and more aroused watching me dance, his cock made its way down one side of his shorts toward his thigh, straining against the tight, thin cotton. I could easily make out his impressively thick shaft and even the outline of its mushroom head. I had never cared about the size of a man's dick, but my chin dropped a little at the sight of it. I was the one that got caught looking that time. "Point, Tom," I thought to myself.

"You're not moving your hips," I said, trying to cover. "Here..." I instructed and turned around putting his hands on my hips. "...follow me." I scooted back and let my ass graze his crotch. I felt his body start to follow mine. "There you go. See, it's not so bad."

"I could get used to this. And this is really how people dance in clubs these days?"

"Oh, yeah. This is fairly tame."

"Really?"

"Definitely. You see people making out and grinding so hard it practically looks like they're having sex with their clothes on."

"Seriously?"

I turned around and put one arm around Tom's neck, the other on his chest, still swaying my hips. I felt the butterflies in my stomach stir, feeling the bare skin of his muscular chest.

"And your husband lets you make out with these guys?"

"I don't really make out with them. Sometimes I let them give me a little kiss or two. Let their hands roam a bit."

"Where?"

"You mean where do I let them kiss me or where do I let them touch me?"

"Both."

"I let them kiss me on my neck..."

I tilted my head to one side and ran a finger along my neck.

"...my shoulder..."

I pushed the neckline of my robe just a bit to the side.

"...my ear..."

I ran my finger up my neck and turned my head to highlight my ear.

"...and sometimes..."

I don't know what made me do it, but I raised up on my tiptoes, thinking of Will watching through the glass.

"...my lips..."

I kissed Tom gently on the mouth, barely touching our lips together for half of one Mississippi. I swear my heart stopped.

Tom licked his lips. "And where do you let them touch you?" he asked. His eyes looked hungry.

"My hips..." I smiled, putting my hands over his. I turned around, putting my back to him again, and inhaled deeply in response to his touch as I slid his hands to my stomach.

"...my stomach..."

I turned back around and moved his hands back to my hips, trying to angle myself so Will could get the best view.

“...my butt...”

I tiptoed up once more and kissed Tom again. As I did, together we slid his hands down to my ass. One Mississippi. He gently squeezed my cheeks through the thin satin material of my robe. I stayed on my toes for a moment, resting my head on his shoulder as he explored my ass with his hands. We were nearing the end of the second song, and I began to anticipate the sound of Motown, wondering how much rope Will was going to give me before he'd had enough. I had already officially gone as far as I ever had with his little flirting game. I was more than ready to meet Will in the bedroom and feel his mouth between my legs. Instead, another song began. It was decidedly not Motown. Tom and I continued our dance to the deep bass and sultry-voiced melody.

I turned around again and started grinding my ass against Tom's crotch with the music. If Will cared to keep it going, I was going to push things a little further, make him suffer. Part of me wanted to see the same look I saw on his face in Atlanta. I could feel Tom's hard cock pressing against me. He wasn't making any attempt to be subtle. Tom grasped my hips and matched my movements. I bent forward and placed my hands on my knees, my robe sliding up and exposing part of my ass and panties as I did. I rocked my backside up and down along his crotch. His hands left my hips for a moment, and glancing over my shoulder, I could just barely catch him quickly adjusting his erection in his shorts. He put his hands back on my hips and pulled me to him. His shaft was then firmly nestled between my cheeks as we rolled our hips in time together. Looking back, that was the moment when I should have stopped. I wanted to bend over further so I could feel him where I ached. I managed to resist the urge. Instead, I straightened up and leaned my head back against his shoulder. It reminded me of Atlanta. In my mind's eye, I saw Will's face in the balcony, full of desire and anguish. Again, I became acutely aware of the butterflies dancing along with us in my stomach. Tom slowly rotated us so that his back was to the glass doors, blocking Will's sightline. Maybe he knew Will was there. I don't know. I took Tom's hands in mine and guided them to my stomach. I felt Tom's lips on my neck. And then again. His tongue began preceding his gentle kisses. I felt the cool air against my skin where he left his mark with each touch.

“Like this?” he whispered.

“Yes,” I whispered back, nodding my head and tilting it to the side. I was starting to get lost in the moment, still having no idea what it was about that man that gave him such power over me. Tom’s lips slowly made their way from my neck to my clavicle, pulling my robe to the side and dotting my skin along the way. He moved his hands low on my hips as he continued kissing my neck and shoulder. I could feel his fingers radiating outward from my hips toward my sex. Tom bent his knees to level his cock firmly against my ass and slid it slowly up between my cheeks.

“Fuck,” I whispered, nearly letting myself fall completely into the moment. I was losing ground. I forced myself to turn around. I centered over Tom’s leg again. I couldn’t resist moving closer and lowering myself until my throbbing pussy was grazing the top of his thigh. With one hand around the nape of his neck, I leaned back and rocked my hips forward, my sex just barely touching his leg with nothing but my warm, wet panties between us. He had to have felt them against the bare skin of his leg. Tom kept one hand in the small of my back, helping me balance. With the other, he untied my robe in one smooth, deliberate motion. I did nothing to stop him. The two sides of my robe parted, exposing my panties and torso, but still clung to my breasts on each side, barely keeping them hidden. He explored my flesh, sliding his hand along my rib cage to my stomach and up to my sternum between my breasts. He moved his hand to my shoulder, his pinky finger following the edge of my robe. At my clavicle, he slid his fingers under the material and then moved his hand down, exposing my breast and grasping it fully in his hand, gently pinching my nipple in the space between his fingers. At the same time, he pulled me closer with his other hand, pressing my aching pussy against his leg. I was panting. The song faded out. Tom was so much bigger than me, I didn’t know if Will could see what we were doing. My whole body was buzzing, wanting more. Wanting contact. Waiting. Listening for the next song. A slow beat faded in. I didn’t recognize the tune. It wasn’t a club song. It wasn’t Motown, either. It was a love song. I couldn’t believe Will was letting things go so far. Or did he even know? Could he even see what was happening? I did my best to gather my senses. I pulled my robe back together and eased myself back from Tom’s leg to stand in front of him. He moved his hands to my hips and pulled me to him. My arms instinctively went around his neck. I was flustered.

“We have to slow down,” I panted.

Tom held me close. I could feel his hard bulge pressing against my abdomen through the thin cotton of his shorts and the satin of my robe. He put his cheek to mine. I could feel his breath in my ear. I sighed every bit of air from my lungs. He kissed his way down my neck and back up to my ear, nibbling at my earlobe. He slid his hand down across my ass to my thigh and back up. My breath became shallow and stuttered. Any edge I’d had in the situation was gone. Tom was in control. His lips found mine, and he kissed me softly. One Mississippi. Then again. I parted my lips and welcomed his tongue—the only other man since I first kissed Will. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. Three Mississippi. Tom eased a hand up to my breast. He lowered his head and sucked my nipple through the thin satin. I gasped. He untied my robe again, opening it on both sides, peeling it back across my breasts and over my shoulders. I pulled my shoulders back and straightened my arms behind me, letting it fall to the floor, leaving me naked except for my white lace panties. Tom slid both of his hands to my ass.

I was throbbing and desperately wanting to be touched. Tom kissed his way down my neck and to my chest until he took my bare nipple in his mouth, gently nibbling it and teasing it with his tongue. I wanted him. Badly. I felt him slide his hands into each side of my panties, ready to take them off. No matter how badly I wanted it, I knew I couldn’t indulge. I shook my head and took his hands in mine, guiding them back to my ass. Tom pulled me close to him, my head against his chest, my hands around his back pulling him to me, feeling his bare chest against mine. Tom eased one of his hands all the way down my ass and between my legs, finding my wetness. My chest was heaving. He worked his middle finger inside my underwear, reaching to part my folds and find my clitoris. I kissed his chest and quietly moaned as he flitted his finger. I said nothing to stop him. I waited, wondering if Will could see and would burst in to stop us. It didn’t happen. Instead, I whimpered wordlessly into Tom’s chest as a man who was not my husband brought me to orgasm.

In a stupor, I found myself kissing Tom and then tonguing my way down his chest, slowly squatting lower and lower until I was circling his navel with my lips and tongue over and over, contemplating the unthinkable. Holding his hips for balance, I could see the precum that had

soaked through his shorts. I kissed and licked further down until I felt my chin brushing against his dick and the wetness of his waistband on my lips. I ran my tongue along the edge of his shorts, tasting his salty desire.

Never in my life had I wanted to go down on a man. I could count on the fingers of one hand the number of times I actually had. In that moment, as I squatted before Tom with a pair of my husband's shorts the only thing between me and another man's manhood, it was taking every ounce of self-control I had remaining to not give in. I lingered just above his waistband, unable to pull myself away, kissing his belly below his naval and sneaking my tongue just barely under the salty cotton, waiting for Motown to save me from my insanity. Tom lifted my chin with a finger and gently traced my lips with his thumb. I opened my mouth and licked it. I licked it again and circled it with my tongue before taking it between my lips and sucking it. I shifted to my knees and sat on my heels, staring up at him. I pushed the fingers from both of my hands into Tom's waistband as I fellated his thumb, still barely resisting the urge to free his cock and have my way. Seeing my reluctance, Tom pulled his waistband open on his own with his free hand and worked his shorts down. I would be lying if I said that I didn't help him. His cock sprang out in front of me. It was remarkably thick, meaty, and gorgeous. Tom took it in his hand and began slowly stroking himself, staring down at me licking and sucking his thumb. I followed his hand as he inched it closer and closer to his cock.

Suddenly and all at once, the song ended, and the dryer loudly buzzed its completion. I looked up at Tom, drunk on desire. He pulled his thumb from my mouth and gripped the base of his shaft. He leaned forward just enough for the tip of his cock to rest so close to my mouth that I could feel the heat emanating from it. The room was silent. In that moment, it finally became clear to me what I had been feeling and why I recognized it but could not quite place it. The rollercoaster. The anticipation. The buildup. The crest. And then, that fraction of a second when you're weightless and powerless to stop the fall. My drug.

Without thinking and in slow motion, I lifted my chin and extended my tongue to meet the underside of Tom's shaft just below the tip. The instant my tongue touched his cock, it felt like I was jumping off a cliff into a bottomless void with my arms spread wide, buzzing and ready to fly, letting gravity and fate take me wherever they chose. I took his cock in my

hand, circled the tip with my tongue, and finally opened wide to engulf his spongy, salty, cockhead with my mouth.

I watched myself like I was someone else as I unabashedly sucked Tom's dick on my knees in the middle of my living room. I heard the bassline of another song. It sounded like it was a thousand miles away and underwater. I put a hand down my panties and flitted my finger across my clitoris as I devoured Tom's cock, working to fit his girth in my mouth. His shaft absorbed most of the volume of my high-pitched whine as I came with a cock in my mouth for the first time.

*“than the birds in the trees...”*

With my other hand now free, I moved to wrap it around Tom's shaft with my other one. He intercepted it and pulled my fingers to his mouth, tasting my orgasm. Once satisfied, he let it go. I worked his cock with both hands, neither coming close to navigating it's entire circumference on its own. My mouth somehow relaxed into something I'd barely done before. It felt surprisingly natural. For some inexplicable, primal, evolutionary reason, I reveled in being on my knees for a man I had met only a few hours earlier. I felt empowered, submissive, beautiful, and divinely sexy all at the same time. I was on a desperate mission to please him. The only thing that mattered to me in that moment was that I be the one to make him come. I savored his taste and the feeling of his cock in my mouth—sensations I had avoided my entire adult life. I hummed my contentment as I sucked him. And for the first time, I wanted to taste a man. I took Tom's hand and put it on the back of my head. He gathered my hair with both hands and guided me up and down his cock, sometimes along just the first few inches, other times until he reached my throat. When I gagged, he let me up for air.

“Fuck,” I gasped. I looked up at him, my eyes watering, my lips glistening. “I want you to come,” I panted.

I launched myself back onto his cock, determined to finish him. Tom kept guiding me until he started groaning louder. I had never had a man finish in my mouth. It caught me off guard, even though I knew it was

imminent. It wasn't what I expected. It holds true to this day that, at that moment in my life, Tom tasted like he was made for me. It was pheromonal. Biological. I kept jerking and sucking, doing my best to coax all of the salty tanginess I could, until he pushed my head away. I lifted my messy chin upward, shamelessly looking for his approval. I reached for his cock with my mouth and stole another taste. I couldn't believe myself. I was like an entirely different person. Bizzaro Lily.

"Fuck," Tom panted, using my shoulder to help hold himself steady as his body quivered. I wrapped my lips around his cock again. "Goddamn!" he exclaimed as he pushed me away again, trying to keep his balance.

I stood up, wiping my chin and licking the salty taste from my lips. I wrapped my arms around Tom's neck and felt his bare chest against my breasts. We kissed. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. Three...

Somewhere around six Mississippi an unmistakable tune faded into my consciousness, "...*talkin' bout, talkin' bout, talkin' bout my girl...*"

"Oh my god! Will!" I panicked. I had completely forgotten about my husband. "You have to go!"

I hurried to the dryer to get Tom's things and heard Will coming into the bedroom from outside. I ignored it and pulled out Tom's clothes and a towel from the dryer to cover my chest. By the time I made it back to the living room, Tom had Will's shorts pulled back up and was standing where I left him, looking confused.

"I'm sorry. I'm so sorry. You have to go," I pleaded.

"But I thought..." he started to say.

I pushed Tom toward the door, his clothes in hand. I nearly had him out the door when he bruted his way back across the threshold. As he stood in front of me, I was reminded of how ruggedly powerful he was. He lifted my chin with his finger and kissed me softly on the lips. I fell into him and kissed him back. His touch settled me somehow. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. Three Mississippi. Four. Five. Six. Seven. His hands roamed my body. I dropped the towel. Tom kissed his way down my neck and to

my nipple. I wanted more but I stepped back deliberately, keeping my hand on his chest, and said in a much calmer, kinder, instructive tone, “You have to go.”

As Tom stepped back respectfully, I lunged forward and stole one more, deep, full kiss as I simultaneously eased him out the door. The neighbor across the street or anyone driving by could have easily witnessed my topless and kissing another man.

I closed the door behind Tom, picked up my towel, and slowly walked to the bedroom, preparing myself for Will’s righteous anger. I had no argument, no justification for what I had done. Anything he had to say to me or any consequence he levied, I prepared myself to accept. As I entered the bedroom, I saw Will standing naked and hard in the middle of the room. His stare was intense and unprecedented. It put Atlanta to shame. I stood just inside the doorway, holding the towel against my chest. Our eyes locked. I felt tears beginning to flow. My throat was tight. I managed to whisper, “I’m sorry,” as I broke down.

Will marched forward and grabbed my wrist, pulling me with him to the bed and tossing my towel to the floor. He yanked my panties off savagely and climbed between my legs. He pinned my hands above my head on the mattress and ran his cock along my slit. I was still wet and aching to be fucked. I spread my legs wide, and Will put himself inside of me. He fucked me with quick, stabbing, staccato thrusts. His face was angry. Dominating. He had never looked at me that way before.

“Did you like sucking that big cock?” he growled.

I turned my head to the side as far as I could, trying to hide my shame and my tears.

“Look at me, Lily! Look at me!”

I turned my face to his.

“Did you like sucking another man’s cock?” he demanded more softly.

I stared into his eyes, watching them turn from anger to desire. I could tell he was replaying the scene of me on my knees for Tom in his head. I felt Will’s cock thrusting into me, fucking me without the restraints of kindness for the first time. It felt amazing.

“Tell me! Did you like sucking that big fat dick?”

“Yes!” I relented, grunting back in a whisper through my tears.

Will somehow growled and whimpered at the same time, like he didn’t know what to feel. His breathing became deeper and smoother.

“Yeah? Did you swallow him?” he whispered, stopping and teasing the head of his cock at my entrance. It felt better than it ever had before.

“Did you? Did you swallow his come?”

“Yes,” I whispered, staring him in the eyes, my acquiescence turning to willing, antagonizing, participation. I licked my upper lip. “I can still taste him.”

Will lowered his head to mine and darted his tongue into my mouth and started thrusting inside of me again.

“Yes!” I whispered loudly against his lips. “Fuck me.”

Will fucked me as deep as he could, our mouths pressed together, breathing each other’s breaths.

“Did you like it, Will?” I taunted, taking back control. “Did you like watching me suck his cock?”

I could feel Will’s body starting to quiver.

“Did you like watching your wife get on her knees for another man?”

“Fuck!” Will growled with pleasure, his hazy eyes staring back at mine.

For the first time in my life, I could feel an orgasm building from the sensation of a man’s cock inside of me.

“Yes! Fuck me!” I whispered into his mouth. “Fuck me!”

Replaying in my mind the moment of the fall, that split second I first took Tom in my mouth, sent me over the edge.

“I’m gonna come! Fuck me! I’m coming...oh, god, I’m coming! I’m coming!”

My voice was filled with equal parts ecstasy and surprise. For the first time in my life, I came from having a man inside of me. It was wholly unexpected and amazing. Another first in an evening of firsts.

Despite his obvious desire, Will was having a difficult time coming. I knew it had to have been because he had come only a few minutes before while watching me and Tom. He pulled out and stood tall on his knees between my legs, stroking his cock with brutal force and gripping my knee with one hand. He was desperate to come again. I knew what he wanted.

“Did you see me come with his cock in my mouth? Is that what made you come?” I provoked.

“Fuck!”

“Or was it when you saw me swallow him?...”

“Or was it watching me lick his huge cock?...”

My teasing was visibly having the desired effect.

“His cock is so much bigger than yours,” I continued. “I could barely fit him in my mouth.”

Will moaned desperately. He’d never heard me talk like that before. I never had. I’d never even thought like that before.

“I couldn’t even wrap my hand all the way around it.”

Will panted, holding my menacing gaze. His eyes revealed his craving and his dread. “Did you hear the song?”

I knew exactly what he meant. Did I know that he wanted me to stop? Did I defy him so that I could go down on another man? I paused, debating the truth in my own mind and if I should tell my husband that truth.

“Yes,” I whispered, nodding slowly. “I heard the song, Will. I didn’t want to stop. I wanted to finish him.” I paused before offering a final confession, designed to bring Will the satisfaction he craved.

“I wanted to make him come in my mouth.”

A split second later, the first rope of Will’s come shot past my head, landing on the sheets behind me. The rest covered my torso before he collapsed on top of me. We laid there speechless and panting. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. Three Mississippi. Four Mississippi. Five. Will rolled off of me onto his back beside me and joined me in staring at the ceiling.

“Jesus Christ,” he finally uttered.

“Yeah,” I agreed.

“Did you seriously come...like...for real?”

“Yup.” My voice was monotone.

“Wow.”

“Yup,” I repeated, popping the “p”.

Will started to say something. I knew he was going to want to analyze the whole situation. I shut him down. “Not tonight. I don’t think I can process one more single solitary thing tonight.”

Will exhaled loudly through his nose. He wasn’t one to let things linger. When there was a problem, he liked to handle it immediately. Waiting was difficult for him. He much preferred handle things straight away. He loved efficiency. But he loved me more.

“Okay,” he relented, getting up to go to the bathroom.

I got the bed in order and got out some clean panties and a t-shirt. As soon as Will was done in the bathroom I went in and closed the door behind me. I took a shower and moved mindlessly through my bedtime routine. I was numb. I spent another ten minutes sitting on the edge of the tub with my head in my hands wishing for my mind to stop spinning and for Will to be asleep by the time I walked out. Neither wish came true.

Will’s light was off, but he was still awake when I came out of the bathroom. I crawled in on my side and turned out my light.

“Goodnight, baby,” he said.

“Goodnight.”

“Lily?”

“Yes.”

“I love you.”

“I love you, too.”

We both lay silently in the dark, trying to sleep. I couldn’t stop replaying what happened with Tom over and over in my mind. Finally, after

what seemed like forever, Will fell asleep. I made myself come again,  
giving me just enough relief to rest my head.

# CHAPTER 3

## *Negotiations*

I woke to the smell of coffee and could hear Will mucking around in the kitchen. I stayed in bed for several minutes, not wanting to face the conversation that I knew was coming. Will and I had sworn that, above all, we would always be honest with each other. I had stayed faithful to that promise, save for the little white lies everyone tells. I knew that if I was going to continue to stay true, it was going to be a difficult morning. I mustered my courage and surrendered to whatever consequences lie ahead.

I shuffled out to the kitchen. Will was standing at the sink. I kissed him from behind on the cheek like I always did and reached for my coffee mug. It was obvious that he had been up for a good while. He was showered, dressed, and cleaning up his breakfast dishes.

“Do you want something to eat?” he offered.

I shook my head. “Just coffee.” I took a seat at the island. Will dried his hands with a towel and sat across from me. I steeled myself.

“Who goes first?” he asked.

“You go first,” I answered.

“Okay,” he exhaled. “I’m not mad. I was. Really mad. Well, that’s not entirely true. I was angry...” Will looked down at the countertop like he was ashamed. “...but I was also incredibly turned on. What you did last night was the hottest thing I’ve ever seen.” He looked back up at me. “It was incredible. You were so sexy. I’ve never seen you like that before. And then afterwards, I think we can both agree, was mind-blowing. I’ve never seen you so free. I don’t know what else to say.”

I conceded his point with a small nod. I kept my voice as calm as his. “If you were so turned on, then why did you play the song? I don’t

mean that in a snarky way. I'm just trying to understand." I was careful with my tone to convey curiosity, not accusation.

Will took a breath before admitting, "I was afraid you were going to fuck him."

"I wouldn't do that," I reassured. "Did you come? Watching me?"

Will nodded his head.

"When? Which part?"

Will took a deep breath. I could tell he didn't want to admit what he was about to say. "As soon as you put your mouth on him."

"If you were worried that I was going to have sex with him, why didn't you come in and stop it yourself?"

"I don't know."

We sat in silence for a moment. It was the quietest our house had ever been.

"Did I really make you come last night?" he asked.

"Yes," I replied. Technically, I wasn't lying. It was Will who did, in fact, ultimately bring me to orgasm. But I knew damn well that it was really Tom that made it happen — or more accurately, whatever the hell was going on that Tom triggered inside of me.

Will took another deep breath. "Did you really like it?"

"Which part? The you making me come part, or the other thing?"

"The other thing."

It was my turn to take a deep breath. I reminded myself of our promise to always tell the truth and that it was the only way to get through this with a healthy, intact, marriage. I couldn't bring myself to look at Will when I answered. "Yes."

"All of it?"

I knew what he meant.

"Yes," I replied.

"I don't understand, Lily. Why? ... I mean, I ...you've never...I mean...?"

I rescued Will from his inability to form a complete sentence. “You mean, why did I do that for him when I never do it for you?”

“Yes.”

“I don’t know.”

“Did you want to fuck him?”

I tried to exhale every bit of the dread of this question that I could. I knew it was coming. I was going to craft my answer very carefully. I had been practicing in my head since I woke up. “Sitting here with you, no.” I forced myself to look Will dead in the eyes. “You are the only man I want to make love to. For the rest of my life.” I slowed my speech and chose my words very precisely. “But in the moment, last night, I worried that if, *if* you wanted me to, I would have.”

“So, you’re saying that last night, in the heat of the moment, you wanted to fuck him?”

“Yes.” I quickly clarified, “But I wouldn’t have unless you told me to.” I was honest, but I spoke in a tone that downplayed the magnitude of the word “yes.” There was no need for Will to know just how badly I had wanted Tom to take me.

Will nodded his head, looking down with concern.

“Will?” I prompted, to bring his gaze back to mine. “Be one hundred percent honest. Did you want to watch him fuck me?” I involuntarily squeezed my thighs together, imagining Tom bending me over the couch and taking me from behind while Will watched helplessly from outside.

Without hesitation, Will shook his head. “No. That’s why I changed the music. I can’t even process the thought of you being with another man like that.”

“Just to be clear, the *only* way I would have was if you told me that you wanted me to. He tried to take my panties off, and I stopped him.” Again, I spoke softly and minimized how difficult it was for me to deny Tom in that moment. At that point in my life, it was the thing of which I was most proud. But Will didn’t need to know that, either.

Will seemed satisfied with my answers—at least satisfied enough. He nodded. “Good. So now we know what we’re dealing with. You liked it. I liked it. Neither of us wants you to have sex with him. And it made us both so horny that we had the best sex of our lives, including me being able to make you orgasm during sex for the first time ever. No big deal. Does that about sum it up?” Will delivered his speech with the perfect blend of sarcasm and disbelief.

I sipped my coffee and matched my demeanor to his. “Pretty much, I guess.” I knew it was too much to ask for that to be the end of the conversation.

“So, the question now is, what do we want to do about it?” Will continued.

“What do you mean?”

“Should we do it again?”

I didn’t bother trying to conceal my irritation and surprise. “Are you fucking serious?”

Will looked inexplicably surprised at my reaction to his suggestion. “I thought you enjoyed it?”

I raised my voice further. “I did.”

“I mean, you have to admit, it was pretty amazing. We just talked about that. I’m not crazy, right?”

“No, it was.” I left out “dumbass,” but it was implied in my tone.

“Then what? Why don’t you want to do it again? I don’t get it.”

“Because we’re married!” I raised my voice another order of magnitude, over-annunciating each word for maximum effect, flabbergasted that I would even have to explain that.

“I’m not talking about fucking him,” Will defended. “I’m just talking about...you know...the same thing as last night.”

I was livid. “So, does it need to be Tom’s cock, or will any random stranger do?”

“Lily, calm down. We’re just talking. It’s okay. I’m just being honest. We tell the truth, right? Last night was huge turn on for me. Christ, I’ve jerked off twice this morning thinking about it. I’m hard right now! And judging by your reaction last night, I thought it was a huge turn on for you, too.”

Will’s inability to grasp what I was saying pushed me over the edge, and I completely lost what little cool I had left.

“It was, Will! But here’s what you’re not getting. Yes, I enjoyed it. Yes, it was a huge turn-on. Yes, it made me come. It was fucking amazing! The peak sexual experience of my life! And, yes, since we’re being honest, part of me wants to do it again! Part of me wants to march down to Tom’s place, get on my knees, and suck his dick again right now! Is that what you want to hear? But that’s not what it’s about. It’s about our marriage. It’s about being faithful. I sucked another man’s cock last night, Will! Doesn’t that bother you, at least on some level? Jesus! I want to be faithful to you. You’re my husband! I belong to you! No one else, you fucking asshole!”

I could see the expression on Will’s face changing from hope to shame. I lowered my voice to a more rational, yet still stern, timbre. “Grinding on some random fuckboy in a club and letting him cop a feel so you can get off isn’t the same thing as me getting on my knees and blowing the neighbor in our living room. I’m not going to do it again. No matter how fucking hot it makes either one of us, I’m not doing it.”

There was no mistaking how sincere my words were. By the time I finished ranting, it was clear from the look on Will’s face that no further argument was necessary. “Okay,” he replied definitively.

“Yes?” I demanded he clarify.

“Yes. I’m with you. One hundred percent.”

A wave of relief washed over me. “Good. Thank you,” I sighed.

“I love you, Lily.”

“I love you, too, Will.” I paused briefly. “Jackass,” I added, mostly lightheartedly.

I leaned across the island and kissed him. It was a formality. I was still angry, but I knew I would get over it. I could tell Will was about to

make a joke. It was how he always put the lid on uncomfortable situations.

“So, in lieu of sucking giant man cock, what would you like to do today?”

I almost spit out my coffee, grateful that it once again seemed certain we would make it the eleven weeks to our fifth anniversary.

Things managed to get back to normal fairly quickly. My daily routine did a good job of keeping my mind off of what happened with Tom. It took a little longer for things to resume in the bedroom, but within a few weeks, we were back to our old faithful routine. Will always went down on me straightaway to make sure I was taken care of. Sometimes, despite my best efforts, I couldn't help but imagine it was Tom with his head between my legs. Will did his best to make me come again during sex, but that, too, returned to its previous incarnation. A few times, Will made some subtle overtures to me about going down on him. I declined with equal subtlety. We didn't speak directly about it, but one morning at breakfast, Will probed a little.

“Lily, can I ask you a question?”

I could tell by his tone that it wasn't trivial. “Sure,” I replied as though it were.

“Is everything okay? I mean, you know, with us?”

“What are you talking about? Of course, it is.” And it was. It was fine. It wasn't nineteen-seventies key party exciting, but it was fine.

“You're...you know...satisfied?”

I kissed him on the mouth. “I wouldn't change a thing.”

“Okay. Just checking.”

And that was that. That is, until we both had a good bit to drink at a neighbor's party. It was the weekend just before our anniversary, and it was one of those nights when the booze hit the both of us just so. By the time we got home, we were eager to get at each other. Things started off the same as usual, just more intense. We kissed passionately as we undressed each other. Will laid me down on the bed and found his way between my legs with his tongue. After very nearly five years of marriage, he knew very well how to please me in that way. He took his time, more so than usual,

doing his best to make me come hard. He succeeded. Things changed, however, when he got on top of me. Will ran his shaft along my pussy, parting my labia and gliding it along my clitoris. It felt amazing, enough so that I wondered why we hadn't been doing that as a matter of course.

With the exception of the Fourth of July, Will and I weren't particularly verbal during sex. He would occasionally tell me how beautiful I was, or we'd say how much we loved each other. That's why, when Will started whispering in my ear while he teased me, I knew things were going to be different.

"You're so fucking sexy."

I felt him slide inside of me.

"You were so hot that night."

The image of looking up at Tom from my knees and the sensation of having him in my mouth washed over me. I exhaled. Will could tell that his prompt was having the desired effect.

"You were so free," he whispered, slowly fucking me.

"Yes," I whispered back.

"I couldn't believe it when you got on your knees..."

I exhaled deeply.

"The way you sucked his cock..."

The moment replayed in my mind. "Oh god...fuck me."

Will started fucking me just the way I liked, breathing heavily and moaning quietly into my ear. I could feel the beginnings of an orgasm building inside of me.

"You know what turned me on the most?" he asked.

I didn't answer, but I hummed my curiosity.

"I could tell how much you liked it."

"Fuck me," I whimpered.

Will pressed his thumb to my mouth. I parted my lips and sucked his thumb, remembering how I had sucked Tom's cock.

"I could tell how much you loved sucking his cock."

Will screwed me harder. I looked down to watch his cock working between my legs. I pretended it was Tom's.

"Yes! Fuck me!" I cried. I could feel it building. I could almost taste Tom in my mouth.

"You looked so fucking sexy with his cock in your mouth."

Just as I had the night of the Fourth, I came hard from the inside, sucking Will's thumb, thinking of taking Tom in my mouth, and the feeling it gave me - reliving the moment of the fall. Will fucked me through my orgasm until I went limp beneath him. Looking up and remembering where I was, I wrapped my legs around him.

"Are you gonna come for me, baby?" I prodded.

"Tell me!" he grimaced.

I paused, looking into his eyes. He was full of lust and jealousy.

"I wanted to, Will."

"Oh fuck," Will moaned.

"I wanted to suck his cock. As soon as I saw him in those tight shorts, I knew I wanted his cock."

"Yes."

"It was so beautiful." Then, I tested Will's limits. "So much bigger."

Will let out a pained exhale. I reveled in it.

"He has the perfect dick, Will. I wanted to wrap my hands around it...feel it in my mouth. I knew it was wrong, but I couldn't stop myself."

"Ugh," Will growled. I could tell he was holding back, trying not to come, wanting to hear more from me.

"I heard the song, Will. I did it anyway"

I knew he wasn't going to last much longer. I wanted to torture him more. I knew the thing he both dreaded and desperately wanted to hear. Something we'd talked around, but I'd never said out loud.

"But I wanted to make him come," I whispered in his ear.

Will pulled out and started jerking his cock onto my stomach, sneakily trying to aim it toward my face. I teased his glans with my fingertips, blocking his attempt with my palm.

“He tasted so good,” I taunted as he came.

“Oh fuck,” Will groaned, and he collapsed on his back next to me, his chest heaving. He was speechless. Will wasn’t often speechless.

My stomach and hand were covered in his load. I less than subtly reached for a tissue and began cleaning up the mess. I looked at Will as I did, underscoring the fact that I had never tasted him. We went to sleep without saying anything more than our usual goodnights.

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The plan for our fifth wedding anniversary was to have a quiet romantic dinner at home on the actual day and go out over the weekend. The day of our anniversary, however, I had to call Will and tell him I wasn’t feeling well. By the time he got home, I was in bed with the covers over my head. He doted on me like a faithful husband, but not too much. I think he learned his lesson in Atlanta. He graciously ate takeout alone at the kitchen island instead of having his favorite meal at the dining room table, cooked by his wife of exactly five years. By the weekend, however, I was feeling better. Will gifted me a beautiful green sapphire necklace with diamond accents that must have cost him a pretty penny. He also gave me a sexy, short, yellow babydoll dress that I knew was more for him than it was for me. It was a little too sexy to wear out and about, so I planned to put it on for him when we got home from the restaurant. I was excited to give Will what I bought him. It was an all-mahogany guitar that he had been obsessively perusing online for a while. He was thrilled. It didn’t seem to occur to him that in order to know which model to get, I had to have accessed his browser history.

Dinner at the restaurant was excellent, and everything was going well until our waiter appeared with a bottle of wine, “compliments of the gentleman seated in the corner.” Will and I looked over to see Tom raising his glass and smiling. Will and I smiled back.

“Should we go over?” Will asked.

Just as I was about to respond, I saw Tom helping his date up from her seat. He led her directly to our table.

“Hi guys. Happy anniversary,” he smiled.

“How did you know?” Will asked.

“Same waiter,” he replied.

I didn’t recall telling our waiter it was our anniversary. Maybe Will did.

“This is Julie,” Tom gestured to the voluptuous blonde next to him. I immediately judged her as being largely the product of plastic surgery and makeup, with her sizeable chest and unnaturally plump lips. Other than the fact that we were both female, we were nearly complete opposites.

“Nice to meet you,” I smiled.

“Well, we don’t want to interrupt. I just wanted to say hello,” Tom explained.

Will expressed his genuine appreciation. It was, in fact, a sweet gesture on Tom’s part. “Thank you, Tom. That was very thoughtful of you. You’ll have to come by the house sometime and play guitar again.”

Tom bid us a goodnight and was on his way. Will and I exchanged a look but said nothing more about Tom for the rest of dinner. I’m embarrassed to admit it, but I spent most of the rest of our anniversary dinner picking Julie apart in my mind. By the time we were in the car on the way home, I’d made a decision. I looked over at Will in the driver’s seat. I could see he had an erection. I wondered if it was because seeing Tom triggered memories of the Fourth of July or if it was because he knew he was going to have anniversary sex when we got home.

“I’ll do it,” I announced.

“Do what?” Will asked, obviously having no idea what I was referring to.

“Tom.”

Will turned his head toward me in disbelief and had to snap his attention back to the road after almost running onto the curb. “Are you serious?” he asked.

“Do you not want me to?”

We had the good fortune to get stopped at a light. “Only if you do.”

My breath was shallow and nervous.

“I want to,” I breathed, wondering if I was opening Pandora’s box.

Will did his best to be subtle, but in my peripheral vision, I saw him move his hand to the bulge in his pants.

“I’ll do it,” I repeated, subtly nodding my head, trying to sound more convincing. Unlike the first time, I looked Will in the eye. “No sex,” I clarified. “That would be cheating. My panties stay on at all times.”

Will nodded in agreement.

“Definitely no sex. And never without me there. And never in our bed. Ever.” His voice was stern, but I could hear the eagerness barely hiding under his tone.

“One more thing,” I added. “Anything Tom and I do, beyond kissing, I stop doing with you. That’s non-negotiable. Think of it as a guardrail.” Seeing as the plan was only to give Tom a blowjob, and that wasn’t something I did for Will anyway, it wasn’t much of a price to pay. It seemed like a silly thing to say, but it felt kind of like an insurance policy against things going too far.

“Fair enough,” Will replied.

And thus, the rules for our little game were set while waiting for a stoplight to turn green. We weren’t far from home. The tension in the air on the ride was palpable. Will parked the car in the garage. I got out and walked to the door, knowing Will was watching me. As I crossed the threshold into the house, I lifted my skirt. When Will walked in, I was bent over the dining room table with my panties around my thighs, waiting for him. I didn’t need any foreplay. I was ready for him when he hurried to put himself inside of me. I had been ready since the restaurant.

Will started fucking me steadily straightaway. Neither of us said anything at first until Will finally grunted, “Tell me!”

I looked back at him. I knew what he wanted to hear.

“Tell me!” he barked.

“I want to suck his cock again, Will,” I whimpered. Saying it out loud only added to my pleasure.

Will grunted again and dug his fingers into my hips, gripping them harder as he fucked me.

I panted, looking over my shoulder, trying to see the look on Will’s face.

“Don’t stop,” I ordered.

Will wasn’t going to last long. I knew he was holding back so that I could come.

“Do you want to watch me?” I goaded. “Do you want to jerk your cock and watch me get on my knees for him?”

I was getting closer.

“Do you want to watch me suck that big cock again? Do you want to watch me beg another man to come in my mouth?”

That was it for me. Just saying it out loud sent me over the edge. As soon as I finished coming, Will pulled out and finished on my ass, still obeying the rules regardless of how heated the moment was. We had always been steadfastly ethical, the two of us. My torso fell limp onto the table with Will on top of me, kissing my shoulders.

“Are you absolutely sure?” he whispered.

“Yes,” I whispered back, staring at the wood grain of the tabletop.

The next day, Will texted me while I was at the grocery store.

Pick up some extra booze. Tom is coming over for drinks tonight.

The butterflies started immediately. I felt like I was in the front cart, leaving the platform of my favorite roller coaster—only better. I knew I only had a few hours to get ready. Just like the Fourth of July, when Tom arrived, I was in the pool. This time, I wore my black bikini. It was just as skimpy, but not see-through like my white one. As planned, Will flashed the outdoor lights when Tom arrived. I waited several minutes before I got out of the pool and rinsed myself off in the shower. I wanted to give Tom

enough time to get at least one or two drinks in him. I took my time in the shower and put on a bit of a show for the boys in case they were watching. Then I dabbed myself dry and made another show of putting on a little bit of oil. I walked into the house and found Will and Tom in the office playing guitar. Tom stood up and set his guitar down as I came in.

“Hey, Lily,” he smiled.

I walked straight to him and kissed him. Tom looked surprised. Will obviously had not told him why he was there.

“It’s okay,” I whispered. I kissed him again. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. Three Mississippi. I eased my tongue into his mouth. We kissed more and more passionately until I guided his head to my neck. I looked over at Will, sitting only a few feet away. His mouth was open, and I could see a bulge in his shorts. I reached behind my neck and untied the top knot of my bikini. I untied the lower knot and let my top fall to the floor. Tom didn’t need any encouragement to find his way to a nipple. With his hand supporting me in the small of my back, I leaned back just enough so Will could watch. If Will objected to me letting Tom usurp my breasts, he gave no indication. He just squeezed his hardon through his shorts.

I lifted Tom’s t-shirt over his head and started kissing him again, my bare chest pressing against his. His skin felt amazing against mine. Tom’s hands found their way to my barely covered ass. He made a move to slip a finger between my legs and under my bikini bottom. I stopped him and guided his hand to my mound from the front, over the material of my bikini. I pulled his face to my breast as he began rubbing my pussy. I started breathing heavily and cooing my pleasure. I reached into either side of Tom’s shorts, pulling them wide and sliding them down until gravity took them to his ankles. I did the same for his boxers. I took his already hard cock in my hand and began gently stroking it. Tom and I stood just inside arm’s length, looking into each other’s eyes as we masturbated each other. I let myself forget that my husband was watching and gave myself over to the moment. Tom locked into my rhythm, and soon I was on the verge of orgasm.

“Oh fuck,” I cooed, staring into his green eyes. “I’m gonna come.”

Tom pulled me closer and took my nipple in his mouth, gently nibbling it as I came.

“Yes! Yes! Yes!” I whimpered.

He held me, supporting my weight as my knees nearly buckled. I kissed him again, still gripping his cock. I started kissing my way down his torso until again, I was on my knees in front of him, looking up hungrily with his cock inches from my mouth. My mouth started watering, forcing me to swallow. I looked over at Will. He had taken his cock out and was slowly stroking it as he watched me. I shifted on my knees so that I could look at Will with Tom’s shaft in front of me. Will stared at me intently, looking drunk on a cocktail of agony and desire. Staring my husband in the eyes, I licked the length of Tom’s shaft. Will’s breathing changed, becoming so shallow that it was almost like he was holding his breath. I licked Tom’s length again. I circled the head of his cock with my tongue and kissed it again and again, making eye contact my husband while I worshiped another man. Tom’s cock was twitching in response to my relentless teasing. I shifted my stance again until I was staring up at Tom, gently tonguing the underside of his cockhead. I gave Will one more glance, knowing it would be the last time I looked at him until I had what I wanted. Then finally, I turned my attention solely to the task in front of me. I took the first few inches in my mouth, tonguing the underside as I did.

“Oh fuck,” Tom moaned.

I efforted to open my mouth further to accommodate Tom’s girth, but I was still only able to take half of him in my mouth. I stroked the base with my hand as I bobbed up and down on what I could of his shaft. Tom gripped my hair in one hand and pushed me further down until I gagged. He pulled me off, and I looked up at him, slobber dripping from my face, my chest heaving.

“Fuck yes,” I growled. I still couldn’t understand how contented I was by being so subservient to that man.

Tom pushed me back down onto his cock for more. He gripped the sides of my head and started fucking my mouth. I kept my balance by putting my hands on his thighs. Eventually, he let me go and left me to suck

him again as I saw fit. I sucked, jerked, kissed, and licked until he was ready to come. I loved every second of it even if I was still clueless as to how that man had such power over me.

“Come in my mouth again,” I said, looking up at him and jerking the tip of his cock.

“Oh fuck,” Tom growled. “Yes!”

“Yes!” I echoed.

I latched onto his cock with my mouth, bobbing as quickly as I could on the head as I jerked his shaft with one hand and massaged his balls with the other. And even though I was much more prepared for his load this time, I let it get messy, knowing that Will would want to see—or to be more honest, knowing that it would both titillate and torment him.

“Oh my god,” Tom sighed.

I stood up and whispered in Tom’s ear, “Meet us in the pool.”

I looked over at Will, my face a mess. He had come all over his t-shirt but was still gripping his hard cock. I didn’t say a word to him as I slowly sauntered out of the office and down the hall. I looked back to see Will following. As I crossed the threshold into our bedroom, I simultaneously untied both sides of my bikini bottoms and let them fall to the floor. I got on all fours on the bed and presented myself to Will for the taking.

“That was amazing, Lily,” he gushed as he entered the room.

“Shut up and fuck me,” I demanded.

Will lined up behind me and slid his cock inside. “Oh my god. You’re so wet.”

“Shut up!” I barked. “Don’t talk. Just fuck me.”

Will didn’t need to be told again. I bucked back against him as he fucked me, pretending the entire time it was Tom.

“Yes!” I whimpered. “Fuck me...make me come!”

I replayed the scene from the office in my mind as Will fucked me. He flipped me over onto my back and got on top of me. He kissed me as he put himself back inside of me. Will kissed his way down my neck, making

his way to my breasts. I grabbed his head in my hands and pulled him back up.

“Those are Tom’s now, remember?” I spoke.

Will’s only reply was to fuck me harder. His reaction turned me on. It wasn’t long before I was ready to climax.

“Yes! Fuck me! Fuck me!” I screamed, wanting Tom to hear. Finally, I came hard and went loose on the mattress. Will continued trying to fuck me but I pushed him away. I knew he wouldn’t be able to come again so soon.

“Save it for later. I’ll suck him again out at the pool,” I told him.

Will continued stroking his cock hopefully. I yanked his hand away and pulled him up from the bed. “Come on,” I said, kissing him on the cheek. “Tom’s waiting.”

I put my bikini bottoms back on and made my way to the kitchen. I fixed myself a drink and grabbed a beer for Tom. It gave me a moment alone to reflect on what had just happened. It was thrilling to taunt Will with Tom right in front of him. Sexually, it was fantastic. I loved the way Will took me afterward. But it was still missing something that was there the first time. I didn’t get my rollercoaster moment. The fall. My fix. Just an echo. I walked outside topless to find Tom sitting on the steps of the pool. I went down on him two more times that night before he left.

And so, it began. Saturdays with Tom.

CHAPTER 4

Bottoms

“Hi, Mom.”

“Hi, Hon. You sound happy.”

“Do I not usually sound happy?”

“You know what I mean. Did something happen?”

“Do I need a reason to be in a good mood all of the sudden?”

“Is Will taking you to another roller coaster or something?”

“Not exactly.”

“What does that mean?”

“Don’t worry about it.”

“Fine. Sometimes it’s like pulling teeth to get you to tell me anything. How’s Will? Is he as happy as you?”

“He’s good.”

“And Sally? I haven’t seen her in forever. You need to bring her next time you come home.”

“She’s good, too. Nothing new.”

“She hasn’t left Eric yet?”

“No, Mom. Of course, not.”

“She could do better.”

“I know. You’ve said that a thousand times.”

“Oh, I almost forgot. Somebody from your daddy’s old AA group called me. They were asking about a memorial service.”

“Ugh, Mom. I don’t even want to think about that. I don’t know any of those people, anyway.”

“Okay. Okay. Don’t shoot the messenger.”

“Sorry. I just don’t want to talk about it. Okay?”

“Okay.”

“Listen, I’ve got to go. A friend of ours just came over for a visit.”

“Okay, hon. I love you. Have fun.”

“I will. Bye.”



The next few months seemed to fly by. Every Saturday, without fail, Tom came to the house. He and Will played guitar. We ate good food and imbibed. We talked about movies and music, never politics or religion. But mostly, Will pleased himself to the sight of his wife topless and on her knees for another man. As agreed, our frolicking never crossed the threshold into the bedroom, and my panties always stayed on. Through their thin layer of chastity, however, Tom became a master at pleasing me with his fingers like I was one of Will’s guitars. Gone, or at least on hold, were the amusement park pilgrimages. To say that I had found a new drug, one that Will and I could both enjoy, would fall just short of the whole truth. What I had found was a glorious, relentless pursuit of my new favorite drug. Ever since my first time with Tom, I couldn’t quite reach the same pinnacle. No matter how hard I tried, I couldn’t duplicate the magic. I’m not talking about orgasms. I had an abundance of those, from both Tom and Will. Myself, too. One of my favorite things had become making myself climax with Tom’s cock in my mouth while taking in my husband’s broken-hearted stare. The boys both seemed to like it, too, unsurprisingly. What I struggled with, rather, was reaching that same euphoria I felt that first time with Tom. I could get so close, but never quite there. It was maddening.

Sex with Will was never better. Even when it wasn’t Saturday, our sex life revolved around taunting each other with references to our playtime with Tom. We both loved it, and even though we were reluctant to admit it at first, we eventually embraced the fact that we, both individually and as a couple, derived so much pleasure from our interactions with a gruff retired

marine twenty years our senior. Before Tom, I never knew sex could be so amazing. Still, I was endlessly frustrated, trying to reach that pinnacle I felt the first time with him.

The week of Christmas, we had a bout of unseasonably warm weather. I decided to lay out by the pool. I knew I wouldn't really be able to get any sun. I had something else in mind. I wore the same white bikini bottoms I had on the Fourth of July. I didn't bother with the top. It wouldn't have lasted long, anyway, and any mystique surrounding my breasts was long gone. As the sun started waning later in the afternoon, I rinsed myself off in the warm water of the outdoor shower. Will and Tom came outside, drinks in hand. Apparently, Tom had already been there for nearly an hour.

"Why didn't you come say hello?" I asked. My feelings were a little hurt that he'd completely ignored me in favor of my husband.

"I don't know. Just got caught up looking at you, I guess. You looked so perfect, I didn't want you to move," he answered.

I tiptoed up and kissed him. "Good answer," I smiled. I started dabbing myself dry and asked Will to go inside and pour me a glass of wine. "Tom, could you help me with this?" I asked, handing him the little bottle of coconut oil I kept by the shower. It was no mystery to either of us what was going to happen next.

"Sure," he answered.

Tom started with my back, then moved to massaging my neck. From there, he wrapped his arms around me from behind and oiled my breasts while he kissed my neck. I turned around and kissed him. By the time Will returned with my wine, Tom was sucking my nipple and playing with me through my bikini bottom. I wondered what it was like for Will to see Tom sucking my nipple, knowing that he wasn't allowed anymore. I felt a tingle.

"You kids didn't waste any time, did you?" Will joked. Even though we'd been at it for weeks, Will's voice sounded a little awkward.

"Let's go inside," I proposed, pulling Tom by the hand past Will, ignoring the glass of wine he had poured for me.

I was already pretty worked up and ready to get to what it was we were all there for. Once inside, I laid a clean towel on the couch. Will sat next to it while Tom and I picked up where we left off. Between kisses,

fondles, nibbles, and pets, I managed to get Tom's clothes off. I sat down on my towel next to Will and started sucking Tom's cock. Like so many times before, I marveled at how much I enjoyed something I used to think was whorish and disgusting. Now I loved it. I loved how it made me feel powerful and subservient at the same time. I loved how I had become so good at it that I could make Tom come exactly when I wanted or edge him indefinitely at my discretion. I loved the sense of accomplishment I felt when I finished him off and the fact that I had learned to love his taste. And when I was in the right mood, I even loved the freedom I felt when I let go of my inhibitions and let him cover my face and chest. I just had to be prepared, though, because anytime that happened, Will would immediately drag me back to the bedroom with a complete absence subtlety.

While I serviced Tom's cock, Will undressed himself and began masturbating. I leaned back on the couch and pushed down on Tom's hips with my feet, signaling to him that I was ready to be tended to for a while. I knew this was generally Will's least favorite part of the festivities. He would much prefer to watch me wrapping my lips around Tom's meaty shaft, but I didn't care. I wanted to come.

Tom willingly dropped to his knees between my legs. He loved making me come. I spread my legs wide and draped one leg over Tom's shoulder, the other over Will's leg next to me. Tom began gently rubbing my pussy through the thin nylon of my bikini. I leaned my head back and let my eyelids droop while I enjoyed his touch. I relaxed into the moment. Every now and then, I glanced at Will to enjoy the look on his face. There was always a hint of pain behind his pleasure that, for some sick reason, added to my enjoyment.

My new favorite thing had become Tom kissing my inner thighs while he played with my pussy. It was something he'd only started doing recently and was so teasingly delightful. He led with his tongue, followed by his lips, on the sensitive, soft skin of my inner thigh. It didn't break the rules, but only just barely. The only thing between his tongue and my clitoris was a distance of a few inches and a thin layer of soaking wet fabric. I looked at Will and exhaled my pleasure through pursed lips. Tom was teasing me relentlessly, not letting me come. Like I could with him, he had the ability to edge me or make me climax almost entirely at will. I

became more and more intoxicated by his relentless teasing. I hadn't had a sip of my wine, yet my head was spinning.

"Please?" I quietly begged. Tom ignored me and still wouldn't let me come.

My stomach and chest were heaving, and my insides were pulsating. Out of the blue, I got the same feeling I always did as the cart ticked up the track to the first peak. Tom's teasing had me the closest I had been to my fix since the first time I was with him. In my mind, I felt the cart level off at the top, and the drop come into view. I knew what I needed to do to finally get what I had been chasing for weeks. I looked at Will, my eyes glazed over, my breathing hypnotic, and my jaw slack with desire. I took the strings of my bikini bottoms between my fingertips and pulled, removing the only barrier between Tom's mouth and my bare pussy.

"Ooh," I howled when Tom's tongue found its way to my clitoris. At last, the fall. My fix. Tom wasted no time devouring my cunt. I squeezed his head between my thighs, moaning the most obscene things as I finally came. Will's face was glorious. He took such pride in going down on me and fulfilling me. Now I was giving that privilege to another man, leaving him in suspense as to when I would allow him to taste me again. When I released Tom from my clutches, his face was almost blue from lack of oxygen. He kissed his way up my mound, to my stomach, then to my breasts, until he reached my mouth. I could taste myself on his tongue. At the same time, his cock came to rest between my legs. He instinctively slid his cock along my folds. Before I could even process what was happening, Will yanked me sideways onto the couch by my leg and buried his cock inside of me. He fucked me like a madman. I reached for Tom's cock with my mouth. He gladly met me halfway.

Even though I was the one who had broken the rules, there was also an unwritten rule that Will and I did not have sex in front of Tom. I was pissed. Adding to my irritation was the fact that he didn't use a condom. I had let Will know a few months before that I had started having

complications with my birth control and needed to stop taking it for a few months. We'd been using condoms ever since. He fucking knew better. I didn't push him off of me, but I glared at him as he fucked me, making it clear to him that I was far more interested in finishing off Tom's cock than his. The look of pain on his face was exquisite. I goaded him further by taking as much of Tom's load on my face as possible and made a show of sloppily cleaning his cock. That sent Will over the edge. He tried to bring his cock to my face as he was finishing himself off, but I pressed my feet into his belly and pushed him back, leaving him to come clumsily into the air and make a mess on the couch as he fell backwards. All three of us lingered in the awkwardness of the moment until Will gave Tom a look, letting him know he needed to leave. I knew there was no way Tom was afraid of my husband. Even if they weren't friends by that point, which they were, there was no way Will could best Tom in any kind of fight. Tom quickly gathered his things out of respect, though, and left.

With equal haste, Will put his clothes back on and screamed, "What the fuck!" just before he slammed the door to the garage behind him. I heard Will's tires squeal as he pulled away. I took a shower and masturbated, replaying in my mind the look on Will's face when I pulled my bikini strings and gave my pussy to Tom. I didn't worry about Will. He was angry, but I knew he was also likely to be somewhere in his car masturbating, reliving the sight of Tom's head between my legs. I don't know what time he got home that night. I was sound asleep.

Will was in the bed next to me when I woke up the next morning. I didn't have to get close to him to smell the scotch. I slid out of bed, doing my best not to not wake him. I don't know if it was the noise or the smell of the eggs I was making that woke him up, but Will came shuffling in toward the coffeepot. Neither of us said a word. I didn't even turn around. I could tell by the sound of his breathing that he was still angry. I set the eggs aside, turned off the stove, and walked back to the bedroom. Will followed me. I was standing in front of the dresser, wrangling my hair into a ponytail,

when Will dropped to his knees behind me and yanked down my pajama pants, taking my panties with them. He tried to nuzzle his face between my legs. I turned around and pushed his head away. He tried again, and I slapped him in the face.

“No!” I barked.

Will yelled back, “You broke the rules!”

He stood up and got in my face. I’d never seen him like that before. I liked it.

“If you didn’t want it to happen, then you should have stopped him!” I taunted.

“You fucking whore!” Will growled.

“Oh, now I’m a whore? Now that I get a little of what I’ve been giving? It’s all about you, isn’t it? The only thing that matters is what gets *you* off.”

Will spun me around and bent me over the top of the dresser. Fortunately, the drawer right next to me was the one that had the condoms in it. I opened the drawer, leaving it to Will to reach inside. He pulled them out as fast as he could, clumsily dropping the box. I was already wet thinking about the ways I was going to taunt him. He finally got the condom on and started fucking me, thrusting forcefully, purging his insecurities.

“Why didn’t you stop him, Will?” I taunted.

“Fuck you!” he barked.

“Now you don’t get to taste your wife anymore.”

“Oh fuck,” Will moaned.

“The only thing left for you is to fuck me with a stupid condom on.”

“Yes,” Will grunted. It sounded like it was an accident that he said it out loud.

I continued goading Will relentlessly. “You liked watching Tom take that away from you, didn’t you? Just like my tits. You like seeing me give myself to a real man.”

“Ugh,” Will groaned. My arrows were finding their mark.

“You can’t get enough of watching me suck such a big cock while you sit there by yourself, stroking your average little dick. You wish you were as much of a man as he is.”

“Fuck you,” Will retaliated.

He slapped my ass. It wasn’t hard. I could tell he had held back. I reached back and pushed the offending hand away.

“He made me come so hard, Will.”

Will fucked me harder. He was panting and sweating, trying desperately to come.

“Better than you...he knows my body so well.”

I thought that would have done it, but still, Will couldn’t come.

“Are you having trouble, dear?” I said condescendingly. “Do you need Tom to come over and come on my face again so you can finish?”

“Fuck,” he exhaled with a guttural snarl.

Almost there...

“Or I guess maybe now...since the rules have changed...he could come all over my pussy?”

That was it. Even though he was wearing a condom, I pulled away. Will jerked himself into the condom, looking like he knew very well how pathetic it must have seemed to an audience. When he was done, he peeled it off and went to flush it down the toilet. I stopped him.

“No!” I scolded. “You’ll clog the pipes. Then we’ll have to call Tom to come and fix it. Throw it in the trash!”

Will tossed the condom in the trash can and got in the shower. I snuck off to the gym just to get away from the house. When I got home,

Will and I were civil, but things were still awkward for the rest of the day. He started drinking well before the sun went down. That night, as we were both reading before bed, Will noticed a bruise on my leg from where he had yanked me across the couch.

“I’m sorry,” he said, gently rubbing the mark. “I thought you were going to fuck him.”

“I wouldn’t do that,” I replied flatly, never looking up from my book.

Will turned off his light and rolled onto his side. “Goodnight... I love you.”

I looked at the back of his head. “I love you, too, Will.” It was true. I still loved him. I just wished I knew why I loved hurting him so much.

At some point during the week, Will must have smoothed things over with Tom. I wasn’t privy to it. Will approached me on Thursday and asked if I still wanted Tom to come over that weekend.

“I’ll leave that up to you,” I said. I waited to see if, even after all that had happened, after all I had taken from him, after all the demeaning things I had said to him, he would still want to share me with another man.

“Just, please, Lily. Don’t fuck him.”

I nodded. Will turned and left the room. The next thing I heard was ice being dropped into a tumbler. Tom came over that Saturday. And the Saturday after that. And the one after that. The renegotiation of the rules, if you could call it that, opened a new world of possibilities. Tom, having already mastered my clitoris, found my G-spot and made good use of it. I also discovered the joys of a sixty-nine. Coming from having my pussy eaten while sucking my favorite cock became an unexpected joy. Will got fully in the spirit of things and gifted me a dildo. Despite it being black, I’m sure it was no mistake that it was similar in size and shape to Tom’s

cock. It wasn't quite as girthy, but close enough. All the while, Tom and I were very careful to keep his cock on his side of the fifty-yard line.

CHAPTER 5

The Dress

“So, Tom’s coming over tonight,” I reminded Will as I put the steaks in the fridge. It was Valentine’s Day. I knew Will didn’t need reminding, but I wanted to set the stage for what I had planned for the evening. We had just gotten back from the store and were putting away our week’s groceries. Will was putting up the cereal in the pantry.

“Leave the steaks out. I’ll cook them for dinner,” he said.

“I don’t want to eat too heavy tonight,” I countered. “A full stomach is kind of the last thing I want, if you know what I mean.”

Will smirked knowingly. “Fair enough. I’ll cook them tomorrow. We’ll just graze today.”

I smiled back. “I was thinking maybe we could do something a little different tonight.”

“Like what?” Will asked, still stocking the pantry.

“Hear me out first, okay?” I pleaded before continuing. Will looked at me curiously but didn’t say anything. “You know how things have been getting maybe a little bit stale?”

“You mean with Tom?”

“Yeah. I mean, it’s still fun, but don’t you think it’s missing some of the excitement it had in the beginning?”

“I suppose a little. What did you have in mind?” I knew that Will was actually quite content with the way things were. I wasn’t. I carried on anyway.

“Don’t get me wrong,” I hedged. “It’s been great. I love getting you all worked up and torturing you,” I flirted.

“C’mon now,” Will teased back. “You’re not doing it *just* for me.”

I gave him a guilty smile, but I knew that he wanted me to enjoy it. In fact, the more I enjoyed it, the more it got him off. I’d had the conversation we were about to have so many times in my head; I had prepped for his every move and my every response. I stepped closer and put my arms around his neck.

“You know, in some ways, I feel closer to you than ever since we started playing with Tom. I’m just saying that our little game isn’t as fresh as it was. Don’t you want a little more of that initial excitement?”

Will was getting suspicious. “What are you getting at, babe?”

“What if...” I tiptoed up and whispered in Will’s ear. “...Tom and I fool around in our bed tonight?”

Even though I had broken the rules in the past, it had always been in the heat of the moment. This was calculated. I had formally challenged one of Will’s rules. The question hung in the air for a moment.

“I thought we agreed we wouldn’t do that.”

“I know, baby. I just thought it would be a little bit extra naughty. Remember how taboo that first night was? Remember how good it felt?”

Will’s face looked reluctant, but I knew my husband. I kissed him on the mouth. “Are you okay, baby?” I asked as I moved my hand down to the front of his pants. I could feel him already getting hard. I gave him some help.

“Fuck me,” Will whispered.

“Yeah?” I teased. “You want to fuck me?” I squatted down in front of him and kept rubbing his cock through his pants. I could feel how hard he was. “So, you do like the idea of me sucking Tom’s cock in our bed...”

Will stared back at me. I knew he was torn. I had agreed, but Will was the one who insisted on keeping our bedroom sacred. I knew that it was a big deal to him. That made it taboo. That made me want it. I unbuttoned his pants and took his cock out. The head was already starting to drip with precum. I started spreading it around with my thumb.

“You’re so hard thinking about it, aren’t you?”

I looked up at Will, staring into his eyes. I stroked his shaft gently. I moved my mouth closer to his cock as I slowly jerked him off. I licked my lips and inspected how hard he was for me.

“Do you want me to lay him down in our bed, right where you sleep, where you and I make love, and take his big, beautiful cock in my mouth?”

Will exhaled with pleasure.

“Do you want me to suck another man’s dick in the place I promised was just for you?” I taunted some more, opening my mouth and licking my lips just millimeters from Will’s cock.

“Please?” my husband begged in a desperate, whispered tone.

“You want me to suck your cock so bad, don’t you?” I said quietly, staring at his erection.

I dribbled my spit onto the tip of his dick and worked it down his shaft with my hand. I stroked him some more, letting him see me contemplate breaking my self-imposed rule of reserving my mouth for Tom.

“Please?” Will whispered again.

I gripped Will’s cock by the base and pointed it upward. Will stared with his mouth open, breathing heavily as I moved my head forward, pressed my tongue to the underside of his shaft, and began kissing it.

“Oh, fuck yes,” Will sighed.

“You’ve never felt how good I can suck a cock now, have you?” I teased. “How many times have I had you in my mouth our whole relationship? Two? Maybe three times? I used to hate it. I had no idea what I was doing. I only did it because I love you.”

I ran my tongue up his length, all the way to the tip, taking my time.

“Now I love it. How many times do you think have I’ve sucked Tom’s cock? It has to be dozens at this point, right? How does it feel to know that he’s the only one who knows what a good little cocksucker your wife is?”

Will groaned quietly. Again, I kissed and tongued my way up Will’s shaft. When I reached the tip, I gripped his cock and looked up at him, his

dick directly in front of my open mouth.

“Please?” he begged.

“Sorry, baby. I only suck Tom’s cock. Remember?”

I squeezed Will’s shaft and jerked it until he came. It didn’t take long. I kept going until he was completely spent, hunched over and speechless. I stood up and kissed him sweetly. Without saying a word, I washed my hands in the sink, dried them, and walked out of the room, leaving Will to clean up the mess, looking dazed and foolish with his pants around his ankles.

We largely avoided each other for the afternoon while we awaited Tom’s arrival. I showered and shaved, making sure there wasn’t a single unwanted hair. Will waited in the living room, sipping single malt while I got dressed. I knew exactly what I was going to wear. The pale yellow babydoll dress was one of Will’s gifts to me for our last anniversary. It was both pretty and sexy, the way I wanted to be. It was held up by two spaghetti straps leading to a modest v-cut front. The skirt began just below the bust and flowed downward to my upper thigh. Underneath the flowered see-thru lace of the skirt was a thin, yellow liner. It was a beautiful dress, just a little too short and a little too sexy to be worn out and about. It was perfect, however, for my purposes that evening. Just before the ever-punctual Tom was due to arrive, I sauntered into the living room and did a little spin for Will.

“Do I look okay?” I asked. I watched Will’s reaction intently, knowing that he knew the significance of my dress as well as I did. I wondered if wearing his anniversary gift in bed with another man would be too much for him and he would ask me to change.

“Beautiful,” Will replied, staring at me. There was a reason he had picked out that dress. I could see how much he wanted me, and I knew that if it weren’t for the fact that it was our day to play with Tom, he would be trying to ravage me. I did another slow turn, letting Will gawk some more. I couldn’t help but start priming him.

“Do you think Tom will like it?” I asked. As soon as those words were out of my mouth, the doorbell rang. I smiled like a little girl on Christmas morning and rushed to open the door. Will followed me.

“There he is,” I smiled at Tom. I gave him a hug and a kiss on the cheek.

I fixed everyone drinks. Tom and I sat on the couch while Will sat in a chair across from us. This part had played itself out many times before. The normal routine was to have a few drinks, and then Tom and I would start fooling around. Sometimes we stayed on the couch. Sometimes we moved the coffee table and got on the rug in front of Will while he sat in the chair and took care of himself. That night, I knew, would be different. I was nervous.

With each round of drinks, I sat closer and closer to Tom. By his third beer, I was practically in his lap with my arms hugging his bicep. I kissed his cheek. Tom turned his head, and we began making out on the couch like a couple of teenagers while my husband looked on. After a few minutes, I stood up and took Tom’s hands in mine.

“Come with me,” I directed and pulled him up from the couch. I looked at Will as I disappeared behind the wall on my way to the bedroom. I let him see the anticipation in my eyes.

I had already placed a chair facing the bed, close enough to barely leave Will any leg room. When he walked in, Tom and I were standing at the foot of the bed, kissing. There was a different air in the room. Even though we were only twenty feet away from where Tom and I had been almost completely naked together so many times, moving things to the bedroom was hugely symbolic. At the beginning of our little adventure, Will and I had agreed to keep certain things just for us. Intercourse with Tom was strictly off the table at both our behests. And even though it was a good deal more comfortable than the couch or the living room floor, Will had insisted on keeping our marital bed sacred. It was intentionally the first thing we bought together as a married couple, and we both viewed it as being more than a piece of furniture

Once Will sat down, I lifted Tom’s shirt over his head. Instead of tossing it aside as usual, I folded it neatly and placed it carefully on the dresser. Then I kneeled in front of him to remove his pants slowly and deliberately. Again, I folded them and placed them on the dresser. It played out as a ritual, like a Japanese tea ceremony where every move is choreographed and executed to perfection. Tom stood patiently as, finally, I

lowered his underwear, folded them, and placed them on the dresser. I guided Tom down to the bed, leading him to lie down with his head on Will's pillow, his manhood directly in Will's line of sight.

I crawled across the mattress and laid down next to Tom on the far side of Will. Tom and I kissed as I slowly stroked his cock. I looked at Will. He was staring intently at my hand on Tom's shaft. I kissed my way down Tom's chest until my head reached his crotch. As many times as I had played with Tom's cock, it never failed to impress me with how thick and substantial it was. Holding it in front of me, I watched Will scoot his chair forward just a bit more. He and I stared at each other as I started licking Tom's length. Will began rubbing himself through his pants. I turned my full attention to Tom's cock, trusting that Will wouldn't miss a single lick, nibble, or taste. I pulled out all of the stops, putting on my best show for Will's benefit, all the while edging Tom. I was in no rush. I wanted to take my time and enjoy it.

Will stood up and took off his shirt, followed by his pants and boxers. He sat back down in the chair, naked, leaning forward, and putting his view barely a foot away from my wanton display. I shifted to my knees between Tom's legs and continued.

"Do I look pretty in my anniversary present?" I asked Will and circled the head of Tom's prick with my tongue. I knew that was a loaded question. Even though Will had bought it for me, I hadn't worn it for him yet. I'd given that honor to Tom.

Will didn't reply. He just continued stroking his cock as I performed for him. He was in no rush, either. My eyes were growing hazy with lust. I tongued my way up Tom's chest until I was straddling him while we kissed. I reached under my skirt and gently teased the head of his cock with my fingertips out of view. I sat up, still playing with the tip of Tom's dick under my skirt. Simultaneously, I began rocking back and forth along his shaft. This had long been against the rules. I waited for Will's reaction. He said nothing. Did nothing. I bent down and kissed Tom deeply one more time before sitting back up and grinding in his lap again. I didn't make any attempt to hide how good it felt. I put one hand on Tom's chest and the other on his leg to balance myself as I got myself off, my hips moving faster and faster, edging myself closer and closer to orgasm. I looked over my shoulder directly at Will and cooed my pleasure. Will stared slack-jawed at

my hips, moving back and forth in Tom's lap. Then, I gripped that pretty yellow dress that Will had chosen so carefully, lifted it over my head, and tossed it to the floor, revealing Tom's cock buried deep inside of me.

"He fucks me so good, Will," I whimpered.

Will's eyes bulged. His jaw dropped. A horrified look came over his face. Tom gripped me by the hips. I shifted my attention from Will to Tom, cradling his face.

"Fuck me, baby," I whispered.

I heard Will moan in agony. I looked over my shoulder to see his cock spurting like I'd never seen before. I fucked myself with Tom's dick, savoring the feeling of weightlessness – falling and falling and falling - reveling in the glorious satisfaction of finally achieving another fix.

"Yes," I whimpered to Tom. "Fuck me."

I looked at Will as I started to come.

"God, he fucks me so good, Will," I cried. "I'm coming! I'm coming! Oh, god!!!"

Will stayed hard despite having just orgasmed and was still stroking himself. His face contorted in disbelief and agony. It only made me come harder. Will's hand stayed busy in his lap. I collapsed onto Tom's chest. He quickly manhandled me onto all fours sideways in the middle of the bed, so that I was staring directly at Will, my head hovering over his knees. Tom positioned himself behind me, pressing his cock against my pussy.

"I've been fucking her for months." Tom rubbed the tip of his cock up and down my slit, teasing me. "I'll stop if you want me to. All you have to do is say so."

I stared intently at Will, waiting for his reply. He stroked his cock, quickly shifting his gaze back and forth between me and Tom. I loved the way Tom was teasing me, but I wanted Will to hear me beg.

"Please fuck me," I pleaded over my shoulder.

Tom only teased me more. "Please?" I begged again.

"What's it gonna be Will?" Tom challenged.

Will stared at me, squeezing his cockhead in his hand. I could almost see the switch flip in his brain just before he settled his gaze on Tom and grimaced, "Fuck her."

Tom slid himself inside of me with one slow stroke. You would think a man like Tom would display his dominance by showing off his size and physical prowess by jackhammering me. He did the opposite. Tom showed Will how he had mastered my body, playing me like an instrument, drawing sounds from me that my husband had never heard before. It was clear that Tom, in a few months, had learned to please me far better than Will had in our more than six years together. Will, in contrast to the pained look on his face, jerked himself the entire time. Tom took his time, reveling in his dominance. I felt another huge wave of pleasure building, spurred on as much by Will's agony as the ecstasy Tom was delivering.

"Ooh, baby, I'm gonna come again!" I sang. "Make me come!"

Tom pulled my hair and fucked me harder, edging me closer to Will with his thrusts. I found myself pushed forward with my hands on the edges of Will's chair on either side, my face only inches from his. He stared into my eyes; his welling up with tears, mine dilating from pleasure. I was in heaven, loving every second of Will's sweet torture.

Without warning, the sound of Tom slapping my ass filled the room. Thwap!

"Yes!" I grunted.

Will stared in disbelief. I was moved further forward, until my mouth was next to Will's ear.

"Harder," I demanded.

THWAP!

"Ugh!" I screamed. "I'm gonna come!"

Tom knew exactly when and how hard to spank me to draw out my orgasm. He had perfected it over the past weeks and months. For my part, I knew I found the most pleasure in turning myself over completely to the experience. I whimpered incoherently into Will's ear as I climaxed again, finally collapsing into his arms. Not letting me rest, Tom pulled me toward him by my legs until all of me was returned to the bed. He flipped me over onto my back. I wrapped my legs around him and took him back

inside of me. The mood changed from wanton, sensual fucking to gentle lovemaking. Tom kissed me deeply, hovering his body over me, letting the skin of his chest graze my breasts.

“Yes,” I whispered.

Tom stopped and teased me with the head of his cock. We were no longer sexually taunting my husband. I was letting Will see that I had, or at least a part of me had, fallen for Tom. I opened my eyes and looked at Tom.

“Please, baby, don’t stop,” I whispered. “I need you.”

“Say it again,” he mouthed so quietly that I wondered if Will could even hear.

“I need you, baby,” I whispered back. I heard Will exhale with a whimper.

Tom made love to me slowly and perfectly, kissing me as he brought me to a final, tender orgasm. As he neared his own, I enveloped him with my arms and legs, holding him close and quietly chanting “yes, yes, yes” as he came inside of me, something Will had never done in all of our years together. Not one single time. I had been so adamantly opposed to it out of fear of an unwanted pregnancy, that after a few years, Will just gave up.

“Ooh, yes,” I sighed as Tom continued slowly moving inside of me, drawing out his orgasm and using me to draw every last drop of pleasure.

After holding each other and kissing tenderly for a few long moments, Tom eased his way off the bed and began to dress himself in the clothes that I had so carefully folded and placed on our nightstand. He quietly announced in his deep voice, “I’m gonna leave you guys alone. I think you have some things to discuss.”

“Bye, baby,” I said. I tilted my head up for a kiss. Tom kissed me and left. Will and I stayed as we were for a few moments. I looked at Will. He was shellshocked, still absentmindedly stroking his cock and staring at the bed where he had just watched his wife taken away in front of him.

“Please fuck me,” he whispered.

I heard the front door close. I got up from the bed and kissed Will on the cheek. "I only fuck Tom now," I whispered in his ear.

Will groaned pitifully as a small dribble of come trickled from his cock.

"Let me get you a drink," I said. I put on my robe. In my absence, Will managed to pull his pants up and assemble himself to some degree. On my return, I handed him a large pour of scotch.

I sat on the bed across from his chair and put my hands on his knees. I didn't bother asking if he was okay. He was obviously in shock. Instead, I guided him through what was going to happen next. He stared at my dress on the floor as I talked.

"Everything is going to be fine, Will. I'm not leaving you. I'm still your wife. You're still my husband. We're still going to have a family and live the rest of our lives together. I love you. None of that has changed."

Will looked relieved but confused.

"But for now, I'm giving myself to Tom. That's the way he wants it. I know this is a lot to process, but I think you and I both knew it was going to happen."

"Are you pregnant?" he asked, looking terrified.

"No."

"But he just came inside you."

"I'm still on birth control. Tom insisted I make you wear a condom. I'm sorry I lied to you."

Will sat there dumbfounded.

I picked my yellow dress off the floor. I took off my robe. Will looked at my body, the body he was no longer going to be allowed to touch. I stood there for a moment, cruelly letting his gaze linger at what he could no longer have before lowering the dress over my head.

"I think you should sit with this for a while and process." I lifted his chin with my finger, bringing his gaze to mine. "I'll be back in the morning."

Looking in his eyes, I couldn't tell what he was feeling. I'd never seen him like that before. I debated on whether or not to actually leave, but I had planned this for quite some time. I decided to stick with the plan.

"I love you," I said with the utmost sincerity. "It's going to be okay." With a feather-light touch, I kissed him on the lips and walked out wearing my anniversary present.

CHAPTER 6

The Ghost

It felt strange to lay in bed that night with my head on Tom's chest. We had cuddled like that and napped together dozens of times before, but this would be the first time we spent the night together. It felt like the time I went to the beach after graduation with my high school boyfriend and we were free from our parents for the first time. Except I was worried about Will.

"How did he take it?" Tom asked, petting my hair.

"He'll be fine," I answered.

I was reminding myself as much as I was telling Tom.

"He's still in shock, but I think you were right. Deep down, I know he really wanted it to happen. Not to mention, Will's a lot tougher than he looks."

"Oh, really?" Tom let his doubt reveal itself in his tone.

"Yeah," I said defiantly. "He is. You really don't know him that well."

"Enlighten me."

Will didn't like people knowing about his past. I knew I should have just let it go but I felt like I needed to defend him. Even though Tom was physically Will's better, I didn't like the idea of him thinking Will was weak.

"Okay, but this stays between you and me."

I gave Tom a look to let him know I was serious.

“His life started out great. Very different from mine. My parents split up when I was seven. My dad was a paycheck player. I never saw him.”

“Are you guys still I touch?”

“He died right before I met you.”

“Oh. Sorry.”

“The only thing I can really say about him is that he never missed a child support payment and that was probably just to stay out of jail. Will’s mom and dad, on the other hand, had money and were madly in love. They had the big house, the big yard...everything. Literally had a white picket fence. I kid you not.”

“Sounds awful,” Tom said, his voice dripping with sarcasm.

I ignored his comment and carried on. “Then he got with cancer. I didn’t really know him then, but it was hard to miss the kid that was in and out of school for three years. He was the only one allowed to wear a baseball cap in class. Sometimes...god, he was so skinny... you couldn’t believe he was walking around.” I teared up a little. Even then, thinking about young Will tugged at my heartstrings.

“The first time I talked to him was in fifth grade. He was sitting by himself at lunch. He’d been gone so much that nobody really knew him or what to do with him. Everyone just kind of moved on without him. Nobody was mean to him. They just ignored him, moved around him like he was a ghost. Even most of the grownups. He looked so lonely and so frail, sitting there. I still don’t know why, but I got up, walked over, and gave him my pudding cup. That scrawny little kid looked me straight in the eyes and was so still and so calm you would have thought he was a hundred-year-old Buddhist monk...like he knew something the rest of us didn’t. He said, ‘Thank you.’ I said, ‘You’re welcome.’ We both smiled and then I went outside and played with my friends. After that, we started saying hello in the halls.”

Tom stepped a little off his high horse. “Cancer. That’s tough.”

“Oh, I’m not done yet,” I said. “He finally stayed in remission and once we got into junior high, things started getting better for him. His hair grew back. He started looking like a normal kid again. He was still small at

that point, but he didn't look sick anymore. He made some friends. They were the smartest kids in school. They got picked on, of course, but it wasn't too bad. I think Will actually kind of liked it. Being picked on, I mean. At least he wasn't ignored anymore. I kind of looked out for him. I was a cheerleader, and half the football team had a crush on me, so if anybody messed with him too much, me and my girlfriends would see that they had a hard time."

Tom jockeyed for position again. "So, he got picked on a little at school. So did I. Not a big deal. You grow up. You move on."

I wasn't even mad. I just looked at Tom confidently and said, "I'm not finished yet."

"Okay, fine," Tom replied, holding up his hands in surrender.

I laid my head back down on his chest and continued. "Just as people were finally starting to think of him as a normal kid and not the kid who'd had cancer...his mom and dad got killed in an MVA by a drunk driver."

That got a reaction from Tom. "Jesus," he mumbled.

"I still remember my mom telling me. I couldn't stop crying. I mean, how much bad stuff can happen to one kid? I felt *so* bad for him. I badgered my mom until she agreed to take me to the funeral. That's when I stopped believing in God. Mom was uber Baptist. I kept going to church with her every Sunday and Wednesday, but I still don't understand how any god would be so cruel to a child."

Tom stayed quiet.

"The only other kids from school that went to the funeral were his friends Danny and Monty. They sat in the back with their parents. I made my mom sit in one of the side pews, where I could see Will. He only looked up from the floor one time, when he heard me crying. I'll never forget the look in his eyes. He was heartbroken, but he still had that stillness to him. I'd never seen anyone else look like that. It was like he was a piece of driftwood getting taken by the rapids. He didn't fight it. He just let it wash over him. Like he somehow knew where they were going. He was graceful, you know?"

Tom mumbled his understanding.

“I remember asking my Mom, ‘Who will he live with now?’ She didn’t know. I didn’t see him again until high school. He was living in a foster home. We were a few years older, but even though he looked a bit different, I couldn’t forget him. I still smiled at him in the halls, and he would smile back, but there was something different about him. The look in his eyes changed. He always needed a damn haircut. I wanted to chase him down the hall with pair of scissors. And by my count, he never had more than three shirts and a few pairs of jeans. I won’t even mention his shoes.”

“Then, at the beginning of our junior year, he disappeared for two weeks. I thought maybe he had to go to a different foster home and was zoned for a different school. But he came back. His arm was broken. He had stitches over his eye. He was limping. The rumor mill said that his foster father had been arrested. I don’t know for sure. He still hasn’t ever talked about it. But the story was that the guy had been abusing Will for years. Like, pretty bad. Supposedly, Will finally got big enough to fight back. It put them both in the hospital. Will was different after that. He stopped being a kid at all. He spent lunches in the library studying. He always had his nose in a computer book. He told me later that he realized he had no one. While the rest of us were partying, going to football games, and having fun, he knew at sixteen he had less than eighteen months before he was going to have to make his way in the world all on his own. All he did was study when he wasn’t working full time at a quick shop to save up money. He didn’t even go to graduation. I saw him one more time before I left for college. He was at work. I was getting gas. They weren’t busy, so we talked for a few minutes. It was the longest conversation we’d ever actually had. I told him I was coming here for school. He told me he was going out west. I don’t remember exactly what all he said, but god, he was funny. I remember thinking, ‘How does he still have a sense of humor?’”

“Is that where he got shot?” Tom asked.

“No. That was later. When he was in college. He spent a month in the hospital that time. He even turned that into a good thing. That’s how he started his company, with the money from the settlement with the

convenience store. Look, I know you're a legit badass, Tom. I'm not saying you're not. But trust me. So is Will Bradford. You can't fucking break the guy."

Tom nodded. "I get it. I've known guys like him. They make for good marines."

Tom kissed me. He never said anything, but even though I'd made it clear that I had no intention of leaving my husband, I knew he wanted more from me. Part of me did, too. But it would never work, and I could never do that to Will. Despite what a convoluted mess things were, Will was still my husband, and I still loved him. I settled back down into my little nook against Tom's chest. "Goodnight, baby."

I woke up the next morning in Tom's arms for the first time. He was still asleep. I savored the moment, watching him sleep and admiring his body. I knew I would have to leave soon to go home and check on Will. Mentally, I was confident that, deep down, Will wanted what was happening, but I worried about him all the same. I kissed Tom along his chest, working my way down until he woke up to the sight of me playing with my favorite toy. We made love again before I had to leave.

When I got home, Will was still asleep in bed. He was naked next to a bottle of Scotch. It was obvious that he'd had a few more drinks before passing out. The bed sheet was crumpled and resting over his thigh. I walked into the kitchen. I made coffee, English muffins, eggs, and ham as I prepared for another difficult conversation.

Sitting in the chair Will had used to spectate Tom taking me the night before, I nudged Will awake.

"Good morning, sleepyhead." It took a few goes before he opened his eyes. "There you go," I smiled.

He looked like hell. My worry was at an all-time high. Had I broken his heart and ruined our marriage, or had I fulfilled his deepest fantasy?

"Hey," Will grimaced, clearing his throat and rubbing his eyes.

I handed him the coffee and gave him a few moments. "Better?"

Will nodded. He looked at the plate of food on the nightstand.
“Thanks.”

“Sure.”

I paused for another moment. “Are you okay?”

“No. I’m not okay. You cheated on me, Lily.”

His voice was calm, somber, and full of hurt.

“I know.”

“You fucked him again as his place last night, didn’t you?”

“This morning,” I whispered.

Will winced. I felt a pleasant tingle in my gut. Why did I like seeing him hurt so much? At the same time, Will’s cock twitched at my admission. He realized he was still naked and moved the sheet to cover himself.

“Will?”

“Yes.”

“Did you enjoy last night?”

Will paused, looking like he wanted to speak but nothing came out.

“Will? Did you like watching Tom fuck me?”

Will took a deep breath. I could see how torn he was.

“Wasn’t that what you wanted?” I asked with all the kindness in my voice that I could muster.

“I didn’t want you to cheat on me, Lily.”

“Didn’t you?” I kept my voice calm and soothing. “It seemed like you liked it. It seemed like you liked it a lot.”

I moved to sit on the edge of the bed. Will said nothing, but his breathing changed. I eased the sheet back down, exposing his cock again. He was getting harder. I gently encircled it with the tips of my fingers, moving them along the shaft and the tip with a feather touch.

“Would you like me to tell you about the first time he fucked me?”

Will exhaled deeply. His cock throbbed in my hand.

“Do you want to hear about how he came over to our house and kissed me? And then how I kissed him back?”

I stroked him in my palm as I whispered in his ear.

“I was so wet that I soaked through my shorts. You know the little grey ones you like that fit just right?”

“Oh, fuck,” Will mumbled. I could see he was still reluctant to submit to what he wanted.

“He bent me over the foyer table and pulled my shorts down to my thighs.”

I squeezed the tip of Will’s cock.

“He told me he would stop, Will. Just like with you last night, all I had to do was tell him to stop and he would have.”

I teased Will’s tip with my fingers.

“Ugh,” he groaned quietly.

“But I didn’t.”

I nibbled Will’s ear lobe. I took my hand from his cock and pulled his to it instead.

“I told him to, Will. I told him to fuck me. I wanted him inside of me.”

Will squeezed his dick and started stroking himself. I kept my mouth to his ear, my breath detailing my infidelity.

“Then he put that big cock inside of your wife. It was unbelievable. It felt like a blanket warming me from the inside out.”

“Fuck,” Will groaned, pulling himself.

“Oh god, Will. The way he fucked me...it was incredible. I’d never felt anything like it. It’s like he was made for me. I’d never come so hard before. Then I got on my knees for him again. I’d been dreaming of it ever since the first time he came over.”

“Hmpf,” Will groaned, jerking his cock faster.

“I devoured it, Will.”

I paused, making Will wait.

“Do you want to hear more?” I whispered.

Will nodded reluctantly.

“He laid me on the couch and made love to me. It was like a dream. I came over and over. I’d never felt anything like it before. He held me like I was his. He was so sensual. It was like he knew exactly what I needed.”

“Oh, God,” Will whimpered. His breath became short and stuttered. I thought he might start crying. He carried on stroking himself.

I cupped Will’s balls and squeezed gently.

“And in that moment, Will...I was his. I forgot all about you.”

Will exhaled all of the air in his lungs and squeezed the tip of his cock in glorious agony.

“Then he brought me here, to our bed. I told him no. Not here. But he seduced me. He teased me. And then he made me beg...I begged him, Will. I begged him to fuck me in our bed. The place that’s supposed to be for just you and me. Right where you’re laying right now.”

Will sighed.

“It was our anniversary, Will. On our special day, the day we celebrate our vows, the day you made me your wife, I let another man come inside of me for the first time.”

With those words, Will groaned and climaxed onto his stomach.

“Fuck,” Will slowly exhaled.

“You see, Will. You did want me to cheat.”

Will looked at me, sated and defeated. He knew I was right.

I carried on with my confession.

“I didn’t plan on it happening again. I didn’t want to be the kind of woman that cheats on her husband. But when Tom came over the night after we saw him at dinner, I couldn’t stop myself. I waited for you to fall asleep and then I went to his house to fuck him again. We’ve been together ever since. I’m not going to lie and say I did it *for* you. But you wanted it to happen.” I kissed him on the cheek. “I love you.”

Will stayed in the bedroom for most of the day, only coming out to get food, water, and scotch. Finally, as the sun was going down, he came

out to the living room after taking a long shower. I cooked dinner. While we did the dishes together, the doorbell rang.

“That’s Tom,” I said, drying my hands.

Will stared at me.

“Do you want to watch him fuck me again or should we go to his place?”

Will stood motionless for a moment.

The doorbell rang again.

Will gave a subtle nod.

He came three times that night, the same as Tom. I lost count of how many times I did.

CHAPTER 7

The Kitchen Sink

Five months earlier, on the morning of my fifth wedding anniversary, I stood over the kitchen sink, looking down at dirty dishwater that refused to drain. Will couldn't help me. He was already at work. That didn't really matter, though. Will knew a lot about a lot of things. Plumbing was not one of them. To be fair, I didn't know anything about plumbing either. It was the middle of the week, so the plan was to have a quiet dinner at home the day and go out to one of our favorite eateries on Friday. It was going to be pretty tough for me to make an anniversary dinner without a functioning kitchen sink.

For weeks after the Fourth of July, every time I glanced at Tom's card sitting next to the scratch paper and coffee mug full of pens, I told myself to just toss it in the trash can. In that moment, however, I found myself grateful that I hadn't. I couldn't think of any other way I could get my sink remedied in time to get dinner ready. Part of me knew it was a terrible idea, but before I could think too much, I picked up my phone and dialed Tom's number. It rang several times. Just when I decided against leaving a voicemail and take a chance on getting a regular plumber in time, I heard Tom's voice on the line.

"Hello?"

"Hi, Tom. It's Lily." I felt the butterflies in my stomach again.

"Well, hey, Lily. How have you been?"

"Well, I'm in a bind. My kitchen sink won't drain, and I need to make dinner for mine and Will's anniversary. I was hoping you could help me out."

"Happy anniversary."

“Thank you.”

“Is the sink full now?”

“Yeah. It doesn’t seem to be draining at all.”

“Alright. I’m just finishing something up. I’ll pop by there in about half an hour if that works for you?”

“That would be amazing. Thank you so much, Tom. I really appreciate it.”

“No problem. See you in a bit.”

The instant we hung up, I was struck with anxiety and regret. I was going to be face to face with the man with whom I had nearly lost all control. I hadn’t thought it through. I just jumped. Adding to my angst was the fact that I hadn’t done anything with myself since I got out of bed that morning. Before I could get too out of sorts, another part of my brain mercifully took over and demanded that I not let myself go down that rabbit hole. I decided to simply put my hair back in a neat ponytail and hide the circles under my eyes with a little concealer, but keep the plain grey cotton running shorts and white V-neck. As far as I was concerned, it shouldn’t matter what I wore or how I looked other than to be politely presentable. Regardless of what happened a few months before, I was a married woman. Period. That’s what I told myself, anyway. It didn’t do anything to quell the butterflies that were frolicking in my stomach.

Tom arrived exactly when he said he would. While he seemed confident and relaxed, I was just the opposite. I felt incredibly awkward and barely managed to exchange pleasantries without completely embarrassing myself. It would have been comical if it were happening to someone else. I think Tom could tell how anxious I was and took mercy on me, going straight to work on the sink without belaboring the moment. I leaned against the counter and busied myself making a shopping list for dinner, trying to pretend it wasn’t so strange for me to have Tom ten feet away after what had happened the last time we were in the same room. My reaction to him had not changed. I was still scared and enticed by him. The fact that he was neither trying to scare me nor entice me might have been the sexiest thing about him in that moment. I caught myself staring at him and fidgeting with the eraser of my pencil against my lower lip. He wasn’t menacing, but I was terrified of the way his presence made me feel. I

wanted to put my hands on his bare chest again. I wanted to feel him towering over me. I admitted to myself that I should have just waited for a regular plumber and told Will we'd have to make other plans for the evening. It was becoming unbearably quiet until Tom broke the silence.

"So, how long have you guys been married?"

"Huh?" I had been so lost in thought that I didn't process what Tom said.

"You said it's your anniversary. How long have you been married?"

"Oh...um...five years today." I was hoping that Tom was convinced I was distracted by my list and not the scene from the Fourth of July replaying in my head. "How about you? Have you ever been married?"

"Me? No. I came close a few times, but one of us always managed to duck."

I giggled.

"Sounds like you dodged a real bullet." It was a poor choice of words, considering I was talking to a man who had made a living dodging actual bullets. To be fair, he was the one who said "duck." Debating the minutiae of word choice is one of the ways my mind tortures me when I'm anxious. That day was no exception.

"Well, it wouldn't be exactly fair, you know? I spent most of the last twenty years deployed somewhere or another. I can't imagine a woman being happy waiting at home alone."

"I'm sorry."

If Tom regretted anything, he wasn't showing it.

"It's okay. We make our choices. Besides, I don't know that many happy married couples, anyway. Present company excluded, of course."

"Well, I got lucky."

"Sounds like. Your husband seems like a good guy."

A subtle clue in Tom's tone told me he was about to clarify his assessment of my husband with a caveat.

"Please don't go there. Please don't go there," I chanted in my head.

He went there.

“The flirting thing’s a little weird.”

“It’s really no big deal. Just a little harmless flirting,” I minimized.

Tom looked at me and cocked his head, nonverbally calling bullshit while continuing what he was doing under the sink. Obviously, what he and I had done was not just “a little harmless flirting.” That was his frame of reference, though.

“I mean...that night...” I stumbled, “...you know...that you came... I mean, that you were here.” I was drowning. The fucking minutiae of word choice. To this day, I can’t believe I said that. “That was different. It’s not usually like that. I don’t want you to get the wrong idea.”

“So, you never...”

“No,” I recoiled. “God no. Just a little peck on the lips or a hand on my ass was the most that ever happened before.” I was hoping that was the end of it. I wanted to slink away and die.

“Well, I’m flattered then,” Tom concluded with a cocky grin.

“You should be,” I replied, not as cocky. I couldn’t stop wondering what the hell was wrong with me.

Tom stood up and washed his hands in the sink with his back to me. “Did you get in trouble, then?”

“No,” I replied. “Will is a very understanding husband.”

“So, you told him, then.”

“He knew.” Why I didn’t just say yes, I don’t know. But that particular choice of words gave away that Will had actually seen, or at least heard, what went on that night.

Tom turned back around, drying his hands, and nodded his head knowingly.

“Good,” he said, looking over his shoulder with another confident grin. Without making any effort to hide it, he faced me and blatantly looked me over from head to toe. The way he looked at me sent the butterflies raging. I just stood there, allowing his eyes to wander my body. I was acutely aware of his gaze, the silence, and the fact that we were alone. He let the moment linger.

“You’re all set,” he finally said.

“Thank you, so much, Tom,” I exhaled. I made my way to the foyer table, where I’d left my purse. “Here, let me pay you.” I fumbled around in my purse looking for cash, my hands shaking. Tom followed me and stood only a few feet away.

He refused my offer. “Don’t be ridiculous,” he said and moved a bit closer.

“I insist. You came so quickly and saved me.”

“I didn’t come that quickly,” he smirked like a cheeky bastard.

“Please? I feel like I owe you,” I insisted again.

“I wouldn’t mind another kiss,” he said.

“I can’t, Tom. Will’s not here. It doesn’t work that way. I think I have a bunch of twenties in here somewhere.” I fiddled nervously again in my purse and produced a crumpled mess of cash.

Tom stepped into my space, looking down at me. He was close enough that I could smell the soap from his freshly washed hands and his musky scent behind it. The butterflies multiplied and found their way to my knees as well. “Fucking pheromones,” I thought to myself.

“One little kiss. Harmless flirting. Right?” he said, then leaned his head down and kissed me. I let him.

One Mississippi. Two Mississippi.

“How’s that?” I asked rhetorically, hoping he was satisfied.

Tom reached his hand around my waist and pulled me closer. “Just one more...”

We kissed again. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. Three Mississippi. Four. Five. Six. I finally mustered the wherewithal to break the kiss.

“Okay, there you go. But that’s it, okay?” I said, turning my head away. My breathing had become agitated. “Will’s not here, remember? You should go.”

Tom took my hands in his and slowly lifted them above my head, pressing them against the wall behind me. Leaning in, his lips in front of mine, he whispered, "Just one more."

He kissed me again. My lips parted, and he slipped his tongue in my mouth. I lost count of how many slow, intoxicating Mississippis it lasted. I was aching, but I knew I couldn't allow the situation to escalate still further. I turned my head to the side.

"No, Tom. I can't. I'm sorry," I said firmly.

I knew I had already crossed a line, but it wasn't too late. Tom kissed my neck, working his way to my ear and then back down my neck. My breathing deepened. I thought about Will sitting at his desk at work. He would be crushed if he knew what was happening.

"Tom, this is wrong. I can't," I repeated.

"It seems to me like you want to," he refuted, gesturing with his gaze to my crotch.

I looked down at my shorts. There was a small yet undeniable wet spot on my gray shorts, clearly emanating from between my legs. I was so embarrassed. Mortified. Tom freed one of his hands, still holding both of mine above my head with the other, and touched my aching wetness. My body tensed with pleasure. I exhaled with an involuntary moan. Through my shorts, he began gently rubbing my wet, aching pussy. My body remembered how he made me come on the Fourth of July and it wanted more.

"Tom, I can't," I repeated, breathing heavily. I was losing ground, but still determined not to betray my husband any further. I thought of me and Will sitting at the kitchen table, celebrating our fifth anniversary. Tom pulled his hand away from my shorts. For a beat, I thought he had relented when he released my hands from the wall behind me. I was wrong. Instead, he pulled open his shorts and revealed his cock.

"This is what you want, isn't it?" he asked rhetorically.

Inside, I knew I was going to surrender and get on my knees for him again. And I knew it was wrong. Terribly wrong. Somehow, that only made me want it more. I was in completely uncharted territory. I had never felt so sexually charged before. “Who is this man?” I thought to myself. Tom took my hand and placed it on his cock.

“Tom, no.” I panted. He kissed me, parting my lips with his tongue again. I met him with mine, unable to resist. I stroked his cock with a feather touch, my actions defying my words.

“We can’t,” I whispered, still playing with his dick. He pushed my shorts down to my thighs with his big hands and cupped my wetness again, skin to skin.

“Tom, no,” I repeated. My breathing became hypnotic in response to him kissing my neck and gently teasing my clitoris. Despite my protests, I squeezed his shaft harder as I stroked it, never pushing his hand away. He eased his finger inside, still managing to tease my clit with his palm at the same time. I gasped and squeezed his cock. “Oh, fuck,” I moaned. I was about to come when Tom suddenly turned me around and bent me over the foyer table.

“Oh God!” I blurted out, caught by surprise. Tom stood behind me, his cock resting on my bare ass, his finger back at work inside me. “Please, Tom. Don’t!” I begged.

“Tell me to stop, Lily,” he challenged.

“I told you ‘no’!” I barked. Tom had one finger inside me and another circling my clit, causing my body to pulsate with pleasure. “I can’t do this,” I said meekly.

“Tell me to stop,” he repeated.

“Tom, don’t!” I whimpered.

“Just tell me to stop. S...T...O...P. Say ‘stop’ and I promise you, I will.” He edged me with his fingers as he told me the rules of his game.

“We can’t do this, Tom. It’s wrong. I love Will. I’m not going to cheat on him,” I said firmly. But I didn’t say “stop.” In my heart of hearts, I didn’t want him to. “I’ll let him make me come,” I thought. “Then I’ll give him a blowjob. I’ll wait until tomorrow to tell Will, so I don’t ruin our anniversary. And then we’ll end this thing. We’ll move if we have to. But first, I need to come,” I told myself.

Tom dropped to his knees behind me. I felt his big hands on my cheeks, spreading them apart just before his tongue found my labia. I pushed all the breath from my body with my diaphragm and rested my head on the tabletop. “Fuck,” I exhaled slowly, feeling another man’s tongue explore my sex. He brought me to the very brink of orgasm and then stood up again, his hands grasping my hips. He took one hand off and then I felt the tip of his cock rubbing against my folds.

I heard his deep voice from behind me. “Tell me you haven’t thought about it.”

“Tom, no. You can’t.” I shook my head at him over my shoulder, panicking. Of course, I had thought about it. How it would feel to have him inside of me. What it would be like to be wrapped up in that hulk of a man. But I couldn’t. I wouldn’t. “No,” I repeated.

“Tell me to stop, Lily.”

My voice trailed to a whisper. “Tom, please don’t. I’m begging you. Please. Please.” Still, I didn’t say “stop.” His cock felt so good rubbing against me. My head was spinning.

“Say ‘stop’, Lily.”

“Don’t,” I said. The minutiae of language. “Please... please... I’m sorry.” I was whimpering, almost crying. It wasn’t clear even to myself if I was begging Tom to leave and apologizing to him or begging Tom to put himself inside me and apologizing to my husband. I had never felt an ache like that before.

Tom grasped my hips with both hands, his cock parting my folds and pressing firmly enough against me to stay true on its own. “Tell me what you want.”

I was panting like I was in heat. I could feel my pulse keeping time against the firm stillness of his cock against my entrance. I felt my insides literally throbbing, yearning, calling out for Tom to take me. I couldn't resist any longer. I didn't even want to. Will was no longer in my thoughts. My vows. Morality. Self-respect. Simple common decency. All took a back seat to the ache.

"Tell me to stop," Tom said quietly once more.

"No," I whispered to myself.

"I didn't hear you," he said. "What do you want, Lily?"

My gaze shifted to one of the framed pictures on the table next to my head. It was my wedding photo—me in my white dress, Will in his tuxedo. Flowers in my hand. The ocean behind us. I surrendered.

"Fuck me," I whispered quietly.

"Are you sure you don't want me to stop, Lily?" Tom pressed against me the tiniest bit more.

I whispered louder. "Fuck me."

Tom pushed his cock forward. I could feel his girth, just barely inside, begin to stretch me. He paused.

"More?" Tom asked slowly, deliberately.

"Yes," I panted. "Don't stop." I pushed back against him, but Tom controlled me with my hips.

Tom eased himself inside me. My body clenched in wonderful agony, surprising me with its ability to accommodate such unprecedented girth. In a whispered scream, I chanted, "Oh god! Oh god! Oh god!" as Tom slowly and steadily eased himself out and back in again. The beast of a man was being as gentle as he could. It's difficult to describe the sensation. It wasn't painful, exactly. The thickness of Tom's flesh pressed against my walls, creating a pressure that would have otherwise been uncomfortable and unwelcome had it not also been the source of such immense pleasure. It was brand new. I moaned mindlessly in ecstasy as he moved inside of me. There were peaks and valleys, but I didn't know if I was having multiple orgasms or if it was just one long, slowly pulsating orgasm. I had no

frame of reference for what was happening to me. His size played a role, to be sure. But that wasn't what brought me so much pleasure. It was the man. It was the way he mastered me—the way he made me want to submit to him. It was biological. Primal. It was millions of years of evolution. It was the rollercoaster. There, bent over my foyer table, being taken by a man I barely knew, I found bliss.

Tom turned me around and lifted me from the table. He kissed me deeply. I kissed him back. He picked me up effortlessly and carried me to the living room; my arms draped around his neck, my vision tunneled. He was in complete control.

“What are you doing to me?” I asked incredulously, cradled in his arms like a girl being rescued from a burning building.

Tom gently put me down and stood me next to the couch in front of him. “Do you want me to stop?” he offered gently.

I shook my head, hypnotized, bewildered.

“No,” I whispered.

I pushed my shorts the rest of the way to the floor and pulled my shirt over my head. I dropped to my knees in front of him. I breathed slowly and deeply, reaching to grip his cock in my hand. My mouth watered. I closed my eyes and put his cock to my face, resting the tip on my forehead, my nose against his shaft. It reminded me of the fact that Will wasn't there. I put my tongue to the underside of Tom's shaft. Slowly, I savored the taste and feel of his musky skin as I dragged my tongue up along his cock. Reaching the head, I circled his tip with my tongue. I looked up at Tom. He looked deep in my eyes, seeing my submission. I turned my gaze back down, circled his tip again, and then finally, took his cock into mouth. I had never seen the appeal in blowjobs other than for the man, and my looks had allowed me to skate by without ever having to be concerned with it. I felt a twinge of almost evil satisfaction giving Tom for the second time what I never gave my own husband. I looked up at Tom hoping to see approval on his face. He was looking down at me in awe.

“God, you're sexy,” he whispered.

I licked his cock seductively, brushing it along the face every man I'd ever known had told me was beautiful. I had grown to hate that word

along with “pretty” and “stunning.” Never did they call me sexy. And never had I worshipped at their feet as I was at Tom’s. I pleased him for a few moments more, remembering his taste, before he pulled me back up.

Tom lifted his shirt over his head and eased me down to the couch, crawling on top of me as he did. He kissed his way down my belly, making his way to my sex. I watched as this scarred warrior brute lay servile between my legs, patiently worshipping me as I had done for him. Enlisting his tongue, his lips, and his fingers, he brought me to another orgasm. It was wonderful, but not unfamiliar. Will could do similar. I wanted more. I needed his cock inside of me again.

Tom made his way back up my torso, lingering on my breasts and resting his shaft against my labia. I reached down guided his cock to my entrance. I watched incredulously as it disappeared inside of me.

“Oh my God. I can’t believe you’re fucking me,” I gasped, referring equally to both the size of his cock and the fact that it belonged to someone I wasn’t married to.

Tom stared into my eyes. “Tell me to stop, Lily.”

I stared back. “No. Don’t stop,” I whispered, staring into his eyes.

I looked down again, watching and allowing all of my senses to indulge in the pleasure. Our bodies gradually moved closer and closer, until I was engulfed by Tom’s body. We kissed deeply as he moved inside of me. Thought and language left me. He was masterful, playing me like an instrument. Crescendo, decrescendo. Adagio, allegro. I came again. And then again. We kissed gently and lovingly as he pleased me, and I took him deeper and deeper inside of me, my body gratefully accepting my new lover. If sex is what I had experienced with the previous men I’d been with, then there needed to be another word for what was happening in that moment. Tom knew he had me. He picked me up from the couch, still inside me. I wrapped my legs around his waist and held him close as he carried me.

“Where are you taking me?” I asked.

He didn't respond. I quickly realized he was taking me to the bedroom.

"No. Please. Not here," I protested as he crossed the threshold to the bedroom.

He laid us gently down onto the bed. His strength was remarkable. I could feel him move inside me as we settled on the mattress.

"Not here," I repeated, shaking my head.

Tom's response was to tease me with the head of his cock. When he could see the uncontrollable desire in my eyes, he said again, "Tell me to stop, Lily." He kissed me deeply and I was, again, fully entranced.

"Tell me to stop," he repeated in my ear.

I said nothing, only moaned as he gave me more of him, only to take it back again. He teased me and teased me in that way, bringing me to the edge and then back again, taunting me, never letting me climax.

"Tell me to stop, Lily."

"No," I finally grunted. I had surrendered again. I needed more. I needed him deep inside. I was dizzy.

"Tell me what you want," he whispered.

"Make love to me. Please," I begged.

"But it's your anniversary. We're in your husband's bed. Tell me to stop, Lily."

"No." I didn't want to think about that. I shut it out of my mind.

"Tell me you want me instead of your husband on your anniversary." Tom whispered and gave me a little more of his cock, reminding me yet again of what I wanted so badly.

I was desperate, but I couldn't bring myself to say that.

"Tell me," he quietly demanded, still edging me.

"Please?" I begged "I want you." I couldn't say the rest. I loved Will. This wasn't his fault.

"Tell me." Tom gave me more and took it back again. Edging me. Torturing me.

I resisted as long as I could. And then something happened. A switch flipped inside of me. Everything changed. I wholly embraced my shadow self. I wanted it. I cradled Tom's face firmly in my hands, looked him in the eyes, and told him exactly and unabashedly what I wanted. "Fuck me, Tom. Take me..."

Tom started easing inside of me...

"...in my husband's bed..."

He gave me some more...

"...on our anniversary. I want you to fuck me instead of my husband. I want your cock. Not his. Fuck...My...Married...Cheating...Cunt."

I had never said that word in my life. I finally understood its utility. Tom pushed deep inside of me. I was finally free from his teasing.

Whereas Tom had made love to me sweetly in the living room, in the bed I shared with my husband, he fucked me like the cheating whore that I was.

"Tell me to stop, Lily!" he barked.

"No! Fuck me!" I barked back.

"Yeah? You like cheating on your husband with this big dick?"

"Yes!" I wailed. "Give me that fucking cock!"

Tom flipped me over on all fours. "Tell me what you want, Lily!"

"Fuck me," I demanded. "Fuck me harder!" My voice was almost guttural.

Tom fucked me steadily from behind, sensing where the line was, and going past it just a hair. The sound of our bodies slapping together echoed through the bedroom. I couldn't believe I was taking him so forcefully. I'd never been treated like that by a man.

"Yes," I moaned.

"What about your husband? Doesn't he fuck you like this? Keep you satisfied?" Tom taunted.

I said nothing, only moaning my approval.

That wasn't enough for Tom. He slapped my ass, adding a surprisingly welcome sting to my yielding. Thwap!

"Tell me, Lily! Doesn't Will fuck you this good?"

"No!" I relented, almost crying from pleasure rather than shame or guilt. "Fuck me!"

"So, is this my pussy now?" Tom pulled my hair, forcing my head upward and my back to arch. He slapped my ass again. Thwap!

"Yes!" I cried, my breath shaking. In that moment, I would have said anything. I would have let him do anything to me he wanted. I would have loved even more for him to take it.

Tom freed my hair and grabbed my shoulders with both hands, fucking me harder. I was completely at his mercy – totally subservient and wanting nothing more than to please him while he gave me what I had never known I needed so badly.

I lost count of how many times I climaxed, and I could tell Tom was finally nearing his own. I pulled away from him and laid on my back, pulling him down close to me and kissing him madly. He immediately found his way back inside me and buried his face in my neck. With my mouth to his ear I panted, "Don't stop. Don't stop." Soon, I was as close to coming as he was. I would have pleaded with him to stay inside me had I not already been sure that he was going to do just that. The feeling of Tom pulsating inside of me as he came sent me over the edge. I hugged him with my legs as tight as I could while I orgasmed with my whole body. He continued making love to me slowly, nursing me through the tail of my climax as he came down from his own. When we were both satisfied, he stayed inside me and kissed me as my cortex started coming back online. One of my first thoughts was about how I would surely regret what had just happened. But it didn't feel that way. I was basking, not whirling. I felt no shame. I hummed my satisfaction as Tom slid to my side.

"You okay?" Tom's deep voice queried.

"What just happened?" I asked, semi-rhetorically.

Tom smirked confidently. "Your husband's gonna love this."

"No!" I countered. "He can NEVER know about this. Ever."

“Lily, it was my job to look after my men; to know what they needed. And your husband wants to watch you get fucked.”

“No, he doesn’t, Tom. We talked about it. You don’t know anything about Will.” I looked as sternly at him as I had ever looked at anyone. “And this can NEVER happen again. Do you understand me?”

Tom was wise enough not to argue. I also got the feeling that he didn’t believe me.

“Fair enough,” he replied.

We laid in bed staring at the ceiling for what must have been fifteen minutes. It seemed like an hour. I don’t know what Tom was thinking but I was struggling to make sense of what had just happened. Finally, I broke the silence.

“Tom, this can never happen again,” I reiterated.

“What time does your husband get home?” he asked.

“A little after five. Shit! I’d better call him and tell him dinner is off.”

I couldn’t fathom cooking an anniversary dinner after I’d just fucked another man in our bed. My immediate impulse was to play sick like I used to in high school.

“Not a word,” I ordered Tom.

He got up from the bed and walked naked down the hall, presumably to the kitchen. I couldn’t help but admire his brutish figure and muscular ass. I sat on the edge of the bed for a minute trying to figure out what I was going to tell Will. The phone was ringing when Tom returned carrying two glasses of wine. I shushed Tom with a finger to my lips and urgency on my face.

“Hello?” Will answered.

“Hey, baby,” I replied, trying my best to sound not well.

“What’s going on?” Will asked.

Tom stepped forward, stroking his cock in my face. I looked up at him and rolled my eyes in disbelief.

“I’m not feeling well. I don’t think I’m up for dinner tonight. I’m sorry.”

“Oh no,” Will lamented. “Do you want me to come home? Do you need something from the drugstore? I could...”

As Will was speaking, Tom brought his cock to my lips. I looked up at him and almost immediately relented, taking it in my mouth. I sucked it as quietly as I could until Will stopped talking. I still had no idea what it was about him that made me want to submit to his every wish.

“I think I just need to lay down,” I said into the phone and the tip of Tom’s dick simultaneously. “You should stop on the way home and pick yourself up something to eat. There’s no need to rush. I’m probably just going to be in bed anyway.”

“Yeah. You sound a little off. You should probably get some sleep. I love you.”

I peeled my mouth off of Tom again. “I love you, too. And Will?”

“Yes?”

I paused and seductively licked the underside of Tom’s dick, looking wickedly up at Tom. “I’m really sorry.”

“It’s okay, baby. Don’t worry about it. I’ll check on you when I get home. Call me if you need anything. Are you absolutely sure you don’t need anything?” Tom pushed his cock to the back of my throat as Will was forgiving me for cancelling.

“Will do. Love you. Bye,” I managed to reply, not entirely clear on what Will just said, my eyes watering from gagging on Tom’s shaft.

Will could barely say “I love you, too” before I hung up the phone.

I looked up at Tom. “Fuck me,” I sneered.

Tom and I fucked for the rest of the afternoon. We barely spoke, other than during the act. We were such different people, I doubted that we would even have a lot to talk about. Physically, though, it was as though the two of us were made for each other. I had never experienced anything like it. I’m not sure he had either. As he left, he bent me over the foyer table and took me one more time while I both begged for it and insisted that we could

never be together again. I barely had time to take a quick shower and change the sheets before Will got home.

As I laid there for hours, satiated and sore, I struggled to comprehend what happened that day. Even more than that, I was avoiding admitting to myself the most unsettling thing of all. It had been there from the moment I put my lips to Tom in the living room on the Fourth of July. And even more than the life-changing sex, it was what made the first time Tom fucked me so unbelievably gratifying. It was the thing that opened a whole new world to me, a side of myself I never knew existed. Cheating. For reasons beyond my comprehension, the fact that I was willingly and wantonly fucking another man without Will's knowledge or consent is what filled some kind of hole inside of me that I always knew existed but had always pretended wasn't there. For the first time in my life, I was being bad. I was doing the most reprehensible thing I could think of. I was betraying the person I loved most in the world. It filled that hole inside of me. And I craved it like a drug.

That weekend, Tom came over for his first official Saturday visit. Will had no idea I had been unfaithful. That only added to the excitement for me. Looking at Will while I was going down on Tom, knowing that he had no idea I had already done things with Tom that I had never done with him, was thrilling. Still, I had no intention of doing it again. That first Saturday, I blew Tom three times while Will watched. And even though Will fucked me twice and Tom made me come with his fingers multiple times, I still wanted more. I tried masturbating after Will went to sleep. It wasn't enough. Finally, I surrendered and snuck out of the house. I walked the half-mile to Tom's place and knocked on the door.

When Tom opened the door, I stepped in without saying a word and dropped to my knees. I pulled his pajamas down. He pulled his shirt over his head. As soon as I had him hard, I stood up, took him by his dick, and led him to his couch. I hastily pushed my jeans and panties to the floor. I pushed Tom down onto the couch and straddled him, finally indulging in the thing I had been craving all day. I fucked myself with his cock until I came. When I came the second time, he came with me. I didn't have to tell him to come inside of me. He knew I wanted it. I didn't linger in the afterglow. I needed to get home. I got up and pulled my jeans on, leaving my panties on the floor.

“Will leaves for work at eight on the weekdays,” is all I said before leaving as swiftly as I arrived.

On Monday morning, I stared at the clock for what seemed like forever. At exactly five after eight, there was a knock at the door. And so, it began. Weekdays with Tom.

CHAPTER 8

Sally

“I want you to meet him,” I said, sitting across from Sally on our lunch break.

She swallowed and asked, “Who?”

“Tom.”

“You mean the man you’re cheating on your husband with?” Her tone clearly relayed her disapproval.

“I’m not *cheating* cheating.”

“My mistake. You mean the man you’re giving head to in front of your husband but fucking in secret?” she clarified.

“Come on, Sally. I know it’s strange, but I want you to meet him.” I knew even before I told her that Sally would want nothing to do with my extracurricular situation. But she loved me, and I knew she would agree if I begged enough. “Please?”

“Okay,” she relented. “Fine.”

“Thank you,” I smiled. “We’re both off Thursday. Maybe we could go to his place for lunch?”

“You mean not in public.”

“Sally,” I whined like a spoiled little girl. “Please?”

“Okay. Okay. But you’ll have to drive. They’ll be working on my car that day. Can you pick me up?”

“Absolutely. I know you’ll understand once you meet him.” I was giddy. I desperately wanted someone else in the world to understand.

Nothing ever seemed real to me until I'd shared it with Will or Sally. And I couldn't share this with Will. Not yet anyway. Maybe.

"Can we just stop talking about it, please, and finish eating?" Sally complained. "We've got to get back to it in like five minutes."

I was already done with my food and got up to toss my trash. I kissed Sally quickly on the cheek on my way to the trash can. "Thank you," I smiled. "I love you," I added on my way out the door to let Sally finish eating in peace.

"I love you, too" she mumbled with a mouth full of food.

Two days later, I picked Sally up at her house and drove her to Tom's. While we were on our way, Tom was grilling ribeyes for us. We found a note on the door telling us to let ourselves in. Tom's condo wasn't much to speak of. It had a living room, a small dining room adjacent to the kitchen, one bedroom, and one bathroom. There was a sliding glass door to a small patio just outside the dining area. Through the glass, we could see Tom working the grill. He was wearing his usual cargo shorts, a t-shirt that accentuated his chest and arms, and beach sandals. He didn't notice us. We stood in the living room for a moment, just watching.

Sally gave him a good look over. "He's kinda hot in a stray dog sort of way. I'll give you that," she admitted. I could tell she found him more attractive than her tone. There was just something about him.

Tom spotted us. He smiled and waved us to him. Sally and I smiled and waved back. "Here we go," Sally sang under her breath as we stepped forward.

"Hey, baby," I smiled, tiptoeing to kiss Tom hello. I rested my hand on his chest and let the kiss linger for a full two Mississippis. Sally hadn't heard me call anyone other than Will "baby" in years. I introduced her.

"Sally," Will smiled and shook her hand. "It's nice to meet you."

Sally smiled politely. Begrudgingly. Things were off to a rocky start. I don't know what I expected. I think I was hoping Sally would magically fall under Tom's spell like I had. Lunch helped ease things along, though. The food was good. Tom was charming. And Sally seemed to relax a bit. Tom opened a bottle of wine. After two glasses, Tom and Sally were joking

around like friends. I was happy. And I was getting hornier by the minute. When Tom excused himself to go to the bathroom, it gave me an opportunity to get Sally's revised assessment.

"Sooo, what do you think?" I grinned.

Sally took a moment to choose her words. "He's a little scary at first...but I can see why you like him."

"I know, right?" I waited for Sally to say more.

"He's funny...and his arms are really nice."

"He's sexy as hell, isn't he?"

"Lily!"

"Well, he is," I teased as I got up to clear the table.

On my way to the sink, Tom walked back in. "Isn't that right, baby?" I joked, knowing he had no idea what he was supposed to agree to.

Before he could respond, I tiptoed for another kiss with a plate in each hand. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. A little tongue. I could taste the wine on his lips. Three Mississippi. I peeled myself away and put the plates in the sink. I poured Sally another glass of wine and told her to go relax in the living room while Tom and I did the dishes. You could see into the dining area from the living room, but not the kitchen. I turned on the faucet and let it run. I pushed Tom against the counter where he was standing just around the corner from the living room. I reached my arms up and around his neck and pulled him down to kiss me. I slid my hands down across his chest and then back up, under his shirt, feeling his skin and muscles under my palms. I could feel his cock getting hard as he pressed against me. He kissed my neck, and I reached around with one hand to pull him closer to me, gripping his ass.

"Oops!" I heard Sally exclaim. Tom and I looked over to see Sally looking surprised and embarrassed. "Sorry. I was just going to ask if it was okay to use your bathroom."

"Sure thing, it's just around the corner there," Tom gestured.

"Thanks," Sally replied and hurried away.

I sank to my knees and started unbuttoning Tom's shorts.

“What are you doing?” he challenged, pulling away.

“She takes forever in the bathroom,” I said as I wrestled back control of his shorts. “I just want a taste.” I freed his cock and took it straight into my mouth. I wanted him to fuck me right then and there, but I knew that wasn’t an option. I sucked his cock with purpose. I challenged myself to make him come before Sally was done in the bathroom. I stroked the base of his cock with one hand while I fit what I could of him in my mouth. With my other hand, I reached under my sundress and fingered my throbbing pussy. I came in what must have been less than a minute, being sure to keep my whimpering quiet. I turned my full attention back to Tom and sucked him the way I knew would make him come. I could feel him tensing as he started getting closer when I heard Sally’s voice.

“Oh, my god!” she gasped.

I looked over at her. Her mouth was agape watching me stroke Tom’s cock, my lips hovering next to it. I backed my head away just a little and moved my hand from Tom’s base to his tip. I stroked his full length, slowly, while keeping my eyes on Sally. She stood there frozen; her eyes fixed on Tom’s erection as I displayed it for her.

“Fuck,” Tom moaned. I could tell he was ready to come but needed me to finish him off. Sally made eye contact with me for a split second before turning her gaze back to Tom’s cock, her face still locked in shock. I wrapped my lips back around Tom’s dick and sucked it like I did in front of Will – for show. I drew out Tom’s pleasure and anticipation, reveling in making Sally a witness. After a long minute of licking, kissing, and sucking just enough to edge him, Sally still had not moved. I turned my eyes directly to her again as I licked the entire length of Tom’s shaft. Her eyes met mine. Then I launched my mouth back on to Tom, stroking him and fucking him with my mouth.

“Fuck,” Tom groaned again. I locked my mouth on the head of his cock and flicked it with my tongue while furiously stroking his shaft, gripping it firmly. Tom erupted into my mouth and down my throat. I tried to suck him and swallow in time with his spasms. His torso collapsed downward, and he held my head in his hands, pushing me from his cock

when he could take no more. I looked at Sally as she watched me bite my lower lip, tasting what was left of Tom's orgasm.

"Jesus Christ," she whispered, her breathing labored.

The room was silent as Sally and I stared at each other. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. Three Mississippi. Suddenly, she about-faced and walked quickly to the door, grabbing her purse along the way.

I stood back up and kissed Tom goodbye. "Sorry. I'd better go." I hurried to the door. "I'll call you later," I said on my way out. Sally was leaning against the passenger side door. I unlocked it for her with my remote, and she got in. I climbed into the driver's seat.

"Sorry," I whispered, looking at the steering wheel.

"Jesus Christ, Lily," she replied.

I wanted desperately for her to understand. "The sex is even better," is all I could think of to say.

Sally rubbed her forehead. "So, you're just going to abandon Will for some older guy with a nice body part and a one-bedroom condo?"

"I'm not abandoning Will!" I argued. "He watched me do the exact same thing four days ago. Twice! And he loved it, Sally. Hell, it was his idea! Don't be so fucking judgmental."

"I'm sorry. I'm just having a hard time with this whole thing. I mean, Jesus, Lily. I just watched you suck some guy's dick right in front of me, and you want me to act like this is all normal."

"You didn't leave."

Sally turned her head away and looked out the passenger-side window.

"You could have. But you didn't," I reiterated. Point me.

I started the car and made for Sally's house. Neither of us said a word. I didn't even turn on the radio. When we pulled in her driveway, before she could open her door, I said, "I love you."

Sally turned her head back my way without quite looking at me. "I love you, too," she said. She got out and walked inside without turning around.

I didn't speak to Sally until we both worked again on Monday. I wanted to give her some time. We found ourselves alone in the breakroom during a lull.

"Are we okay?" I asked timidly.

"Yes. We're okay," she conceded. "Look, I understand the attraction. And if you and Will are into the swinging thing or whatever it is you're doing, it's really none of my business. I just hope you know what you're doing."

I hugged her and kissed her on the cheek.

"Careful," she chided playfully. "I know where your mouth has been."

I chuckled and then teased, "I think you liked it."

"Did not!" Sally protested. "It was just...," she couldn't help but smile, "...impressive."

"I told you."

"So, are you a size queen now?"

"It's not even that," I replied. I had desperately wanted this conversation ever since the first time I was with Tom. I didn't have anyone to talk to about it. "It's how he is, you know? The whole thing. He takes me. Like, dominates me. In a good way. I would do anything that man told me to do. Like what you saw the other day. I never wanted to do that for anyone before. Now I can't wait to get on my knees like a little whore," I giggled.

"Did you...you, know...this weekend? With Will, I mean?"

I nodded.

"But you don't have sex in front of Will?"

"No."

"I don't get it. Will likes to watch you...you know...do stuff...but not have sex?"

"We have rules."

"Like what?"

“Anything I do for Tom; I don’t do anymore for Will.”

“So, no blowjobs for Will?”

“Nope. And so far, that’s mostly it. Except my tits. And Tom is allowed to use his hands on me.”

“Alrighty, then. To be clear, Will has no idea about all the other stuff?”

“No.”

“Did you tell Will about last Thursday?”

“God no.”

“So, he doesn’t know...you know...that I watched you.”

I examined Sally’s face. She did like it. I could tell. And she knew it. I shook my head. “No. He has no idea.”

“You see, that’s where you lose me. Why don’t you just stop the sneaking around? Fuck Tom in front of Will, say to hell with the rules, and let Will fuck you, too. Everybody wins.”

I looked at the floor. There were two answers to that. The technically correct answer was that Will had asked me not to have sex with Tom even though I was about fifty-one percent sure that deep down he wanted me to. And even if he did, Tom and I agreed that Will wasn’t quite ready to know quite yet. But the other answer was the truth.

“Can I be honest?” I asked.

“Please.”

“It’s the best part.”

“What is?”

I took a breath. “The cheating.”

Sally furrowed her brow. “What?”

“It’s like, the more wrong it is, the more I like it.”

“What do you mean?”

“I don’t know,” I sighed. “That night, after Tom and I were together for the first time, I laid in bed for hours trying to understand what was going on with me. The sex was amazing, don’t get me wrong. Life altering.

But that wasn't it. Not really. I finally realized that what it was ...what it was that made me feel so...complete...was the cheating. I've never cheated on anyone or anything before. I never cheated in school. Never cheated on my taxes. Never stole a pack of gum. Nothing. But begging another man to fuck me in my husband's bed on our anniversary was the best feeling I have ever had. *Ever*, Sally. I've spent every day since then trying to get that feeling back."

"Jesus, Lily."

"I know."

"Maybe you need to talk to somebody?"

"Maybe."

"Code Blue! Code Blue!" someone yelled.

CHAPTER 9

Yet Another First

“I’m bored,” Sally’s text read.

“I’m at Tom’s watching a movie,” I replied. “You’re welcome to come over. Do you remember where he lives?”

“Idk.”

“Relax. We’re just watching a movie. We already did the other thing. We have lasagna.” My lasagna was Sally’s favorite thing on the planet. I texted her the address. I knew she could find Tom’s house. She’d already been there once before. I was just prodding her.

“On my way.”

Sally showed up about thirty minutes later. I fed her a plate of lasagna, and we all settled in the living room to start another movie. I cuddled next to Tom on the couch. Sally took the recliner. About twenty minutes into the movie, when everyone had relaxed into the plot, I laid down and rested my head on Tom’s lap. Sally glanced over when I moved, quickly returning her attention to the movie. Tom stroked my hair. I ran my hand up and down his thigh. I could see Tom’s cock growing, creeping further down his pant leg toward my hand, like it was seeking out my touch. I gradually caressed him further up his thigh until I was brushing the tip of his burgeoning erection. I waited, teasing him until he was fully hard, before I finally squeezed him through his shorts. Tom sighed quietly. I could see Sally shift ever so slightly in the recliner. She was aware. Unlike the last time she was at Tom’s, she had driven herself here. She could leave at any point. There was nothing between her and the door.

I massaged the shaft of Tom’s cock through his pants. I was being subtle but not making any real attempt to hide what I was doing. Tom

intermittently exhaled noticeably as I rubbed him. I could see Sally cut her eyes in my direction without moving her head. I had to shift onto my belly and up onto my elbows to unsnap Tom's pants. Sally glanced briefly and saw what I was doing before turning back to the screen and pretending she was unaware. I unzipped Tom's pants. He lifted from his seat just enough to slide them down to his thighs along with his boxer shorts. I took his cock by the base and angled it straight up, announcing its meaty presence for Sally if she cared to look. Part of me knew what I was doing was wrong. I knew I shouldn't be dragging my best friend any further into the mess I was making. But I wanted company. And I wanted another ride on the rollercoaster. Cheating on Will with Tom hadn't become boring, but it wasn't enough anymore to give me what I was after.

There was no need to rush. I was going to take my time. I slowly licked Tom's cock like I was tending to a melting popsicle, keeping an eye on Sally all the while. Her head turned just a tiny bit in my direction, and she cut her eyes yet again, stealing a split-second peek. Her hands were in her lap, slowly fidgeting. I rested my head on Tom's stomach and started lazily sucking his cock. After a few turns in my mouth, he groaned quietly, but loud enough that Sally could easily hear it. She turned her head just enough to look over. Her gaze lingered. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. After silently taking a deep inhale, she turned her head back to the screen. I could see her hands fidgeting more, her breath deepening.

I propped myself back up on my elbows and started working Tom's cock more deliberately. He gathered my hair in his hands and pushed me further down on his shaft. I made an unmistakable gagging sound as his cock challenged my throat. Tom released me, and I pulled my head back up and gulped the air, a long stream of precum dangling from my face to Tom's dick. I looked at Sally. She was staring back at me. I gave her a sweet smile. Sally swallowed. She didn't turn away. I returned to Tom's shaft, giving Sally a show like I had in the kitchen the last time she was there. I got up on my knees, still sideways on the couch, to get a better angle. Tom slid his hand down my back and pulled my sundress up enough to slide his hand between my legs. I wasn't wearing any underwear. We'd already had sex earlier, and I hadn't bothered putting my bra or panties back on. Tom played with my wet pussy, knowing exactly how to navigate me. My face hovered over his cock, enjoying his touch, looking at Sally, and cooing my pleasure

through pursed lips. Sally looked back at me; our eyes locked. She swallowed deeply again and licked her lips, leaving her mouth open, watching the pleasure on my face. I was feeling more and more confident that she wasn't going to run away.

I kissed Tom, his cock still in my hand. I looked back at Sally. She was still watching. We briefly made eye contact before I swung my leg over Tom, straddling him. I reached down and guided him inside of me underneath my skirt. I cradled his face and kissed him as I slid down his shaft and began to ride him. I worried if I might have gone too far and halfway expected to hear the door. But all I could hear was the sound of me, Tom, and if I listened very carefully, Sally breathing heavily. It occurred to me that Sally had the remote and must have muted the television. I knew I couldn't look back far enough over my shoulder to see her from that angle, so I didn't bother trying. But Tom could. At first, he only looked at her for a brief second or two. Then he fixed his gaze on her while we fucked. I gauged her reaction by the look on his face. I lifted my sundress over my head and tossed it to the floor, letting Sally see me. She'd seen me naked a thousand times, but never in the act of sex.

With his brute strength, Tom lifted us both from the couch and positioned me so that he was lying down with me still on top of him. I could see Sally clearly now. Her arms were folded across her chest. She was covertly pinching one of her nipples between her fingers through her sundress. We bought a few of them together at the beginning of the summer. Her left leg was crossed over her right, pointing in my direction. We locked eyes for a moment before Tom pulled me down to him. I buried my face in the far side of his neck as he grasped my hips and thrust into me hard and fast. Tom's thrusts made my moans vibrato as I came loudly. I knew what Tom was doing. He was putting on a show for Sally like I had, flaunting how well he could make me come.

His point made, I slid off of Tom to the floor, and he sat back up on the end of the couch closest to Sally. I walked on my knees to get between his legs and suck his cock again. Sally was close enough that when I got into position, my bare ass bumped her foot. She uncrossed her legs, giving me more room. She uncrossed her arms as well, pressing her hands between her thighs, breathing deeply through her mouth. I turned my head occasionally to peek at her as I serviced Tom's dick. She wasn't just

watching me go down on Tom; she was studying my body. She had one hand on her breast, and the other was pressing into her upper thigh. She couldn't quite bring herself to masturbate. But I knew she wanted to.

Tom slid off the couch to his knees on the floor. He manhandled me toward the recliner so that I was standing on my knees, naked, directly in front of Sally. Tom slid under me, on his back. I lowered my pussy to his mouth. I leaned back, supporting myself with my hands on Tom's body, giving both Sally and I a bird's-eye view of his tongue expertly pleasing me. I stared at Sally as Tom worked me toward another orgasm. She was rubbing her nipple in a circle through her dress and doing the same in her thigh, still not able to give in and play with herself. When Tom made me come, my body clenched, and I naturally folded in on myself. I lost my balance and fell forward, my head collapsing onto the seat of Sally's chair between her legs. Tom slid out from under me and lined up behind me, pulling up on my hips and putting me in position to get fucked. I clung to Sally's knees with my hands, looking up at her, both of us panting.

Tom's deep voice broke the silence. "Do you want us to stop, Sally?"

Sally's eyes shifted quickly between me and Tom.

"Do you want us to stop?" he asked again softly.

Sally looked at Tom and swallowed. "No," she whispered almost inaudibly, shaking her head.

The moment the word "no" was out of her mouth, Tom eased his entire length inside of me. I fell forward with a moan, sliding my hands up Sally's skirt to her hips. I could feel her panties under my fingertips. My head came to rest on top of her dress in the middle of her thigh, my chin along the hemline. With each thrust, Tom pushed me further up Sally's thigh, dragging her skirt up with me. I grasped her hips tightly, still holding on as I felt Tom pull me up by my ponytail. Sally's legs were spread wide from accommodating my intrusion. I pulled back against her hips with Tom's slow and steady rhythm, causing her to grind back and forth in the recliner. Sally sat up straight and scooted forward to the edge of the recliner, bucking with the rhythm of me still pulling on her hips. She moaned with pleasure for the first time as her sex rubbed against the chair.

Tom released my ponytail, and my head fell onto Sally's shoulder. She instinctively supported my naked torso with her arm until I could balance myself with my hands on the arms of the chair. Tom slowed his pace and the mood turned sensual. Sally continued grinding herself against the chair along with me and Tom. The sides of our faces pressed together, our breath in each other's ear. I kissed the side of her neck gently. Just once. I felt her breath change. I pressed my tongue to the same spot before kissing it again. A moment later, she did the same to me, letting me know I was not unwelcome. I pulled back slowly until we were face to face, our lips millimeters away, breathing into each other's mouths. Tom slowed his pace even further, teasing me with his cock, letting my flirtation with Sally play out. Sally and I stared into each other's eyes. I kissed her bottom lip. She squeezed my top lip between hers. I pulled my head back just enough to look into her eyes.

"I love you," I mouthed.

We kissed again. Sally and I had kissed once before, years ago, after a night of heavy drinking. Neither of us were married at that point, and I knew that she had made love to a few women. I wanted to see what it was like to kiss a girl. It was awkward then. It wasn't awkward anymore. Sally cradled my face and kissed me deeply and lovingly. I kissed her back, savoring the feeling of her soft lips and gentle tongue. Sally and I had been friends our entire lives, but I never felt closer to her than I did in that moment.

"Take off your dress," I whispered.

Sally looked at me with her eyes glazed over. Tom backed away, freeing me to help Sally off with her dress. She reflexively reached back and unclasped her strapless bra, leaving her only in her white panties. We kissed again. She joined me on her knees on the floor. Our breasts pressed against each other as I pulled her close. Sally took the initiative and kissed her way down my neck to my breast. She tongued and sucked my nipple, gently kneading my flesh with her smooth hand, better than any man ever had. After she found her way back to my mouth, I eased my way down her neck to echo her affections. I lowered my hands to her backside, cupping her ass in my palms as I explored her breasts with my mouth. Sally's chest

was heaving. I had already come twice. Her pussy remained untouched. I signaled for her to stand up by pulling her upward by her hips. Sally rose to her feet, and I slipped my fingers under the sides of her panties. I pulled them down past her thighs to her calves, guiding them past her feet as she stepped out of them. I slid my hands back up her long legs, letting my thumbs brush the inside of her thighs on their way to her hips. I gently pushed her backwards, signaling to her that I wanted her to sit in the recliner. She sat down, and I started kissing my way up the inside of her leg, beginning just above her knees, and slowly working my way up her thighs. I was nervous and excited at the same time. I had never gone down on a woman before. If that was to be my first time, I was glad it was with Sally. Once I reached the top of her thigh, I looked up at her, staring down at my face centered between her legs. I couldn't help but wonder if she had ever fantasized about this moment. I looked at her wet, engorged pussy. Sally's body was literally quivering with desire. I looked into her eyes and licked the air directly in front of her pussy. She gulped and took a shallow breath.

"Please?" she whispered in quiet desperation.

I kept my eyes locked with hers and eased my head forward, finally pressing my tongue to her soaking labia. Sally exhaled forcefully, her breath shaky. I licked her again.

"Yes," she whispered louder.

I continued, letting Sally's breath and body guide me. As Sally and I found our way, Tom found his way inside of me again. So, there I was, cheating on my husband with my secret lover and my best friend. The feeling was nearly as thrilling as the first time Tom took me on my anniversary. Sally took my head in her hands and started bucking against my tongue as I licked her.

"Yes!" she screamed.

I did my best to hold on while Tom fucked me from behind and Sally fucked my mouth. I wrapped my arms around her legs as she squeezed my head between her thighs and came.

"Oh god, Lily! I'm coming!" I can still hear those words from Sally's mouth echo in my mind to this day.

I licked Sally gently until she could take no more and pushed my head away. We smiled at each other. I think we both felt closer in that moment than we ever had. Tom pulled me back on top of him as he laid down on his back, continuing to fuck me without breaking stride. From where she sat, Sally had a perfect view of Tom fucking me. I watched her staring at Tom's cock, sawing in and out of me. I could see her thinking about joining in. I wanted to beckon her with my finger, but my hands were busy supporting me. Instead, I said, "Sally, please? I need you."

That was all she needed to hear. She got down on her knees between Tom's legs and began tonguing my clitoris as Tom fucked me. The sensation was amazing. To have Tom's girth inside of me and Sally's tongue licking me was a new level of ecstasy. I watched her tongue along my slit, sometimes straying to Tom's cock but never letting it linger. I knew Sally well enough to know that she was resisting the urge to cheat on her husband with another man. Hoping I could do it without Sally knowing I intended it, I eased my body backward just enough that Tom's cock slipped out. I waited to see what she would do. First, she took the opportunity to lick me hungrily and unabashedly for a moment without a man's obstruction. Then she gripped Tom's shaft and guided it back inside of me. Her tongue found my clit again, and I soon came as hard as I ever had. As I had done to her, Sally licked me gently afterward until I couldn't take any more. With Sally still on all fours between Tom's legs, I got on all fours facing her with my pussy hovering over Tom's face. I kissed Sally and then started licking Tom's cock. I kissed her again and then moved back to Tom's cock, this time kissing the bottom of his shaft and around his base, looking back up at Sally and pointing Tom's big mushroom head at her mouth. I ran my tongue back up Tom's shaft and kissed Sally again with Tom's cock barely an inch from our tongues. I slowly led Sally closer to Tom as we kissed until we were both tonguing the head of his cock. Briefly, I took the tip in my mouth and returned to kissing Sally. I did it again. I glided my tongue down his shaft a little and eased the head in Sally's direction. She hesitated, but then took it into her mouth. Soon we were taking turns with Tom's dick and kissing passionately in between. I sat up, straddling Tom's torso, and pulled Sally up with me. I kissed her deeply and explored her body with my hands. I moved my mouth to her breast and my finger to her pussy. Still playing with her clit, I kissed my way up to her ear.

“Please,” I whispered. “I want you to know what it’s like.”

Sally followed as I led her to straddle Tom. I held his cock and guided it as the tip pressed to her folds.

“Oh, god,” she whispered.

“It’s okay,” I whispered just before I kissed her and put my hands on her hips, gently pushing down.

“Oh, god!” she growled, loud enough for the neighbors to hear, as she sank onto the first few inches.

“It’s okay, baby.” I whispered in her ear. “Take your time. It’s gonna be so good.”

Sally looked down and started slowly fucking Tom, only going a little past the tip. As she found a slow steady pace, I moved back closer and gently caressed her breasts and torso.

“Oh, my god,” she moaned.

Sensing she could take more, Tom raised his hips and pushed deeper into her.

“Oh, fuck!” she whinnied.

Tom bucked gently upward, slowly working his way deeper. I found myself getting jealous that I couldn’t experience Tom again for the first time, the way Sally was at that moment. Beyond his anatomical advantages, there was just something about the way he handled a woman.

Sally’s face turned red and the veins in her neck and forehead bulged. “Oh, god, I’m gonna come!” she grunted.

Sally stared into my eyes with a blend of ecstasy and surprise as she came. Her whole body tensed, and I knew that she would finally understand. Tom gave her no chance to recover before he rolled her over onto her back and continued fucking her. I laid down next to her, fingering her clit and kissing her as Tom worked his magic. That’s the part I wanted Sally to understand. It wasn’t just his cock. It was the man.

Sally stared down at Tom’s cock inside of her, “I can’t believe he’s fucking me.”

I kissed her and caressed her.

“He’s fucking me!” she repeated.

Slowly her cries of disbelief changed to craving.

“Yes!...Fuck me!” she begged, moving her eyes back and forth from Tom fucking her to staring into his eyes. “Don’t stop!”

Tom played her well. Soon he and I had her on the brink again. She kept begging for more.

“Fuck me! Fuck me! Fuck me!” she growled.

Then, I couldn’t resist. “Yeah?” I breathed into her ear. “Do you want him to fuck that pretty, married pussy?”

Sally looked at me, starting to come.

“Oh, god!” she cried. I kissed her.

“Yes! I whispered. Come for me, sweetie. You look so beautiful.”

“Oh, fuck! I’m gonna come again!”

“Let it happen,” I whispered.

Sally’s voice rose two octaves. “Yes! Yes! Yes! Yes!” she chanted. I flitted my finger along her clit and sucked her nipple as she came again until she finally relaxed into the floor. Tom pulled her up to her knees in front of him, holding his cock in front of her mouth. Sally looked up at him. I knew what he was doing. He wasn’t forcing you. It wasn’t an obligation. It was appreciation. Good manners. A thank you. Submission.

I watched Sally submit. She didn’t half-ass it, either. Historically, she wasn’t as averse to going down on a man as I had been. In fact, she sucked Tom’s cock so well that I got a little concerned for a minute that Tom would favor her over me. I knew, however, that Sally was disgusted by the idea of actually swallowing a man’s load. So as Tom got closer to coming, I watched her jerk his cock, aiming it down at her chest. But he wasn’t coming. Sally put his cock back in her mouth and jerked the shaft trying to make him finally come. Tom started grunting. Sally didn’t cringe. She kept sucking the head of Tom’s dick and stroked his shaft even harder, sending his come directly into her mouth and down her throat. Tom shuddered as he came, finally pushing Sally’s head from his dick. My jaw dropped as I watched her resist, actually trying to get more out of him. She looked almost angry, like she was swallowing his load *at* him. Or maybe

she was angry at the situation. When he forced her head away, she came back and licked his shaft upward until she could wrap her lips around his tip one more time, defiantly making sure there was nothing left.

“God damn,” Tom admired.

Sally sat on her heels quietly for a moment. “Tom?” she finally asked tersely but politely. “Do you have any alcohol?”

“There’s some wine on the counter and I’m pretty sure there’s still some vodka in the freezer.”

Sally got up and walked into the kitchen. I heard the freezer door open and close.

“Give me a minute,” I whispered to Tom before I walked into the kitchen.

Sally was standing at the counter with her back to me. I walked up behind her and wrapped my arms around her belly, putting my head on her shoulder. I kissed her cheek the way I had a thousand times before and asked in my sweetest voice, “Are you okay?”

“I don’t want to talk about it,” she replied, taking a swig of vodka from the bottle. “I don’t want to think about it.”

She had, after all, just cheated on her husband for the first time.

“That’s okay,” I said as she turned around to face me. “We don’t have to talk.”

Her skin felt so good next to mine. I smiled and kissed her kindly on the lips. She smiled meekly back at me. I kissed her briefly again, in a less friendly fashion. She kissed back.

“It’s gonna be okay,” I whispered. “Come on.”

I took her by the hand and walked her through the living room toward the bedroom. Along the way, I gave Tom a look, letting him know that he wasn’t invited. Sally and I spent the rest of the afternoon making love. We never said a word other than to say, “I love you.” Tom was still blissfully asleep on the couch when Sally and I left to return to our unsuspecting husbands.

CHAPTER 10

The Pool Pump

As fate would have it, not long after Sally and I moved beyond the conventions of friendship, our pool pump motor stopped working. It just so happened that her husband, Eric, owned the second-largest pool company in town. It had been the biggest when he inherited it from his father. The pump motor failing was not an uncommon occurrence. Our system had some mysterious quirk that caused it to chew through motors every year or two. Despite the fact that Eric had multiple repairmen working for him, he always came over himself to replace the pump on a weekday when I was the only one home. Eric had always had a thing for me. Back in college, we actually flirted for a while before I found out Sally had a crush on him. Will was twice the man Eric was, but if I'm being honest, Eric was better looking. He was taller, more muscular, and, like Tom, had the masculinity of a man who worked with his hands. I probably would have at least gone out with him once or twice to test the waters if Sally hadn't been interested in him. Even after he married Sally, I routinely caught Eric checking me out. It was almost an unspoken inside joke between the two of us. I had even caught him looking at me in my bridesmaid's dress on their wedding day. It didn't bother me. I was used to men looking at me. He only actually hit on me once, after he and Sally got together. It was back in college, before they got married, after he and Sally had a big fight. He came to my dorm room drunk to talk to me about Sally and ended up trying to make a move. I pushed him off of me and kicked him out. He came back the next day with his tail between his legs and apologized profusely. When I told Sally about it, she told me that he had already confessed. I respected him for that. So did Sally, apparently.

In my twisted brain at the time, because I knew Sally had cheated on her husband with me and Tom, I saw Eric coming over as the perfect

opportunity to even out the karma between them and, more importantly, for me to get a fix. It was a juicy rationalization, but deep down, I knew it was wrong. Incredibly wrong. Egregiously wrong. Sally was my oldest and dearest friend in the world. And Eric was her husband. In spite of that, I felt powerless to stop it. The need for a ride on the rollercoaster was just too strong. I couldn't ever seem to quite get the feeling I craved so badly unless I was breaking new ground, crossing some new forbidden line.

I was ready and waiting when Eric arrived. I was out by the pool, in the heat, tending to some plants when he walked into the back yard. I was wearing my khaki garden shorts and a ratty old concert t-shirt. Underneath, I had on my yellow bikini. Like my white one, it was nearly sheer when wet. I had discovered that when I rubbed oil into the material, it became almost completely transparent, though. It stayed that way until I properly washed it with soap and hot water to get the oil out. I had thoroughly coated it with oil before putting my shorts and t-shirt on earlier. Eric never stood a chance. I was bending over with a watering can when he arrived.

“Hey, stranger!” he smiled, announcing his presence.

“Hey, Eric,” I smiled.

I walked to him and kissed him on the cheek, something I almost never did with him. I added a hand on his chest for good measure. I knew at that point he would think I was just being nice because he was coming over to fix our pool.

“Thank you so much for coming.”

“No problem. I'll just go ahead and get to work if that's okay with you.”

“Sure. You know where everything is. Let me know if you need anything.”

I busied myself with the plants for about five more minutes before walking to the pool shed. “Hey Eric? Is it okay if I get in the pool and cool off, or will that mess you up?”

Eric was busy fiddling with the old motor. “Sure, yeah. It’s no problem.”

From where he was working, he could easily see around the corner to the pool if he turned his head. I made sure to stand where he could see me as I peeled off my shirt and bent over to push my shorts down. I could see Eric watching me in my peripheral vision as I sauntered down the steps into the pool. I walked through the shallow end and dipped my head backwards into the water, slicking my hair back as I reemerged.

“Oh, this feels so good,” I called loudly across the pool to Eric. “You should come in when you’re done.”

“Oh, I don’t swim in them. I just fix ‘em, darlin’.”

“Suit yourself.”

Little did Eric know; he was going in the pool whether he wanted to or not. I waited until he was done fixing the pump and stalked the edge of the pool. As he walked by, I jumped up, grabbed him by the shirt, and pulled him into the water.

“What the hell, Lily?” he blustered, coming up for air.

“Feels good, though, doesn’t it?” I argued just before I splashed him.

He splashed me back and started chasing me around the pool until he caught me. He wrapped his arms around me and tossed me to the deep end. I giggled and screamed as he manhandled me. His hands got a good feel of my ass as he did, too.

“I didn’t bring a change of clothes, Lily,” he complained.

“Relax, you big baby. I’ll put your stuff in the dryer. I’ll fix you lunch while you wait.”

“And in the meantime, what am I supposed to wear?”

“You can wear some of Will’s stuff.”

“I don’t know that anything of his will fit. No offense.”

“Just trust me, knucklehead.” I had just the shorts in mind. Who knew gray cotton shorts and clothes dryers could be such powerful tools of seduction? I walked up the steps and out of the pool, taking my time and ringing out my hair so that Eric got a good look. My yellow bikini wasn’t a G-string like most of the others, but it clung to my skin when wet, and with the oil still soaked into it, it was almost like not wearing anything at all. In my opinion, the way it showed off my body was even sexier than a G-string.

Eric followed me out of the pool. He took off his shirt and started wringing it out as I dabbed myself dry, making sure to leave my suit as wet as possible. I handed my towel to Eric so he could dry off a little before following me inside. Just as I’d hoped, I caught him looking at my nipples through my swimsuit. I led him inside, giving him a good look at my backside, and had him wait in the extra bedroom while I went to get the gray shorts. As I walked back to give them to Eric, I turned them inside-out and tangled them up the best I could. I handed them to him and closed the door behind me. Like a sneaky child, I got on the floor and peeked under the door to look for his towel and his wet shorts to hit the floor. I counted two Mississippis before opening the door. Eric was standing with his back halfway to me, naked, and trying to sort out the gray shorts. I got a good look at his dangler before he noticed my presence.

“Jesus Christ, Lily!” he yelped and moved quickly to cover himself with the still-tangled shorts. “I’m naked!”

“Sorry,” I giggled.

“What the fuck?”

“I forgot to give you this,” I explained, handing him one of Will’s t-shirts.

He held the gray shorts in front of his business and took the shirt with his other hand.

“Could you hand me your wet clothes?”

“And how am I supposed to do that?”

“True,” I smiled. I walked to where the clothes were on the floor, just in front of him, and kneeled down to pick them up. Eric turned his body slightly in an effort to remain covered as my sightline changed.

I looked up at him as I stood up. I rolled my eyes. “You can relax, Eric. I already saw your dick.”

“You what?”

“I already saw it,” I said nonchalantly. “Don’t worry. You don’t have anything to worry about.”

“What do you mean, I don’t have anything to worry about?”

“I mean that you have a nice cock,” I shrugged. “I already knew. Girls talk, you know. Sally told me years ago that you have a really nice dick.”

“Well, thank you, Lily. That’s good to know,” Eric replied facetiously, his cheeks red.

I just stood there, enjoying how uncomfortable he was.

“Lily?” he complained.

“Oh, you’re not gonna show me your nice big dick again?” I teased, throwing in the “big” part for good measure.

I turned around and started making my way out the door. I “accidentally” dropped his wet shorts on the floor and bent over to pick them up just before closing the door behind me. I tossed his clothes in the dryer and made my way to the kitchen. As I was finishing Eric’s plate, he strutted in jokingly.

“What do you think?” he smiled, holding out his arms and spinning slowly. The shirt was comically small. The shorts were tight, like they had been on Tom, putting Eric’s ample bulge on full display.

“Well,” I giggled. “You definitely need to lose that shirt. The shorts aren’t too bad, though.”

“They look ridiculous,” he argued, pulling the shirt over his head and handing it to me.

“No, they don’t. They actually look pretty good on you. Better than they do on Will.”

I turned and picked up Eric’s plate and the two beers I’d pulled from the fridge before making my way for the back patio. I reminded myself as I walked in front of him that my wet and oiled suit was still teasing a view of my ass. I could feel the tension building. I had a feeling like I get when I’m next in line for the Fury 325 in Charlotte. I was nervous, too, though. No matter how attracted to me Eric was, there was still a chance he would choose to stay faithful to Sally. He took a seat at the table under the gazebo’s ceiling fan and started on his sandwich. I took a sip of my beer.

“I still need to rinse off,” I reminded myself out loud and made my way to the outdoor shower. I turned on the water and let it start running over my body. I turned just enough so Eric would feel safe looking at me while, at the same time, being able to tell out of the corner of my eye if he was watching. Once I knew I had his attention, I put on a show like I routinely did for Will and Tom. With all that practice, I’d gotten pretty good at it. I knew just how to bend and pose my body at all the right angles. By the time I was finished, one of Eric’s legs was crossed over the other, and his plate was in his lap. I dabbed myself dry again and walked to the table, bringing the coconut oil with me. I sat down and started applying the oil liberally and slowly all over my body. Eric tried to pretend he was focused on finishing his sandwich.

“Could you put some on my back?” I asked innocently.

“Sure.”

I stood there waiting. Eric just sat there, also waiting. “Well?” I asked impatiently.

“Just...come here,” he insisted.

“No. You come here.”

“No. You come here,” he repeated.

“No.” I let the awkward moment linger in the air for a bit. “Oh, my god!” I giggled. “You’ve got a hardon, don’t you?”

“I do not!”

“That’s it. Isn’t it! You’re hard for me!” I teased. Eric’s face turned red again. I reached for the plate in his lap, starting a tug of war. “Give it,” I giggled.

“No!” he refused.

I let my fingers slip from the plate and fell backwards onto my ass. Eric’s reflex was to hop up to help me, ditching the plate in the process. He took my hand, and as he helped me to my feet, I got a good look at his cock stretching the thin cotton of the shorts. While it didn’t rival Tom’s, I was genuinely impressed by how above-average Eric was. I played up my surprise.

“Holy shit!” I exclaimed. Eric covered his bulge with his hands. “That’s definitely bigger than what Sally told me. Talk about a grower, not a shower!”

Eric was visibly flustered. “What the hell, Lily? What did she tell you?”

“She just said you were average, that bitch. She was holding out on me. I should have known better. She’s always been a size queen.”

None of that was true. She’d never told me how big Eric’s dick was, only that it was “aesthetically pleasing,” and she had never been a size queen.

Eric was getting concerned. “What do you mean a size queen?”

“Dude, her boyfriends were always hung. That big black guy, James, she was fucking when she started seeing you; he had like close to ten inches or some crazy thing.”

“Who the fuck is James?”

“That guy from the football team she was seeing right before you guys got together.”

“Never heard of him.”

“Well, don’t be jealous. That was a long time ago. And, dude, seriously, it doesn’t look like you have anything to worry about. Had I

known what you were working with, I just might have let you have me that night. Do you remember that?" I laughed.

"Lily, come on. Stop it." Eric was blushing again.

"Move your hands. Let me see it."

"No!"

"Come on, Eric. You've been staring at me all day. It's only fair."

I tried to pull Eric's hands away from his crotch. As he resisted, my fingers inadvertently brushed his bulge. He was as hard as a diamond.

"Come on," I pleaded again. "I just want to see what Sally's working with. And how much she lied to me," I giggled.

I tugged at Eric's hands, knowing it was only forcing his hands to jostle his bulge, coaxing his cock even harder if that was possible.

"Fine," Eric relented, and put his hands behind his back. "Just don't tell Sally. Please? Ever?"

"I promise, if you promise not to tell her that I've been parading around for you in a bikini."

"Deal."

"Wow. You really do have a pretty big cock."

"Thank you...I guess," Eric said. I was really enjoying how uncomfortable he was.

"Can I tell you something, Eric?"

"Yes."

I spoke slowly and deliberately. "I like it when you look at me. I've always liked it when you look at me."

I reached back and untied my bikini top, dropping it to the concrete below. Eric's mouth fell open.

"I like it that you're hard for me."

I took the towel from the table and tossed it to Eric's feet before I stepped into his space. He stood paralyzed.

“I like knowing that you want to fuck me,” I whispered.

I put my hands on his chest and slowly started squatting down until my face was level with his bulge. I tucked my fingers into his waistband.

“I like knowing...”

I started pulling at his shorts.

“...that you think about me...”

I pulled his shorts down over his cock, letting it spring out in front of me.

“...sucking your cock.”

I licked his shaft. Eric never had a chance.

“Do you fantasize about me sucking your cock, Eric?”

He stared down at me, my lower lip brushing the head of his cock.

“Do you fantasize about your wife’s best friend sucking your big dick?”

I wrapped my lips around his tip and kiss it. Eric nodded. I smiled. He offered no resistance as I took his cock in my mouth. His moans as I sucked him didn’t satisfy me, though. I knew it was going to take more for me to get what I was after. I looked up at him, massaging his cock in front of my face.

“Just this once, I think we should do the things we’ve always wanted to do.”

“That might take a while,” Eric replied, his voice shaking, his eyes fixated on my mouth.

“Will doesn’t get home for another three hours. What do you say? Do you want to fuck me, Eric?”

I stood up and walked to the table, untying my bikini bottoms along the way and letting them fall to the ground. I bent over, resting my elbows on the table. The buildup was already making me wet, but I knew from Sally that one of Eric’s favorite things was to go down on a woman. Eric moved the towel between my legs for him to kneel on as he pressed his mouth between my cheeks.

“God, you taste good,” he gushed.

I teased him as pleased me.

“I can’t believe you’re licking me. After all these years. Fuck, you’re good at that.”

He really was. Impressively so. Better than Tom or Will. Not as good as his wife, though.

“You taste even better than I imagined,” he growled back. “I’m gonna make you come.” True to his word, in short order, he had me on the verge of coming. I sang his praises.

“Oh fuck, Eric! Yes! I’m gonna come! You’re gonna make me come,” I whimpered.

Eric didn’t let up until he was sure that I was satisfied. When he was done, I had a better understanding of why Sally put up with some of his less appealing qualities. Eric’s confidence seemed to have been bolstered, having done such a good job getting me off. He stood up and pressed his cock against my pussy.

“Tell me you want it.”

“Yeah?” I challenged.

He pressed his cock harder into me, almost penetrating me.

“Tell me,” he demanded again.

“I want you to fuck me, Eric. Fuck me the way you’ve always wanted to. Fuck your wife’s best friend.”

Saying those wicked words turned me on so much that I thought I would almost come again when he pushed his way inside of me. But I knew there was one more thing I needed before I could have my moment.

“Oh, fuck,” Eric groaned, giving me his full length.

I knew I had him right where I wanted him.

“You feel so fucking good, Eric... God, I should have let you fuck me a long time ago... You’re so much bigger than Will.”

“Yeah?” Eric grunted. I could hear the cockiness in his voice. “He can’t fuck you like this, can he?”

“Ooh, fuck. You’re so deep.”

Men are so predictable and easy to manipulate.

“Oh, my god. You feel so much better. I’ve never had a cock this big.”

Eric fucked me harder, spurred on by my praise.

“Yes. Fuck me!” I whined. “I’m gonna come!” I really wasn’t. I could have if we kept going, but I had something else on my mind.

After fake recovering from my fake orgasm, I turned and pushed Eric backward and stepped back from the table. I got on my knees and took his cock in my mouth again. As I sucked him, I pulled the cushion from one of the chairs and set it on the concrete. I pulled my mouth off and reached for the cushion from another chair, putting it next to the first one.

“Sally told me something else,” I said softly. “She told me what you want more than anything.”

Eric looked at me quizzically.

I turned around and got on my knees on one of the cushions. I reached up and took the coconut oil from the table.

“The one thing she’ll never let you do, no matter how much you beg.”

I pressed my head and shoulders against the cushion in front of me and lifted my ass. Holding the bottle directly over my backside, I released a steady stream of oil directly onto my asshole.

Eric stood there in shock, slack-jawed, stroking his cock.

“What are you waiting for?” I prompted. I could feel the anticipation rising.

Eric got on his knees behind me and slid his cock back inside my pussy. He fucked me slowly and spread my ass cheeks, coaxing my asshole wider. He took the oil and squeezed out some more, teasing my ass with his finger. He stayed still, slowly working his finger deeper. I rocked back and forth, fucking myself gently with his cock. I was surprised at how

pleasurable it was to have a finger in my ass. Will had never been that adventurous. Women on pedestals apparently suitable for anal play. We carried on this way until he had one finger deep inside and was using another to slowly ease me wider.

Eric eased his cock out of my pussy and dribbled some more oil onto it, working it along his head and shaft. I couldn't tell if I was nervous or excited, but I knew my ride was nearing the crest and I would soon have what I had been craving. Eric pressed the tip of his cock to my back door. At long last, I could see the peak just ahead.

I turned my head and said softly, "You're my first."

Eric looked at me even more lustfully, if that was possible.

"Tell me what you want," he demanded.

And finally, the fall. My glorious fix. No void. No emptiness.

"I want you to take what your wife won't give you...and what my husband's never had."

"Say it," he demanded.

"Fuck me in the ass."

I'd never said those words before, or anything resembling them. And on that day, they were the ticket to my ride on the rollercoaster. Giving Sally's husband what she refused him—betraying her, my husband, and Tom all at the same time—made me absolutely euphoric.

Eric eased the head of his dick through my outer ring. It was difficult at first, but he took his time and, despite his outward bravado, was as gentle and considerate as he could be. I masturbated to help me through and give myself some pleasure to counter my discomfort. I had never aspired to have anal sex. It was the satisfaction of doing what I wasn't supposed to do that I was after. My expectations for the actual experience were very low. But then, with Eric guiding me, my body relaxed. There was still a little discomfort, but I was quickly learning to appreciate the pressure and even beginning to derive some pleasure.

“Jesus,” I muttered. I wasn’t able to hide my surprise how good it was starting to feel. I was even starting to feel a tingle in my clitoris somehow. And the deeper Eric went, the more the pressure became reminiscent of how it felt when Tom first took me.

“That feels good,” I sang in a whisper.

“Enjoy it. It’s gonna get better for you. I can tell.”

Eric pushed a little deeper.

“Ooh, fuck,” I cooed. “How do you know?”

“Most girls don’t respond as well as you the first time. You were made for this, Lily. You’re going to love it.”

“So far, so good,” I smiled through my breathing.

“Keep rubbing your clit. Let me know when you’re ready.”

“Ready for what?”

“The rest of my cock.”

“Oh, my god. I can’t believe you’re in my ass.”

“It’s not so bad, is it?”

I turned my neck and shook my head.

“It feels good,” I panted. I kept rubbing my pussy as I kept adapting to the new sensations, learning how to experience them. “Talk to me.”

“Yeah? You want me to talk dirty while I fuck your little ass?”

Hearing him say “fuck your little ass” was an unexpected turn on.

“Ooh...yes...fuck my little ass.”

“Who knew that sweet perfect Lily Bradford was such a dirty little whore?”

“Yes!” I growled. I pushed back against his cock, taking him a little deeper.

“Are you ready?” Eric asked. “Do you want the rest of my big cock?”

“Yes. Fuck me! I want to know what it’s like.”

“Just remember. You need to relax, okay?”

I nodded and rubbed my clit, waiting.

Eric eased his cock most of the way back out. Then, with one stroke, he regained most of the ground he had given up. He pulled back again, and then deeper still. It was jarring, but amazing. The nerves in my ring were pinging like fireworks. The pressure deep in my ass was becoming more and more satisfying. I became less and less focused on my clit, letting Eric please me in a brand new way.

“You like it. I can tell.”

I would have called him smug if he weren't so right. “Yes,” I panted.

“I can't wait until I see Will again. I can't wait to shake his hand and think about how I buried my cock in his pretty wife's ass.”

“Oh fuck, yes!” I growled. “Fuck my ass.”

If Eric wasn't giving me his full length at that point, he was close to it. He was squatting over me and leaned forward so I could turn my head and see his face as he fucked me.

“Your pretty little asshole feels even better than your pussy,” he taunted.

“Yeah? You like my slutty little ass?”

“It feels amazing. Do you like having my cock inside you?”

I nodded with zealous appreciation.

“Do whatever you want to me.”

“I'm gonna make you come first.”

Eric pulled all but the head of his dick out and swiftly fucked the ring of my ass. My lips pursed and I flitted my finger across my clit again. I was missing the sensation of having his cock deeper inside me.

“Please?” I asked.

“Not yet.”

He continued teasing me until between my finger and his cock, I felt an orgasm building.

“Please?” I pleaded. “Fuck me. I need to come.”

Eric made me wait a few more moments until he could see in my eyes I was on the edge. In one stroke, he filled me, sending me off the cliff. My back arched and my head lurched back. Eric held me by my hips and put most of his weight on me as he had his way with me. I let out a loud yell as I came, taking an almost brutal fucking from my best friend's husband. It was a sound I'd never heard from myself before. I secretly hoped the neighbors heard me howling. After I came, all I could do was bury my face in the cushion and hold on until Eric was ready to come.

"Did you like that?" Eric growled.

I turned my head sideways and nodded, breathless.

"My turn."

Eric slowed down and savored the moment.

"You're so beautiful, Lily. I never thought this would actually happen."

"If I had known how good you could fuck me, we'd have done this a long time ago." That was a lie. Before Tom, I would never have cheated on Will.

"Yeah? You like the way I fuck you?"

"You fuck me so much better than Will."

"Oh fuck," Eric moaned. I could tell he was going to come soon.

"You have such a nice cock. It feels so good inside of me."

"Yes," Will groaned again.

"Come for me, baby. Come in my ass," I coaxed.

With one long grunt, Eric unloaded inside of me, closing the book on my anal virginity.

"That was amazing," Eric sighed, slowly easing himself out.

"Uh huh," I nodded, getting to my feet. "Come on. Let's get cleaned up." I took Eric's hand and led him inside through our bedroom and to the shower. We bathed each other, exploring each other's bodies under the water. When he got hard again, I squatted down and started sucking his cock.

“I’m surprised you’re doing that,” Eric confessed. “Sally said you never give Will blowjobs.”

“He doesn’t have a cock like yours,” I smiled before sucking him some more.

“Is it that bad?”

“No, of course not. It’s more like yours is that good, not his is that bad.” I moved his cock around with my hand, examining it. “There’s just something about your cock. It’s beautiful.”

“Why thank you,” Eric smiled arrogantly. I swear, it was like shooting fish in a barrel.

“You know, Eric. We can’t ever do this again.”

“I know,” he replied seriously.

“We still have some time, though. Do you want to fuck me in my bed? Where Will fucks me?”

“Yes, please.”

I stood up and kissed him. It felt weird. He’d just fucked the daylights out of me, but we hadn’t kissed. It made me think of standing next to Sally the first time she and Eric kissed as husband and wife. That made me even hornier.

“Do you want to come in my pussy this time?” I asked as I started making my way out of the shower. “I don’t let Will do that either.”

For the next few hours, I gave Eric everything he’d ever wanted and sent him home to Sally with the pact that we would never speak of it again.

The high I got from seducing Eric didn’t last long. By the time I finished showering again after he left, I hated myself. And then I was hollow again. Less than a week later, I was lying in bed with Tom. There was nothing ever routine about having sex with him, but the thrill of doing it behind Will’s back had tapered off until it was practically nonexistent. I had been struggling with that fact for a while by that point. I think part of the impetus for having sex with Eric was to avoid the inevitable. I knew that telling Will of my affair with Tom would surely get me a ticket to ride the rollercoaster. Probably even the best so far, possibly even exceeding the

first time I cheated on him with Tom. I'd imagined the look on Will's face a thousand times. The problem I had was that I could only do it once and I wanted it to be perfect. It needed it to give me the fix I craved, but it also needed to be done in such a way that it wouldn't destroy my marriage. Tricky business.

"Hey, baby?" I said, looking up at Tom.

"Yes?"

"I think it's time."

"Time for what?"

"To tell Will. Do you think he's ready?"

"I think it's about damn time. How do you want to do it?"

"Leave that to me. I've been thinking about it for days..."

CHAPTER 11

The Beginning of the Beginning of the End

“I wish you had a dick,” I said, looking up at Sally from her breast in the afterglow.

“What?” she laughed.

“I’d make babies with you,” I sighed with a smile.

“Aw,” she smiled back. “But what about Will...and Tom?”

“And Eric,” I thought to myself. Of all the selfish, deceitful things I had been up to, I hated myself for that the most.

“I love Will. And one day, we’ll make beautiful babies together.”

“Is he doing okay? I mean, with the new arrangement?”

“Sure,” I said less than confidently. “He likes it when he gets to watch.”

“Even though he doesn’t get to have sex with his own wife anymore?”

“That will just make it better when he finally gets to again.”

“And when might that be?”

“When I’m done,” I smiled.

Sally brushed my hair gently with her fingers. “What about Tom? Do you love him?”

I paused. I had never really thought about how to answer that question before. I think Will was too afraid to ask.

“Yes. I do. Not like Will. But he and Will...well...they’re both...men,” I grimaced.

Sally laughed again. She knew exactly what I meant. “But if I had a dick, then I’d be a man, too.”

“Dammit!” I laughed. “I can’t win!”

We kissed again, more intensely. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. I looked in her eyes. “I love you,” I mouthed.

“You just love me because you like the thrill,” she smiled, teasing me. She knew damn well I loved her. We’d been inseparable for most of our lives.

There was no more joking around. I shook my head, still staring into her eyes. “No. I love you. No matter what happens. I love you.” In my head, I whispered somberly, “I’m sorry.”

“I love you, too, Lil.”

I adored that woman. I kissed her again. Four Mississippi’s before I slowly worked my way down her neck to her breasts. Then her navel. Finally, between her legs. I set my mind with a singleness of purpose to please her. Unselfishly. Asking nothing in return. I knew she was in love with me. I think she had been for a long time. I had just been unaware of it before. I knew that I loved her, too. But not in a way that would make me want to leave Will and marry her. The very least I could do was make her body feel good. I made love to her with my mouth. The only sound in the room was our breathing. The sunlight beamed in through the window onto her skin and the clean white sheets. It was beautiful. I had learned the way she like to be touched. She liked her breasts squeezed as I tongued her clit. She liked her nipples pinched as she came. And when she had come, it was time for me to go.

“I have to go,” I whispered in her ear. “I’m late for Tom’s.”

“Okay,” Sally whispered back. I knew she didn’t want me to go. And she knew it was pointless to stop me. I got my pants on and pulled my shirt over my head. I didn’t feel the need to fuss with my hair or makeup. I was going to be naked again with my head pressed into a mattress in twenty-five minutes.

“Come with me,” I offered. I knew she’d enjoyed fucking Tom the one time she had. She’d been resistant to the idea ever since, though. The thought of sharing Tom with her again made me tingle. Then Sally said something that caught me off guard.

“I don’t want to share you.”

It never occurred to me that in our threesome with Tom, from her perspective, I was the one being shared, not Tom. My expression went flat with the sudden realization. “Okay,” I managed to whisper. “Jesus,” I thought. “What am I doing to her?”

I kissed her goodbye. “Love you. I’ll see you tomorrow.”

Sally smiled sweetly. “I love you, too.”

The closer I got to Tom's, the more guilt crept in without my permission. It wasn’t like with Will. Will, deep down, had wanted me to cheat and, like me, got some sick thrill from it. There was no denying that I was inevitably going to break Sally’s heart. Other than Will, she was the person I loved most in the world. I was on a mission to be in Tom’s bed with him inside me and forget the rest of the world for a while. Soon I was on all fours doing just that. I could still feel my guilt lurking in the background.

“I want a threesome,” I panted, my voice modulating with Tom’s thrusts.

“Yeah? You want me to fuck Sally again?” He pinned my head to the mattress and squatted behind me, fucking me deeper.

“No,” I whimpered, taking every bit he had to offer and trying not to come yet. “I want you to give me to one of your friends.”

Tom pulled my head back by my hair.

“I don’t share,” he said sternly as he fucked me. “I don’t even share you with your fucking husband!” I felt the sting of his palm on my ass. Thwap! And then again. Thwap! It was the hardest he’d ever spanked me.

“Uh,” I cried. I loved it. “Punish me,” I thought to myself.

“This is my fucking pussy!”

THWAP! THWAP! THWAP!

I whimpered. It was the roughest Tom had ever been with me. In the moment, that was exactly what I wanted.

“I better not catch you fucking anybody else,” Tom warned. I could tell he wasn’t just playing his usual dominant role. He was genuinely angry at me for suggesting he share me with another man. Outside of the one time at his house, I had kept sleeping with Sally a secret, so as far as Tom knew, he was the only person I was having sex with. Boy was he wrong.

THWAP! And again. THWAP!

“Fuck me!” I cried. “I’m gonna come!”

Tom brought me to orgasm as only he could. Then without a moment’s rest, he pulled me to my knees and gripped me by my hair. Jerking his cock and slapping me on my tongue with it, he grimaced, “You want to be a whore? I’ll treat you like a whore.” With that, he covered my face. When he was done, he had me clean his cock. It wasn’t a hardship. From the moment I saw him, I wanted to submit. A few moments later, he brought me a glass of wine and a warm wet washcloth.

“Are you okay?” he asked.

“MmmHm,” I nodded.

“Was I too hard on you?”

“No,” I shook my head. “It was perfect.”

“Good,” Tom smiled the charmingly devilish way I loved so much. “Finish your wine. I’m not done with you yet. You need to be reminded who you belong to.”

In that moment, I knew three things. I knew I was going to submit and let him do whatever he wanted with me. I knew I was going to love it. And I knew that I was going to cheat on him again with another man. I hadn’t thought of it before that moment, but something inside of me, something on a cellular level, needed to rebel against the slightest notion of being possessed. Sexual submission was one thing. Punishment was one thing. Possession was another. Tom fucked me repeatedly that day until we were both utterly spent. He punished me and made me beg for more. He

claimed me for his own. And when I got in my car to leave the next morning, the first thing I did was send a text. It was to Eric and read, “I need your cock in my ass again.”

CHAPTER 12

June

June was maybe the worst month of my life...

“Yes!” I panted. “Make me come! Make me come!”

Sally was darting her tongue between my legs and teasing my G-spot with her finger, coaxing the most exquisite orgasm out of me. She was even better at cunnilingus than her husband, not to mention heads and tails above Tom or Will. She was more delicate. More confident. She was like an artist, taking her time painting her masterpiece.

“Oh my god,” I whimpered. My high-pitched whines filled my bedroom as I came. In the silence that followed, I laid still, catching my breath, with Sally resting her head in my groin and kissing my thigh. “Oh my god,” I whispered.

For what seemed like the longest time, we didn’t move or speak. We just enjoyed the feeling. I finally gave in and broke the silence. “Have you ever thought about how many orgasms we’ve missed out on over the years? We should have done this ages ago. What a waste.”

“But then you wouldn’t have Will.”

“Sure, I would. Fuck him, anyway. He can watch. He likes watching,” I joked.

“You mean he likes watching you and Tom,” Sally corrected.

“Don’t get jealous,” I teased. “I’m sure Will would like watching you and me just as much.”

I had been noticing a sadness growing in Sally as we had become more and more intimate. I joked about it, but I knew Sally wasn’t really

jealous of what I had with Tom. She knew as well as I did that situation would inevitably end. What bothered her was that she knew I wasn't going to leave Will. She was jealous of him. There was no doubt in my mind that she would have left Eric for me if I asked her to.

"Lily?"

"Yes, my love?"

"I can't do this anymore."

Tears started to well up in Sally's eyes.

"What are you talking about?"

"I'm in love with you. And what we're doing, it's not fair to Eric. It's not fair to Will. And it's not fair to you."

"But Sally..."

She cut me off.

"Please. Let me finish. I know you love me. I know that. And I know you love *being* with me. But you're not *in* love with me. And you never will be. And that's not fair to me."

I thought about trying to convince her otherwise so I could keep things the way I wanted, but Sally knew me too well. She would see right through me. She already had. Other than attempting to lie or manipulate like had become second nature with the boys, I couldn't think of anything to say. Sally wasn't wrong. None of it was fair to anyone. Except me. I had been getting everything I wanted from everyone and given nothing back other than my carnal affections. Except, of course, to my husband. Sally's broken heart was my fault. She eased off the bed and started getting dressed. I grabbed her hand and held her in place. I started crying.

"Please Sally? I love you. Please don't leave me." Sally was the only person who even came close to knowing me at that point. I felt like if she left, I was going to be all alone in the huge mess that I'd made. She was my life raft in the middle of rougher and rougher seas.

"I'm not leaving you. You're still my best friend. I just can't keep hurting myself with you." Sally bent down and kissed me one last time. "I just need some time to myself. It's okay, Lily," she reassured me.

I couldn't do anything else but let her go. On her way out of the bedroom, she turned and gave me a gentle warning. "Be careful, Lily. All of this stuff you're up to—with Tom, the guys at work, and whoever else. Nothing good is going to come of it." Sally gave me a sympathetic little smile and whispered "I love you" almost silently before walking away. I had no idea how she knew about the two residents I'd been fucking at work. I cried for the rest of the day, and for the first time, I was truly scared.

I managed to pull myself together somewhat before Will got home. I showered, put on Tom's favorite cutoffs, and a little white V-neck t-shirt, just the way he liked. There was only one way I knew to make myself feel better. I was in the middle of writing Will a note telling him I'd see him in the morning when he walked in the door. Dammit, he was early.

"Hey Lily," he greeted, kissing me on the cheek. We hadn't kissed on the lips in weeks. Maybe longer. I tried not to think about it.

"Hey," I smiled as nicely as I could muster, trying to hide my disappointment at not being able to make a clean getaway. The keys in my hand made it clear I was getting ready to leave.

"Going somewhere?"

He knew where I was going. Things had been getting more and more awkward in the previous weeks. I had been spending more and more time with Tom, almost entirely without Will. I spent more nights at Tom's condo than in my own house with my husband. Tom's bed had begun to feel more like home. And I could tell that Will was growing more and more worried that I wasn't coming back.

"I was just leaving you a note," I said nervously. "I'm gonna go crash with Tom tonight." I started heading for the door. "I'll be back first thing in the morning before you leave for work." I opened the door and smiled, "Bye."

I knew that getting away Scot-free was too much to hope for.

"Lily?"

“Yes?”

Will looked at me sheepishly. “Can I come?”

“You can watch tomorrow,” I said, like a mother trying to let a young child down easy. “Do you want Tom to come home with me in the morning, or would you rather do it tomorrow night?”

Most of the time, I found some sick pleasure in Will’s anguish that turned me on, but the look on his face made me want to cry again.

“It doesn’t matter. Surprise me,” he said with a defeated half-smile.

I don’t even know how much he cared about watching me with Tom anymore at that point. I think he mostly just wanted a connection with his wife again.

I walked back into the kitchen and kissed him on the cheek. “Okay,” I smiled. “I’ll see you tomorrow. Love you.”

Will barely managed to get out an “I love you, too” before I was out the door.

As soon as I walked into Tom’s, I was all over him. Our routine had become to have some dinner and a few drinks before we got our clothes off, but that night I was on a mission. I desperately needed him to make me forget about Sally for even a short while.

“Don’t you want to eat first?” Tom asked, puzzled by my aggressive advances.

“No. I need you.”

I dropped to my knees and pulled down his shorts. I put his cock in my mouth, trying to get it hard. It didn’t take long. I looked up at Tom.

“I never get tired of sucking your cock,” I flirted.

“I never get tired of watching you,” he grinned.

I took Tom’s hand and put it on the back of my head, letting him know that I wanted him to take charge. He did most of the time anyway, but that was my way of letting him know that I wanted him to put aside any aspirations of gentleness. I wanted to be punished. I wanted to pay for what I had done to Sally. Tom gripped my hair and force-fed me his cock,

gagging me on his thick shaft. Then he tossed me effortlessly over his shoulder and marched me to his bedroom. He hastily stripped my clothes off, nearly tearing them. He pushed me to the bed and wasted no time going to work between my legs with his tongue. It was nice, but not at all what I was looking for. Plus, it almost instantly reminded me of Sally. I gripped his head in my hands and pulled him toward my face.

“Fuck me,” I grimaced.

Tom put himself inside of me. He wasn’t fucking me hard enough to make my mind stop torturing me, so I rolled him over and got on top. I fucked him hard, taking everything he had with each bounce. Tom could tell I was on a mission and held on for dear life as I used him. Finally, my mind was blissfully blank, with no thoughts of Sally, Will, or even myself to ruin my escape. As I neared my climax, I buried Tom’s cock inside of me and dug my fingers into his stomach, grinding my clit back and forth in his lap like a madwoman until I came. Tom rolled us back over and began gently making love to me. He kissed me longingly.

“I love you, Lily,” he whispered.

I couldn’t escape. I said the only thing that I could say in that moment. “I love you, too, baby.”

That wasn’t the first time we’d said those words. And I did love Tom. At one point, I thought I might have even been falling *in* love with him. But I wasn’t. And in that moment, I didn’t care if he loved me or not. I wanted him to make me forget. As wonderful as it felt as Tom moved inside of me, I couldn’t help but think of Sally. I imagined it was her making me feel that way. I started to cry. Tom kissed me tenderly again. I kissed him back, giving into the pain of loss. Tom knew well how to make my body respond and soon I was nearing another orgasm to accompany his.

“Stay inside me,” I sniffled through my tears. I started to come. “Yes,” I whimpered. Tom let out one long satisfied groan as he filled me with his orgasm. He kissed me again before rolling to my side. I tucked myself into him and he held me.

“Are you okay?” he asked.

I nodded.

“What happened?”

“I had a fight with Sally.”

“What about?”

There was no way I could tell Tom the truth about what happened, but I stayed as close to it as I could.

“She doesn’t think I should see you anymore.”

“Did you tell her it’s none of her fucking business?”

“Not in so many words.”

“Besides, who is she to judge? She wasn’t complaining when my dick was inside of her.”

“It wasn’t like that, Tom. Can we please talk about something else?”

“Sure. Let’s talk about you moving in with me.”

“What?” I was taken aback. I thought I had made it clear early on that I wasn’t planning on leaving my husband.

“It only makes sense. You already spend way more time here than you do at your place. You have clothes hanging in my closet, underwear in my dresser, makeup and shampoo in the bathroom. You practically live here already.”

I knew Tom was in love with me. What he lacked was the same insight as Sally.

“Tom,” I said softly. “I’m married to Will. Remember?”

“Lily, you left that guy a long time ago.”

“No, sweetie. Will is still my husband. That doesn’t mean I don’t love you. And it doesn’t mean that I don’t love what we have together.” I lifted my gaze so I could look Tom in the eye. I kissed him to reinforce my point. “But I can’t leave Will.”

Tom’s voice got louder. “Then what the fuck are we doing here, Lily?”

I tried to reassure him. “Tom, it’s okay. I’m not going anywhere.”

“So, what am I to you? Just some fuckboy?” he yelled, sliding out of bed.

“No. It’s not like that,” I insisted.

“When is the last time you fucked your husband? Huh?” Tom demanded.

I shrugged. “I don’t know. What does it matter?”

“And where did you come after you had a fight with Sally?”

I looked at the floor.

“Where do you come anytime something's bothering you?”

Tom angled his head, trying to capture my gaze. I didn’t give it to him. “When was the last time you even kissed your husband, Lily?”

I stayed silent.

“I love you, Lily. And you love me. You’re mine. Whether you want to admit it or not, you’ve already left him. You belong to me now.”

That last part lit the fuse to a bomb that had been ready to go off for longer than I ever realized. I caught a glimpse of how deep the well of anger and hurt inside of me actually was. Tom was only scratching the surface.

“I don’t belong to anybody, motherfucker!” I screamed and pushed Tom as hard as I could. It barely budged him, but I was undeterred. “I don’t belong to you! I don’t belong to Will! I don’t belong to Sally! You motherfuckers don’t get to tell me what to do!”

I slapped Tom’s chest over and over until he grabbed my wrists. I struggled against him. “You think just because I let you fuck me and spank my ass that you get to own me, you fucking asshole? I wouldn’t leave my husband for Sally, and I’m not going to leave him for you!”

Tom, suddenly realizing the truth about me and Sally, pushed me away from him and onto the bed. It wasn’t gentle, but it was way more gentle than he could have been. I knew he wasn’t trying to hurt me. He was the one who was hurt.

“Get out,” he said flatly.

My anger turned to sorrow on a dime. I sobbed uncontrollably. I got dressed as quickly as I could. In one day—not even—in less than three hours, I had lost both Sally and Tom. All I was left with was my own miserable wretchedness. Tom had obviously been living with the belief that he and I would be riding off into the sunset together. I don’t know what I had expected to happen, but it wasn’t that. Maybe I just thought he should be grateful to be with me. To be honest, I hadn’t really considered anyone else’s feelings much at all. I just wanted my fix, my ride on the rollercoaster. It’s obvious now, though, that Tom wanting me to leave Will was inevitable. The grief of Sally and Tom both breaking up with me in one day was more pain than I had ever experienced. I had to sit in my car for twenty minutes until the tears subsided enough that I could see well enough to drive the two minutes to my house.

It wasn’t much past dinner time, so I knew Will would still be awake. I was hoping that he would be in the office with his headphones on and wouldn’t hear me, at least for a little while. But he wasn’t. He was sitting quietly in the living room with a glass of scotch. I walked into the kitchen, still somehow hoping I could delay the inevitable.

“Lily?” Will said, walking into the kitchen. His face dropped when he saw how disheveled and upset I was. “What wrong?”

“It’s okay. I’m fine,” I said dismissively. It was obvious that I was lying.

“No, you’re not. What happened?”

I sighed. “Tom broke up with me.” I could have added that Tom had asked me to move in with him. But I didn’t.

Will’s expression changed again. Nearly, but not quite, all compassion left his face. It wasn’t surprising, considering his wife just told him that her boyfriend dumped her.

“I don’t know what to say, Lily.”

Will reached into the cabinet and retrieved another tumbler. He poured a generous amount of scotch into the glass and slid it across the counter toward me. He knew I hated scotch.

“I don’t have anything else in the house.”

“Thanks,” I said, and drank the whole thing in one big gulp. Grimacing and still feeling the burn in my throat, I poured myself another. “I’m gonna go lay down,” I said. Will nodded stoically. He had that monk-like look in his eyes again, where you could only guess what was going on in his mind.

I walked to the bedroom and laid down. I couldn’t help but recall the first time I was in that same bed with Tom. An hour or so later, I was still staring at the wall and ruminating over Sally and all of the chaos since I first succumbed to my baser urges with Tom. “Nothing good is going to come from it,” Sally said. I knew she was right. I knew I should stop. I knew I should save myself for Will and only Will and rededicate myself to my husband. Just as I was thinking that very thing, he walked into the room. He spooned me on the bed and kissed me on the neck, just below my ear. I could smell the scotch on his breath. He kissed my neck again, lingering longer. I knew what he wanted. I knew I should stop all my foolishness and make love to him. But it hadn’t been longer than a few hours since I was with Tom, and as crazy as it sounds, I felt like if I slept with Will in that moment, it would make me a whore.

“Will, I can’t. I’m sorry.” I whispered.

“I’m still your husband, Lily,” he whispered back. I could hear the controlled irritation in his voice.

“I know. And it’s just you and me now.” I was well past the point of limiting myself to telling only little white lies. Even though things were over with Sally and Tom, there were still the doctors at work and the random strangers from the grocery stores and the coffee shops that not even Sally knew about. There was also, of course, Eric. Roller coasters rides had become very hard to come by. In the previous month or so, I had begun going to extremes in pursuit of the only thing I knew that made me feel normal anymore.

“I need some time,” I whispered.

Will took a deep breath and exhaled his frustration. He eased off the bed and left the room without saying a word. Through the vents and the ductwork of the house, I could hear him fix yet another drink and walk to his office to play guitar. I hadn’t heard him play in weeks. I hadn’t been

around to. He played the most beautiful, haunting, mournful tune I'd ever heard. I was certain I had never heard it before. I wondered if it was his. It fit my mood perfectly and as sad as it was, it was also somehow soothing. I mercifully fell asleep, still in my clothes, mascara still on my cheeks.

I woke up before Will but laid in bed pretending to be asleep until he left for work. I took a much-needed hot shower and forced myself to eat a healthy breakfast. Emotionally, I still felt like an absolute wreck. I knew that was going to take some time. A lot of time. Physically, I was starting to come back online. I looked at the empty bottle of scotch still sitting on the counter. I thought about going to the liquor store and getting some vodka to numb myself. Alcohol was not my drug of choice, though. It was Will's. I knew what I wanted. My phone dinged as if on cue. It was Eric:

"Sally's working. Her schedule changed for some reason. Want to meet at my place for a change? Or still yours?"

I knew I shouldn't. Especially after what happened with Sally the day before. What kind of monster would I be?

"Yours," I replied.

Two hours later, I was on all fours in Sally's bed with her husband's cock buried in my ass. There is no way to justify the sick pleasure I got from fucking my best friend's husband in her own bed. The day before I was absolutely grief stricken. I still was, but just as much, I needed a fix. Doing the most duplicitous thing I could imagine was just the thing.

"Fuck me!" I grunted, fingering my clit while Eric had his way with me.

"Jesus, you feel so fucking good!" Eric panted.

"Yeah?" I growled. "You like fucking my ass?"

"Fuck yeah," he growled back. "Whoever would have thought that *the* beautiful Lily Adams would get off so hard from having a cock in her ass?"

Eric pushed my head into the mattress and slapped my ass. He was nowhere near as good as Tom at spanking me, but I let him do it. I always felt like I deserved it. I whimpered into the new comforter I had helped Sally pick out not long before Eric fucked me for the first time. Eric

and I stopped taunting each other and focused on taking in the pleasure. We had learned each other's bodies quite well by that point, and the sex was excellent. It wasn't as good as with Tom or Sally, but it was still amazing. It was far better than anything I'd known before Tom, in my previous life with Will. Eric was drawing the pleasure out, edging the two of us, keeping us at the peak of pleasure that exists right before you begin to climax. I was moaning softly and floating in another world when my heart stopped.

"Lily?"

Sally's desperate voice broke my trance. I looked up to see the woman I loved most in the world with the most awful look of shock on her face that I'd ever seen. I was frozen. Eric, too; his cock still inside me. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. Sally turned and rushed out the door. I looked over my shoulder at Eric. We locked eyes.

"Finish me," I whispered. Of all of the horrible things I've done, saying those words mere seconds after Sally caught me with her husband is the thing of which I am most ashamed.

Eric fucked me with purpose, bringing us both to orgasm in just a few minutes. I think we both knew it would be our last time together. I came so hard, so perfectly, and so despicably, imagining Sally listening to me beg her husband to fuck me in the ass. I stared blankly at the floor for a few minutes before finally getting up and putting my clothes on, not knowing if Sally was still in the house. I walked quietly down the hall lined with photographs, some of which I was in, others of which I had taken. I turned the corner into the living room. No Sally. I made my way to the kitchen and looked out the window. Her car was gone. I left without saying goodbye to Eric. I knew it wasn't likely he and I would ever speak again.

I drove home and took my time getting ready for work. Will would be asleep by the time I got home. I was grateful for that. I drove into work thinking about Sally mentioning the doctors I was having sex with at work. I hadn't told her about them. If she knew, I wondered, who else did? The thought of my coworkers knowing what a whore I'd become both thrilled and terrified me. I didn't know as I walked into work how much of my heart pounding was due to the past twenty-four hours and how much of it was due to the excitement of knowing I was about to fuck Dr. Martin with

everyone aware of what I was doing. I need it. I needed something. I couldn't keep feeling the way I was.

The early part of my shift was busy. We had multiple traumas due to a pileup on the interstate in addition to the usual chaos of the ER. By the end of the night, however, things had slowed down considerably. In the lull, Dr. Martin and I glanced at each other knowingly and separately made our way to the supply closet just down the hall. I was much less discrete about making my exit. The thrill of knowing that my coworkers knew what I was up to had me wet already. I looked each one in the eye and smiled as I passed them. As soon as I closed the door behind me, Dr. Martin took his cock out and pushed me down by my shoulder to my knees. That's where I was when the door opened. For a moment, I thought we were caught red-handed. Luckily, it was Dr. Alexander. He walked in, closing the door behind him. He stood in front of me and took his big, beautiful, black cock out. I took turns sucking them off until Dr. Martin stood me up and bent me over toward Dr. Alexander. I used his hips for balance and sucked his cock while Dr. Martin fucked me from behind. The thought of the other doctors and nurses knowing that I was getting fucked by the two of them brought me to my first orgasm. The doctors swapped places. Dr. Martin's favorite thing was watching his friend fuck me, and it wasn't long before he exploded in my mouth and on my face. Dr. Alexander and I were both about to come when the door opened again. I turned my head, Dr. Martin's come dripping from my chin, and Dr. Alexander buried deep inside of me. It was Dr. Stevens, the head of the department. He looked as angry as I've ever seen someone look.

"Ooh," I cooed, staring my boss in the face as I came.

"Get cleaned up and be in my office in five minutes," he said in a controlled rage before stopping just shy of slamming the door closed. I didn't bother. I knew that was the end of my job at the hospital.

Yup. June was pretty rough.

CHAPTER 13

Fourth of July Redux

“Hi, Mom.”

“Hi, baby. You sound tired.”

“No. I’m fine.”

“I don’t know why you’d be so tired if you’re not working anymore.”

“I said I’m fine.”

“Must be nice not to have to work.”

“I’m just taking a little break, Mom. I told you.”

“I know. I know. How’s Will?”

“He’s okay.”

“You don’t sound convinced.”

“He’s fine, Mom. Jeez.”

“Have you figured out what to do with your father, yet?”

“No, Mom. Dammit. What is this? Give Lily shit day?”

“I’m just asking. He needs to be at rest, sweetheart.”

“It’s not your problem, mother. You hated the bastard, anyway. What do you care if he’s at rest?”

“He’s still a human being, Lily. And he was your father.”

“Was he? Was he, really?”

“You know what I mean. All that bitterness is gonna eat you up inside.”

“Just drop it. Okay, Mom?”

“Fine. I’ll talk to you next week.”

“Okay. Bye, Mom.”

“Bye, baby.”

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Will and I were having a rare moment of normalcy in the kitchen, preparing a soup for dinner later that night. My heart wasn’t in it, but I was going through the motions, hoping that I could find my way back to feeling something resembling the contentment I used to feel with him. That all seemed so far away. I hadn’t really known peace since my first encounter with Tom unlocked whatever it was inside of me that turned my life upside down. Will had mellow classic rock playing in the background while he deboned the broth. I was chopping the celery. We had barely spoken all morning. It wasn’t hostile. At least for my part. I couldn’t speak for Will. It was just awkward. And boring.

Will broke the silence. “I saw Nancy. She asked if we were coming to the Fourth of July cookout.”

“What did you tell her?”

“I told her that we hadn’t talked about it, but I didn’t see why not.”

“Aren’t you worried Tom is going to be there?”

“Maybe. Can’t hide forever. Are you worried he’s gonna beat me up?”

I was pretty sure he was joking, but it wasn’t funny to me. “He’s not like that.”

“I know. I’m just kidding.”

“They probably all think I’m a whore.”

“They probably all think I’m a cuckold. If we don’t go, it’ll just give them more reason to talk.”

“That doesn’t bother you?”

“A little. But things are different these days. People have all kinds of open relationships. Do you honestly think you’re the only wife in this neighborhood that has slept with another man?”

I conceded Will’s point. I was pretty sure half the women in the neighborhood would sleep with Tom if given the chance. Will, too, for that matter.

“Let’s just go. Get it over with. Show them that we’re still together. Get back to normal. It’ll be good for us.”

“Okay. I can do that.” Normal. I wanted it. Or at least I wanted to want it. I wished it didn’t sound so unappealing when Will said it out loud.

The cookout was almost exactly like the previous year. There were a few new people, but otherwise it was more or less the same crowd. I brought my cobbler. Will brought his guitar. If anyone actually knew about me and Tom, they weren’t saying anything. There wasn’t even any innuendo, just the same old, run-of-the-mill, southern passive aggression. We had settled in and were having a good time when I saw Tom coming up the sidewalk, guitar case in hand. My heart started pounding in my chest. I’d had all week to prepare myself mentally for the possibility, but I didn’t feel anywhere near ready to see him again. Tom set his instrument next to Will’s and extended his hand.

“Will,” he acknowledged, gripping my husband’s hand firmly.

I felt butterflies in my stomach, but not like the ones I had felt the year before. I thought about the previous Fourth of July and the feeling I got the first time I saw Tom, and then the first time I got on my knees for him. And God, the feeling I got the first time I cheated on Will—the feeling I’d been chasing for over a year.

“Tom,” Will replied, gripping Tom’s hand in return.

I was proud of my husband. Despite all that had happened and how daunting a presence Tom could have, my husband never let himself be intimidated. He didn’t cower from showing his face, despite the fact that he

knew the neighborhood rumor mill had me and Tom together for the last year. And Tom—I was proud of him, too. I don't suppose I should have ever expected him to stay down for long.

Tom couldn't have timed things any more perfectly. I was standing at the same table as when we first met, serving cobbler. He picked up a plate and stepped in front of me, head high.

“Hi, Lily. Mind if I get some?” he asked in his familiar, deep voice. I was grateful to him for extending an olive branch. I knew that I had broken his heart. Mine, too.

“Sure, Tom.” I smiled kindly. I missed him. I missed his touch. I would have stayed with him had he not wanted me to leave Will. I knew Tom wouldn't be taken down by the likes of me, but it felt good to know that he didn't bear any ill will. Later on, Tom and Will played guitar together. I had forgotten how much I enjoyed listening to the two of them play. There were so many nights before things got messy that I listened to them playing along with each other in Will's office or by the pool. It felt good to have some fun again. I felt much more at peace with how things had ended with Tom. But I was restless. I was having a much harder time missing the rollercoaster. I felt empty.

After the little fireworks show at dusk, the families with kids made their way home, leaving only the childless adults. Among the new people was a very attractive, younger guy named Patrick. He'd caught my eye earlier, and I mistakenly thought he was one of the young dads. I was surprised that he was still around after dark. From listening in on bits of other people's conversations, I gathered that he was renting one of the condos where Tom was. He had recently started a job, his first out of college, as a medical equipment salesman. The job would likely suit him, I thought. He had the good looks and superficial demeanor of a salesman. I caught him staring at me a few times. I disliked him almost immediately. He was exactly the kind of guy I spent my college years avoiding at all costs. I got the sense that Will and Tom felt the same way. Unsurprisingly, none of the girls seemed to mind him.

As Will and Tom continued their job as a backing band for poorly sung drunken karaoke, a few people started making their way into the pool.

I watched Patrick peel off his shirt and cannonball off the side, purposefully getting Janet's hair wet. He probably thought he was flirting. Patrick resurfaced, slicking his dark hair back over his pretty face. He had the body of someone who followed the latest workout and diet plan closer than most people follow their religion. I looked over at Tom and Will, thinking how much I loved them both and knowing how much they both wanted me. I knew I couldn't be with Tom anymore. It wasn't fair to him. And I wasn't ready to go back to how things were before with Will. I could feel a wicked urge to make trouble building. It was powerful and inexplicable. There was no good that could come from what I was about to do, and I knew it. And yet, I couldn't resist. I wanted the rollercoaster. I had been too long without a fix.

I quietly got up from my seat and kissed Will on the cheek mid-strum. I walked to where my bag was sitting on one of the picnic tables. I reached in and pulled out my towel. Will knew that I had always avoided drawing attention to myself at neighborhood gatherings. That day was going to be different. I could feel his eyes on me when I slowly lifted my shirt over my head, revealing a red one-piece swimsuit underneath that I scoured the shops for earlier in the week. It wasn't made of the typical nylon or polyester. It was made of a cloth blend that clung to me like a second skin when it was wet, almost like a wet t-shirt. The shoulder straps were connected to the rest of the suit by two metal rings on either side at the top of my chest and one metal ring in the middle of my back. The sides of my breasts were clearly visible. I forced myself to not look at Tom and Will as I shimmied my way out of my shorts. The bottom part of my swimsuit was high cut – barely more than a thong—revealing most of my backside that Will loved so much, all of my hips, and those lovely little creases where my legs meet my groin. It wasn't quite as revealing as one of my bikinis, but it was definitely pushing the limits of propriety for a neighborhood cookout. I could feel the anticipation building. I hadn't known for sure that I was going to stir the pot, but I had come prepared just in case.

I sauntered to the steps of the pool and into the water, a red plastic cup filled with vodka and cranberry juice in hand. I took my time and let the neighborhood see more of me than they ever had before, save for my husband and Tom. Patrick and Janet's husband, Bill, pretended not to stare

as I descended into the shallow end. I set my cup on the edge of the pool and dipped my upper body under the water, pinching my nose and brushing the water through my hair as I came up. As designed, my suit clung to my body. It wasn't translucent like my white and yellow bikinis, but it teased areola and readily displayed how hard and perky my nipples were. It even outlined my navel. I picked up my drink again and made my way to the corner of the shallow end. Patrick tossed me the frisbee that he and Bill had been passing back and forth, inviting me to play. I joined in. Another couple joined the four of us in the pool, and then things started getting interesting.

Bill organized a game of football using the frisbee. Patrick joined Janet and Bill's team. I was partnered with Judy and Mark. I knew precious little about football, but I was instructed to swim to the deep end and try to catch the football on offense and to guard Patrick on defense, attempting to prevent him from doing the same. Even if it had been up to me, I couldn't have planned it better.

Patrick was handsy from the beginning. So much so that I wondered if he was even aware that I was married and that my husband was less than ten yards away. My rings were on the nightstand at home, but it should have been obvious I was with Will. If Patrick knew, he didn't let that stop him from putting his hands all over me. When I played along, he pushed it further. He stopped shy of outright grabbing my breasts, but his hands practically lived on my ass. The fact that he was so blatantly groping my body in front of Will, Tom, and everyone else was thrilling. I flirted back, using any excuse to run my hands along his six-pack abs, pet his chest, or squeeze his perfect ass. He was a frat boy jackass, but he certainly was pretty. Our flirtations were well lit by the underwater pool light and the floodlights mounted outside the building that housed the jacuzzi and sauna just beyond the deep end of the pool. There was no hiding our untoward display.

Despite their best efforts to be covert about it, by the time the game was over, I could tell that everyone was watching Patrick and I shamelessly flirt. Growing weary of the game, the six of us in the water retreated to our drinks on the side of the pool. I hopped up and sat on the edge, sipping mine. Patrick's drink was a few feet away. I commandeered it and held it in

front of me, coaxing him to stand in the water between my legs. I took a sip and then held it high, above Patrick's reach. I poured the slightest bit in front of him, starting a game where I portioned out his drink in drops from above that he tried to catch in his mouth. I drew him in closer with each drop and wrapped my legs around his torso, resting my heels against the small of his back, gently caging him in my grasp. Patrick put his hands on my upper thighs, almost to my hips, as he angled for his rum. As I brought him closer, his hands moved behind me to the top of my ass. I lowered the cup and poured the last bit seductively into his mouth. I leaned down as though I was going to kiss him but turned my head at the last second, making it look as though I had pulled myself back from the brink of desire. It was all for show, but there wasn't much acting required. I looked directly at Will and Tom. I could feel Tom's anger and disgust as he watched me with Patrick in my clutches. I knew he was jealous. And I had seen the torn look of anguish and desire on Will's face many times before. I had them both exactly where I wanted them. I stared back with an equal amount of sincere remorse and a lustful inability to control the impulse that was taking me over.

"Meet me in the sauna," I whispered in Patrick's ear.

I lifted myself to my feet and picked up my towel. As I walked toward the picnic shelter, I saw Tom and Will shaking hands. Tom had his guitar case in hand.

"You leaving?" I interrupted.

"Yeah," Tom deadpanned, his eyes and tone conveying his disgust with me. I welcomed it. I was sorry he was going to miss the show, though. I knew he would hear about it later, at least.

"It was good to see you," I smiled. I kissed him on the cheek, letting my nipples graze him through the wet material of my swimsuit.

"You about ready to go?" Will asked, with a similar level of irritation as Tom.

"I want to try out the sauna for just a bit. Then I'll be ready," I replied.

Will gave a disapproving look, but he wasn't about to start an argument in front of the neighbors. Everyone had seen Patrick walk into the

pool house. The floodlights pointing at the pool kept them from seeing inside, though. As Tom walked away toward home, I dug through my bag and pulled out an oversized white scrunchie and used it to hold my wet hair back in a ponytail. Without saying a word, I kissed Will sweetly on the cheek and started the walk to the far side of the pool. Will knew what I was doing. But he did nothing. He said nothing.

There were a few people still in the pool, and half a dozen or so were under the shelter with Will. Not a single one of them made a sound as I strutted my way to the pool house with my swimsuit still clinging to my body. The first thing I noticed when I entered the sauna was that Patrick's swim trunks were on the floor in front of him. I furrowed my brow.

"It's the custom," he defended. "My grandparents were from Finland. They'd be rolling over in their graves if I wore a swimsuit to take a sauna. You're lucky I'm wearing a towel."

Spoken like a true fuckboy. I tossed my towel next to Patrick's on the bench. Even though we had spent the evening with our hands all over each other, Patrick seemed surprised when I straddled him. He looked out the glass door of the sauna and through the full-length window out to the pool.

"They can't see us," I assured him. "The floodlights."

He quickly got over any concerns when my tongue passed his lips. He ran his hands along my back and hips, and then finally, my breasts—the way I knew he'd been wanting to all night. I slid the straps of my swimsuit over my shoulder.

"Far be it from me to break with tradition," I smiled.

Patrick wasted no time taking advantage of unfettered access to my nipples. He was surprisingly subtle and skilled for a young fuckboy. I could feel his cock growing beneath me through his towel. I covertly checked the time on my watch while Patrick enjoyed my tits. It was 9:57 p.m.—almost time. Just a few more minutes. I pulled Patrick's lips back to mine and kissed him.

“Someone’s getting excited,” I cooed.

“I’ve been hard for you all night,” he replied.

“Hmm. Is that so?” I flirted.

I ambled my way off of Patrick’s lap and stood topless in front of him.

“God, you’re so damn sexy,” he marveled.

He said the magic word. I felt the rollercoaster climbing the track—up and up and up. I sank to my knees between his legs and reached for his towel. I pulled it apart and revealed his perfectly manscaped crotch. His cock was big—not as girthy as Tom’s, but sizeable and gorgeous, nonetheless. It almost irritated me how pretty it was.

“Jesus,” I sighed, looking up at him. “Your dick is as pretty as you are.”

“What if someone comes in?” Patrick worried.

I wrapped my hand around the base of his cock and brought it to my lips.

“Then they can watch me suck your cock,” I grinned.

I circled the head of my new friend’s dick with my tongue and took it in my mouth. He moaned and leaned his head back for a brief moment before looking back down at me.

“Fuck,” he growled. “You are so fucking beautiful.”

“Yeah?” I replied. “Do I look even prettier with your cock in my mouth?”

As a night owl, one of my favorite things to do was go for a run around the neighborhood at night when the traffic was light and there were no horny husbands to fetter my workout. Something I knew that Patrick didn’t was that the floodlights for the pool house were on a timer. Every night, at precisely 10:00 p.m., they turned off. The difference from inside the sauna was subtle and easily overlooked by someone who was

preoccupied. But not me. I was keenly aware when they turned off. I felt the weightlessness and then the fall. For the moment, my emptiness was gone.

Will and the rest of the partygoers could then, without obstruction, witness me on my knees between Patrick's legs, my head busily moving in his lap. I wanted so badly to turn around to see if anyone or everyone was looking. I resisted. I didn't want to break the fourth wall. Instead, I focused my efforts on making sure everyone could see what an artist I had become. I licked, teased, jerked, nibbled, spit, gagged, kissed, and tongued my way through an epic performance. I dragged it out, not letting Patrick come for the longest time, making him wait while I reveled in my exhibitionism.

"Please," Patrick begged. "I want to fuck you."

"Not here," I answered. "Your place."

Patrick tried to help me up from my knees. I resisted.

"Not yet. I want to make you come first."

I picked up where I left off, using everything I'd learned in the previous year to make sure that I was giving Patrick the best blowjob he'd ever had or likely ever would. In my mind's eye, I imagined how it looked to Will and everyone else, watching my head bobbing up and down on Patrick's dick.

"She probably thinks we can't see her," they would think.

Janet would lack the nerve to say out loud, "I thought she was with Tom."

Mark and Bill would be wondering if they would ever get a turn.

Judy, a pretty girl in her own right, would torture herself with jealousy, knowing she would never have the nerve to let herself be as free as me and would be tethered to her boring dad-bod husband while still in her prime.

And Will. This moment would both humiliate him and dominate his masturbatory fantasies for weeks. He would want to run away in shame and, at the same time, desperately want to make his way into the pool house and watch, jerking himself as I wantonly sucked off a pretty fuckboy I only

met a few hours before. After all the drama with Tom and Sally and Eric, I was finally flying high again.

When my unwitting scene partner could take no more, he stood up and began jerking himself off in front of my face. I pulled his hands away, refusing to let him make himself come. I took over, jerking his shaft with purpose. I turned my head sideways just enough so everyone across the pool could see me flicking my tongue on Patrick's cockhead. I wish I could describe the feeling I got when he unleashed his massive overdue load all over my face in front of everyone. My glorious mindgasm came wrapped in the bow of knowing that my husband was watching and even more importantly, that he was standing amongst our neighbors, all of whom were watching with him. I licked Patrick's cock clean with theatrical devotion, angling myself for my audience's benefit. Then I teased it until his body shuddered and he pushed my head away.

"I have to fuck you," Patrick glared down at me like an animal.

"Your house. I have to get away from my husband first. It might take a minute. Which condo is yours?"

"Five."

"Perfect," I thought to myself. Right next door to Tom. I couldn't have been happier. Surely, it was fate.

"The first thing you're doing when I get to your house, though, is returning the favor," I informed him.

"No problem," Patrick grinned. "I bet you taste like the American dream."

I smiled wickedly. "The American dream is on its last leg. I'm in my prime."

"Isn't that your husband leaving?" Patrick gestured to the picnic shelter.

He was right. Will was, in fact, leaving.

"Perfect," I said. "Get dressed and he'll be gone by the time you walk out. I'll just be a few minutes behind you."

After Patrick made his way out of the sauna, I sat there in silence for a moment, trying to field the thoughts that were racing through my head. I felt a bit guilty for putting Will through the display of his wife publicly giving another man head, but I knew at the same time that he was undoubtedly walking home with an erection and would soon be reliving the moment. Regardless, the guilt paled in comparison to the high of the experience. And if things worked out right, I was going to be able to get not one but two more rides on the rollercoaster before noon the next day.

I used the glass wall of the sauna as a mirror as best I could. It didn't reflect much, but I managed to put my hair in order. I cleaned my face with the towel, but not too well. I didn't want to look too messy when I gathered my things, just enough to get a rise out of Mark and Bill and make it obvious that things had definitely gotten sticky in the sauna. I knew the women in the neighborhood all talked about me. Even before Tom. I wanted them to watch their husbands stare. Served them right. I never liked catty women. That's one of the reasons I loved Sally so much.

I didn't cover up with the towel. I kept my clingy swimsuit on full display as I sauntered to the picnic shelter. I put my towel in my bag with my clothes and put my sandals on. Only the neighbors from the football game remained. No one said a word, and I could feel them staring at me. I looked at Mark. He was staring at my mouth. I gave him a knowing look. Already aware of the answer, I turned my head and asked, "Janet, did my husband leave already?"

"Yes. He left just a few minutes ago."

"Thank you," I smiled as though nothing had happened. "It was good seeing y'all. Have a good night."

"You, too. Take care now," they chorused.

It was all very southern.

I walked toward the street. Home was straight ahead. The condos where Tom and Patrick lived were to my right. I turned right and could almost immediately hear the voices of my neighbors chattering away. I

couldn't hear what they were saying, but I could tell by the tone that they were all aflutter. It was glorious.

When I reached Patrick's door, I could see a lamp still on in Tom's house. I knew he never left a light on at night when he was sleeping. Ruined his night vision, he told me. I rapped loudly on Patrick's door, knowing Tom would hear. As soon as Patrick opened the door, I was on him, wrapping my arms around his neck and kissing him. I quickly wiggled out of my swimsuit, which was growing colder by the second in the air conditioning. I kissed him again, pressing my breasts against the bare skin of his sculpted chest. "As long as he doesn't talk too much, this is going to be fun," I thought to myself.

"Take me to bed," I ordered.

We continued kissing and roaming our hands along each other's bodies as Patrick walked me backwards into his bedroom. I was delighted to see that his bedroom shared a wall with Tom's. Just as I had hoped. I was well familiar with the layout of Tom's condo, but I couldn't have been sure about Patrick's. I felt the rollercoaster climbing towards the crest once again. I scooted myself all the way back on Patrick's bed, leaning back against his headboard. I spread my legs wide.

"Your turn," I grinned.

Patrick obliged. He didn't know my body as well as Tom or Will, but I could tell that he had a good bit of experience going down on a woman. Combined with the thrill of knowing that Tom was right next door, I was getting off in no time.

"Yes," I exhaled, palming the back of Patrick's head. "I'm gonna come...yes..."

I squeezed his head between my thighs and pressed him harder against my sex, rocking back against him.

"Fuck!" I raised my voice. "Fuck...I'm coming...Yes!"

I didn't need to play it up much. Patrick did an admirable job. I was impressed. I wondered if I had been loud enough for Tom to hear yet.

“Good boy,” I praised, like Patrick had just performed a trick. “Are you ready to fuck me?”

Patrick quickly ambled up between my legs, his cock hard and ready. “What about your husband?” he asked suddenly and completely out of character.

For the first time, I let myself feel angry at Will for starting me on this path. I gritted my teeth.

“Fuck him. He made this happen.” Patrick made a move to put himself inside. “Uh-uh,” I shook my head and pushed him over onto his back. I swung my leg over and hovered my pussy over his cock. “I go first.”

I slid down onto his shaft. He was girthy. Not like Tom, but enough to feel amazing.

“Oh, fuck,” I groaned. “You have such a nice dick.”

I slowly moved up and down his shaft. Had I not been with Tom as long as I had, I might have had trouble accommodating Patrick’s full length at first. I took it with ease and pleasure. It was going even better than I expected.

I lowered myself all the way down Patrick’s shaft. I gripped the headboard with one hand, Patrick’s leg with the other and started grinding back and forth, rubbing my clitoris against him, and feeling his dick shimmy inside of me. I started getting loud.

“Oh, fuck!” I cried loudly. The headboard thudded against the wall.

“Easy!” Patrick complained.

“Shut up,” I barked. “You can paint your fucking wall. Do you want to fuck or not?”

“Oh, you want to get fucked, huh?” he barked defiantly.

“Yes!” I grunted, grinding him hard.

Patrick tossed me over and manhandled me onto all fours. I reached up and gripped the headboard again. He thrust his cock into me from behind and started jackhammering. If my sole purpose was to get off, I would have been irritated, but Patrick’s immature machismo dovetailed perfectly with my need for Tom to hear me being taken by another man. A younger man. A prettier man.

“Yes! Fuck me!” I yelled, angling my mouth directly at the wall like a microphone. I let Patrick’s thrusts edge me closer to the headboard until my face was less than a foot away. The headboard tapped the wall in time with Patrick’s thrusts. I started fantasizing about Tom listening. I imagined him remembering how well we pleased each other while he listened to me through the wall begging Patrick for more. Of course, Tom would know exactly what I was up to. But it didn’t matter. He would hear it all the same. I wasn’t ready to come yet, but I faked an orgasm for the sake of my mission. I was nearing the crest of the rollercoaster, thinking of Tom’s anguish, but I didn’t yet know how I was going to push myself over the top. That is, until Patrick figured it out for me.

After I faked my orgasm, Patrick slowed his pace. He started massaging my ass cheeks and spreading them wide as he fucked me. He moved his thumbs closer and closer to my asshole while spreading and kneading my glutes. I encouraged him with whispers and coos as though I was surprised at how good his touch felt as he edged nearer.

“Yes...yes...ooooo,” I purred.

Finally, Patrick circled my asshole with his thumb. I could tell he wasn’t as experienced as Eric. Not even close. Even though I had become accustomed to and all in favor of being fucked in the ass on occasion, Patrick was a bigger than Eric and didn’t appear to have much of a game plan other than to poke around until he decided he was ready without considering the implications for me.

“Get my bag,” I ordered.

“Huh?”

“You want to fuck me in the ass, right?” I said trying to sound more seductive than irritated at his ignorance. He seemed stunned by the question. “I have oil in my bag. Bring it here.” Finally, he understood and fetched my bag from his foyer. I quickly found the lube.

At my direction, Patrick lined back up behind me and slid his cock in my pussy. I took the oil and dribbled some between my cheeks. I felt it run down my asshole and then into my pussy via Tom’s shaft. “Fuck me slow,” I ordered. As Patrick fucked me, I reached around and played with my asshole, gradually easing a finger inside.

“Do you see?” I whispered, reminding myself to relax. I demonstrated for a moment longer. “Your turn...”

I took my hand away. With my head and shoulders on the mattress and my ass lifted high, I spread my ass apart as Patrick worked his finger inside of me.

“Keep fucking me...slowly,” I instructed.

For a moment, I forgot about Tom on the other side of the wall and got lost in the feeling of Patrick’s cock inside my cunt and his finger in my ass. Briefly, I wondered if I could handle two cocks at once. I relaxed and let my ass spread wider. With my permission, Patrick worked a second finger in. I dribbled another stream of oil down my crack and told Patrick I was ready for him.

“You have a big dick. Go slow.”

I rubbed my clit as Patrick pressed his dick to my asshole.

“Yes,” I whispered loudly.

He parted my ring, pushing his head past the entrance.

“Oooooo,” I cooed loudly. “Oh, god.”

“It’s so fucking tight,” Patrick moaned.

I did my best to let go and give myself over to the experience, the way I had learned with Eric. It wasn’t always the case, but when I was in the right mood, there was nothing quite like taking a cock in my ass. Knowing that Will had no idea that part of me had been breached was an excellent aphrodisiac. I was more focused, however, on making sure that Tom had an earful at that particular moment.

“Oh god, Patrick. Fuck me!”

I groaned as he gradually worked his cock deeper and faster. Patrick took direction well and soon I had him fucking me just the way I liked it. I buried a finger in my pussy and found my spot. I started getting loud, as loud as I could without it being ridiculous and Patrick figuring out I was up to something. I could feel myself cresting the rollercoaster.

“Oh, god!” I yelled, trusting Tom would hear. “I can’t believe you’re in my ass!”

I heard a thud through the wall. It sounded like Tom must have thrown something or hit the opposite wall. It was music to my ears. Tom was there. And he was listening to me get fucked by another man in the one way he never had. For the second time that night, I felt the euphoria of that tiny moment just before the fall and then the rush of flying down and then back up, defying gravity. I gripped one of the slats on the headboard, making it rap hard against the wall again.

“Fuck my ass!” I growled. “Yes!”

Patrick squatted behind me and gripped my hips, using me to partially support his weight. He worked his cock deeper. I was pounding my pussy with my fingers, my palm pelting my clit.

“Fuck!” I yelled loud enough for even the neighbors on the other side of Tom to hear. “I’m gonna come! Don’t stop!! Fuck my ass!”

Even though I was playing it up verbally, I wasn’t faking my orgasm. I felt a wave of pleasure radiate outward from my privates. I nearly crumpled over onto my side, but Patrick held me steady working hard for his own climax.

“Are you gonna come, baby?” I whimpered over my shoulder.

“Soon,” was all he could manage.

Between grunts as I took his fucking, I growled, “You know my husband?”

Patrick grunted back and nodded.

“He’s never had my ass...ever.”

That was enough for Patrick.

“Oh, fuck,” he groaned, creaming in my ass. When he was sated, he let himself fall sideways onto the bed next to me. I slid my legs backward along the sheets and laid on my stomach.

“Fuck,” I exhaled. “I’m gonna be walking funny tomorrow.”

“Sorry. Did it hurt?”

“A little. But I like it.”

“I can’t decide which I like more; your pussy or your ass.” Patrick accentuated his point by slapping me on my backside.

I took the sting well.

“Why don’t you try some of that next time?” I challenged. “How much time do you need?”

“You mean you want to fuck again?”

“How much time?”

“In the ass?”

“Maybe not tonight. Next time, though. Now seriously, how much time before you can get hard again?”

“Hang on,” he replied, rolling off the bed and to the bathroom. A few minutes later, he returned and held his hand in front of my face. In his palm was a little blue pill. “We can go all night if you want.”

I hopped up from the bed, excited that Tom wasn’t going to get much sleep. And the more disheveled I was in the morning, the better. Patrick swallowed the pill just before I took his hand. “Let’s take a shower.”

We fucked loudly and well into the early hours of the morning before finally falling asleep. I was well past the point of enjoying it physically. But mentally, I couldn’t get enough of moaning and wailing and begging for Tom’s ears to hear. We finally went to sleep and I set an alarm for around sunrise. I had a third rollercoaster to catch.

With the sun just coming up over the horizon, I opened our front door as quietly as I could, stepping into the foyer with my shoes in hand.

“Don’t bother,” I heard Will’s voice from the living room. “I’m awake.” I would have bet you a thousand dollars he would be. I was counting on it.

I put down my bag and my shoes. I walked barefoot into the living room, naked under my wrinkled t-shirt and khaki shorts. I was disheveled and exhausted. Will was sitting in the corner chair with the reading lamp on next to him. There was a tumbler with clear liquid in it on the table beside him. I couldn’t tell if it was water or vodka. I was guessing vodka.

“Where have you been?” Will’s voice was controlled and quiet, but I could tell he was livid.

“I think you know,” I answered quietly.

“Did you fuck him?”

“Yes,” I answered plainly, looking him in the eye.

“Jesus, Lily. In front of everyone?” he asked disapprovingly.

“No.”

“I saw you, Lily. We all saw you.”

“You mean the sauna?”

“Yes, I mean the goddamn sauna!”

“I gave him a blowjob. Big deal. But I didn’t fuck him there. It doesn’t matter. No one could see.”

Will gestured wildly. “Yes, they could, Lily! Everyone saw you!”

“You asked. I’m just trying to be honest.” No, I wasn’t. I was trying to get that look. The one from Atlanta. The one from night he watched Tom take me in our bed.

Will stood up from his chair and stepped toward me. I knew he would never hurt me, but it was the most aggressive stance he’d ever taken with me.

“What the fuck did you think you were doing?” he demanded, shaking his finger at me. “You’re my wife!”

I didn’t shrink away. I stepped closer and put my hand gently on his chest. “Will, you need to calm down. It’s okay.”

“You sucked another man’s cock at a goddamned picnic in front of everyone!”

“Will. Settle down, baby,” I said calmly. I hadn’t called him baby in months. It seemed to calm him just a little bit. I knew that at the heart of his anger was the fear that I would leave him. “I thought you would like it.”

“You thought I would like it? Did you ever think you should’ve talked to me first? It wasn’t part of the deal that you could just go around fucking whoever you please, putting on a show for the neighbors.”

I kept my voice as still, calm, and nurturing as I could. “Will? Look at me, baby. Can I ask you a question?”

“What?” he answered shortly, still irritated, pacing back and forth.

“Will, look at me,” I repeated. I took his hand and held him still.  
“How many times did you masturbate last night?”

He pulled away. “Dammit, Lily!”

“Tell me the truth, Will. Did you get turned on watching me?”

“That’s not the fucking point!”

I released his hand and stepped into his space, put my hands on his chest, and whispered into his ear.

“Did you come home and jerk your cock thinking about what you saw?”

I slowly lowered myself down from my tiptoes. Will’s breathing slowed. I rubbed the front of his shorts and found his growing bulge.

“Did you stroke yourself thinking about me sucking Patrick’s cock?”

I moved my hands to Will’s belt.

“Wrapping my lips around it?”

I undid his button and lowered his zipper. I slid down to my knees. I lowered his shorts and underwear and looked up at him from behind his hard shaft. It looked so small now compared to the others I’d found.

“He came so much, baby.”

I licked Will’s cock along the bottom of his shaft with only the very tip of my tongue.

“Did you see him come all over your pretty wife’s face?”

I licked his shaft again, just enough make him wonder if I was actually going to finally go down on him.

“Did you sit there with our neighbors and watch me get on my knees for Patrick?”

I kissed the tip of his cock, barely putting it in my mouth.

“Oh fuck,” Will whispered. He had never felt the true pleasure of my mouth. Not since I’d learned how to please. And barely at all even before that.

“Did it get you off, Will? Being home alone all night, knowing I was fucking him? Be honest. Are you mad because I fucked him? Or are you mad because you didn’t get to watch?”

“Fuck you,” he whispered defiantly, knowing I had him in my grasp. He looked down with anticipation, unsure if I was just teasing him again or if I was going to finally give him what he watched me give Tom so many times. I gripped the base of his dick and teased it against my face.

“Did you all watch me suck Patrick’s big, beautiful cock?”

I licked Will’s shaft again.

“Fuck,” Will moaned.

“After you left, everyone watched me walk to his house, Will. I heard them all chattering away as soon as I left. Everyone knew I going to fuck him behind your back.”

I licked Will’s shaft yet again, teasing him. He was as hard as I had ever seen him.

“I spread my legs for him, Will. I let him taste your wife.”

I took the tip of Will’s cock in my mouth and sucked it. One Mississippi. He groaned.

“He made me come. You haven’t made me come in months.”

I ran my hand up and down Will’s shaft. Gently. Slowly.

“Then I let him fuck me. He fucked me so good, baby. His cock is as pretty as he is.”

I sucked the tip again. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. Three Mississippi. I had Will exactly where I wanted him. I could feel the rollercoaster steadily climbing for the peak.

“Mm,” I hummed and licked Will some more. “I’ve been wanting to do this for you for so long.”

“Did you really like it or do you just like torturing me?” said through stilted breaths.

“I fucking loved it,” I whispered and then went further down his shaft and back. “But I like torturing you more.”

Will grunted. “Did he...” I could tell Will was unsure if he wanted to know the answer to the question he was pondering. “Did he come inside you?”

I looked into Will’s eyes. “Yes.”

I saw the sweet anguish and lust in his eyes. I bobbed up and down his shaft, sucking him hard and sloppy, finally give him a proper blowjob. When I felt him getting close to coming, I stopped. I slowly stroked his sopping wet cock with one hand, wiping my mouth with the other. I could tell Will was straddling heaven and hell. And I was getting closer to what I needed.

“How does it feel, Will?”

I teased Will’s cockhead with my tongue.

“How does it feel to know that I let other men do things to me that you don’t get to do?”

I could feel my back pressing against the seat of the cart as it clicked up the track. Will’s face was contorting in the most beautiful way. I teased his cock some more. He begged for my mouth.

“Please, Lily.”

“How does it feel to know that I shared the most intimate thing a man and woman can share with Tom and now Patrick but not you? You’ve never felt what it’s like to have me beg you to come inside of me.”

I nibbled Will’s cockhead.

“Oh god,” he whimpered.

At long last, the crest was in view. I looked up at Will, teasing his glans with my tongue.

“There’s one more thing, dear husband.”

I looked up with a wicked grin. Will looked terrified. And then, finally...the fall.

“I gave Patrick something I never even gave Tom.”

Will stared at me in disbelief. I licked the length of Will’s cock and paused at the head.

“I let him fuck me in the ass, baby.”

As the words left my mouth, I stroked his cock with purpose and stared at his face, not wanting to miss one subtle nuance of his suffering.

“Oh, fuck!” Will groaned and started coming almost immediately. I latched onto his cock and sucked out every last drop, drawing out his orgasm and letting him finish in my mouth for the very first time. His body convulsed and I gripped his leg to help keep him from falling over, never letting him escape my mouth. When he could take no more, Will fell backward into the chair behind him. I looked into his eyes as he recovered, cleaning my lips with a finger then gently sucking it clean. I gave him a tiny, sweet smile, with a hint of wickedness in my stare. Will stared back, both satisfied and utterly crushed. I was savoring every second.

“Are you going to see him again?”

“Yes.”

“What if I say you can’t?”

I was well prepared for that question. “I love you, Will. And it won’t be long before we start a family. And it will be amazing, the best thing ever. You will be the best father and the best husband. And I’ll be the best mother and the best wife. But this body will go away. I’ll have stretch marks. My eyes will be puffy. I’ll be too tired to hardly ever to even think about anything I want. And that’s fine. But I’m never going to be prettier, sexier, or freer than I am now. I don’t want to waste that. I want to experience everything while I still can.”

“What about what happened with Tom? Didn’t we learn anything from that?”

“Patrick has the depth of a mud puddle. He’s a fuckboy. There’s no danger there.”

“How much time are we talking, Lily?”

“I don’t know.”

“And what about me?”

“Have fun with it, Will. Enjoy it.” I took his hand. “Play with me,” I urged.

“I haven’t been having much fun lately, Lily.”

I leaned over and kissed him gently. One Mississippi. I looked down at his spent dick and back up again.

“It doesn’t look that way to me,” I smiled before taking his hand and helping him up. “Come on. We both need some sleep. You’ll feel better. Maybe we can go out to dinner tonight? Someplace nice. I’ll dress up and let the men stare at me. Just the way you like.”

# CHAPTER 14

## *The Hotel*

Patrick was up and gone before I crawled out of bed. Patrick's father was recovering from major surgery. For the foreseeable future, he was going to be going to Atlanta on Saturdays to help his family out before spending the rest of the week on the road making the rounds, hawking durflibideedos or whatever they were. Although I admired his filial piety, especially for a fuckboy like him, it left me in a bit of a lurch. He and I had been spending the weekends together, which, in addition to the obvious sensual benefits, allowed me to avoid Will. Will was eager to "normalize" relations with me, but I just wasn't ready yet. I needed more time on the rollercoaster and it was continually getting harder and harder for me to get a fix. My escapades with Patrick and my coffee shop encounters weren't doing the trick anymore. I kept Will appeased by regaling him on Sunday nights with mine and Patrick's sexual exploits while I went down on him, sometimes two or three times. A few times, Patrick was agreeable to recording some of our activities, which I was then able to share with Will. It was even more thrilling for me than for him. One of my favorite things became watching Will's reaction to those videos while I sucked his cock. He might have been desperate to have me return to being a normal wife again, but in those moments, he was in heaven, or at least his mangled version of it. Some of my best orgasms of the week were by my own hand while I watched Will watching me and Patrick on video.

With Patrick gone for the rest of the weekend, I wasn't sure what to do with myself. It occurred to me that I should have probably planned ahead. He had good coffee on hand, so I piddled on my phone and had a cup while I tried to decide what to do. All I knew at that point was that pretty much anything was preferable to dealing with my marriage. If worse

came to worse, I thought I would just stay at Patrick's until my usual Sunday evening return home. The only problem with that was that I would be stuck alone in my head. While on my second cup of coffee, I heard Tom's front door open and close. I couldn't help but get up to peek out the window. My heart sank. It wasn't Tom. It was Janet. I'd heard that she and Bill split up not long after the Fourth of July picnic. I froze, staring out the window, feeling like I'd been kicked in the gut. Almost immediately, I had the craving. I knew none of my usual partners were a possibility. I gathered my things and hurried back home. Will was in the back yard when I got there, but soon found me in the bedroom packing an overnight bag.

"What are you doing?" he asked, both surprised to see me and surprised to see me packing.

"Patrick's taking me to the city," I lied. I stopped what I was doing and gave Will a gentle kiss on the lips. "I told him I want to get fucked in a hotel tonight," I smiled.

"How very generous of him."

It really did hurt to see the pain in Will's eyes. I'd make it up to him the next day, I told myself. Maybe I'd even let him fuck me for the first time in months. That's how I justified it to myself, anyway.

"Don't worry, sourpuss. I'll be back tomorrow to tell you aaalll about it."

I gave him a longer, softer kiss and then returned to packing. Will left the bedroom. Not long after, I heard the ubiquitous sound of his bottle tapping the rim of a tumbler.

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On the two-hour drive to the city, I debated. I couldn't decide exactly what to do. Should I go to a club, or should I go to a quiet little bar? Should I stay in the hotel Will and I visit multiple times a year, or should I go somewhere they've never seen me before? As the white lines flashed by my car, my excitement grew. I could feel the anticipation building, thinking

of all of the possible things I could get myself into, or rather, all of the possible things that could get into me. I resisted the urge to play with myself, opting to let myself enjoy the longing – waiting in line for my next ride on the rollercoaster.

When I got to town, my car found its way to the same hotel Will and I booked five or six times a year. It was where we stayed when we visited the amusement park nearest our house. As I walked through the lobby, I fantasized about returning here with Will in a month and the check-in clerk recognizing me, knowing that I was here with another man before—a man who wasn't my husband. I checked in and went to my room on the sixth floor. I took a nap and then showered just before six o'clock. By eight o'clock, my hair and makeup were perfect to match my sexy, backless, black mini halter dress with a loose frill skirt. I still couldn't make up my mind on where to go, so I decided to make my way down to the bar while I pondered the possibilities. My rings stayed in the room.

The hotel lounge was bigger than I remembered. There was even a small stage at one end of the room. Several low-rise tables, matched with four lounge chairs each, were scattered around the room with ample distance between them. The bar itself was fairly large as well and had leather-padded stools on three of the four sides. There were only a handful of people at the tables, and two men were seated at the bar. I sat down on the far end of the bar, where I could view my surroundings. The bartender made his way to me and laid a napkin in front of me.

“What can I get you?” he asked. He was a fit but older black man, most likely in his early fifties.

“White wine, please,” I responded, smiling as I noticed him staring. I appreciated the confirmation that I looked as good as I thought I did.

He returned with my wine and asked, “Waiting for someone?”

“No. It's just me.”

“Business or pleasure?”

“Pleasure,” I smiled, but not too wickedly.

“Well, I’m Dante. Let me know if you need anything.”

“Lily. I will.”

I smiled at the middle-aged man who was staring at me from his seat on the opposite side of the bar. Almost immediately, he got up and started walking toward me. Just as quickly, I put him in the category of men who knew they had no shot with me but still approached simply because they liked talking to a pretty girl.

“Hi, I’m Mitch,” he smiled. “You are one of the most beautiful women I have ever seen.”

I could smell the scotch on his breath. It made me think of Will.

“Thank you, Mitchell. I’m Lily,” I half-smiled.

“Can I buy you a drink?” he asked.

“Thank you. I already have one.”

“Fair enough.”

What he said next caught me entirely off guard.

“How much?”

“For what?” I asked, having no clue what he meant.

“Let’s say a blowjob.”

Without even thinking, I blurted out the first number that came to mind.

“Two hundred.”

My heart started pounding.

“For a blowjob?”

I couldn’t believe what I was saying. And yet, I could hear the roller coaster in the distance, coming for me.

“Trust me. It’s worth every penny.”

“One hundred.”

I held fast, halfway hoping I would be too expensive. I wasn't sure I wanted a seat on this particular ride.

"No discounts."

"Two hundred dollars? For a blowjob?" he asked again incredulously.

"Let me ask you," I responded, looking him dead in the eye. Something in me wouldn't let me back down. "Have you ever had a woman as pretty as me suck your cock and swallow every drop while looking in your eyes so you could be sure of just how much she enjoyed it?"

The expression on Mitch's face changed. "Two hundred dollars?" he asked a third time in a much more agreeable tone.

"Take it or leave it."

Mitch took another look at me, or my lips, to be more specific, and started making his way to the ATM machine perched in the corner of the bar. In his absence, I tried to process the thoughts racing through my head. Even though I had set out to be a bit of a whore that evening, I couldn't believe I was actually about to literally prostitute myself. The scariest thing was that I was incredibly turned on by the notion. The rollercoaster was steadily chugging up the track.

"Where to?" Mitch asked.

Fortunately, I had been to the hotel enough times to be familiar with the layout. "Stairwell," I replied. Dante, the bartender, gave me a look as I dismounted my stool and made my way for the door. My heart was beating faster and faster. I was terrified and excited all at the same time. I kept thinking of Will sitting at home alone, taking his melancholy out on his guitar, and having no idea that his wife was about to suck a stranger's dick for money. I knew I would never be able to tell him, but just the fantasy of telling him had me wet before Mitch even opened the door to the stairwell.

"How do you know nobody's gonna use the stairs?" Mitch asked.

"I don't. What's the worst that could happen, Mitch?" I asked rhetorically. "You get caught having your dick sucked by a beautiful

woman?”

Wasting no more time, I squatted down in front of him and started undoing his belt. Then his button. Then his zipper. Mitch reached in his pants and pulled out his cock. He was already hard. I could tell he probably had a bigger dick when he was younger and thinner. He wasn't what I would call small, but I was used to working with the likes of Patrick and Tom. Still, I was proud of him for having a full-bore hardon at his age in front of a much younger woman who would be way out of his league even under the best of circumstances.

“Good for you, Mitchell!” I smiled, peering up at him from behind his cock. He looked at me expectantly. “Money first,” I reminded.

Mitch reached into his pants pocket and pulled out the wad of twenties from the ATM machine. I put them in my clutch. “You’ve got me so wet,” I whispered. I shimmied up my skirt and reached into my panties to finger myself. I could tell he wasn't expecting that. I looked into his eyes as I started getting myself off. “Are you ready for me to suck your cock, Mitchell?”

He nodded hypnotically and eased his crotch forward, putting his dick in my face. A strange warmth came over me, knowing that as soon as I put my tongue to him, I would be a literal whore. My last thought was to imagine Will looking on next to me the way he used to with Tom. A few of those times were even in that very same hotel. At first, I teased my john, licking his shaft and circling the tip with my tongue. Precum oozed from his dick. I found that I could make him twitch every time I tongued it.

“Suck it,” Mitch quietly begged.

I eased my mouth away from his dick and looked down at my hand, busy between my legs.

“Ooooo,” I cooed, looking up at him. “I want to come with your cock in my mouth,” I taunted.

I moved to my knees, ignoring the cold, hard concrete beneath me, and wrapped my lips around his spongy tip.

"Hmm," I moaned, vibrating my mouth on him as I fingered myself. With one hand and my mouth, I gave Mitch the best I had to offer, all while whimpering as I pleasured myself at the same time. I gave myself over to the moment, enjoying the fall and reveling in my latest betrayal. Hating myself would come later. For that moment, I was content. The emptiness was gone.

"I'm gonna come," I whined, swiftly stroking Mitch's cock.

I launched my mouth back onto his shaft and hummed my pleasure as I came. As I neared the end of my orgasm, Mitch began his, filling my mouth with a surprisingly large load. As promised, I stared into his eyes as I swallowed every drop.

"Fuck," he groaned, trying not to be too loud.

I continued looking up at him as I cleaned his cock and licked my lips before standing up.

"Jesus Christ, Lily."

"Told ya." I smiled.

"I want to fuck you. How much to fuck you?"

"Not tonight, babe."

"When?"

"I'm here most Saturdays," I lied.

"I'm only in town once a month."

"I don't know for sure if I'll be here. I'm a busy girl. You'll just have to wait and see."

Mitch pulled another twenty out of his pocket and handed it to me. "Let me see your tits."

I took his money. It was an easy ask. I was wearing a low-cut V-neck. All I had to do was pull my top to each side. I did it slowly for his benefit.

“God, your perfect,” Mitch sighed. He hungrily pulled me to him and took one of my nipples in his mouth, circling it with his tongue and gently sucking it.

“Slow down, cowboy,” I said, pulling myself away. “You go on ahead. I need to go to the ladies’ room.”

“I can’t wait to fuck you,” he grimaced.

“I’ll look forward to it, baby,” I smiled. “Now off you go.”

With that, my first john left satisfied but wanting more—exactly the way you would want him to. I went to the ladies’ room. When I looked in the mirror, I lost all sense of reality. I didn’t recognize myself. Images of Will watching me with other men flashed through my mind. I made my way back to the bar halfway in a daze. Dante saw me coming and had a fresh glass of wine ready for me before I even sat down. Mitch was talking to the other man sitting at the bar. They were both looking at me. A few minutes later, the other man walked over.

“My friend told me you just gave him the best blowjob he’s ever had.”

I played coy. “Is that so?”

“Yup. I told him I didn’t believe it.”

“Maybe you’re right.”

“So, you’re saying you didn’t give him a blowjob?”

“Oh no. I sucked his dick. Swallowed every drop. I’m just saying that maybe it wasn’t the best he’s ever had. I mean, empirically, there’s really no way for me to know.”

Dante smirked behind the bar. He liked me.

“Tell you what,” the stranger said. “How about I let you suck my dick, and I’ll give you the honest to God’s truth if it was the best I’ve ever had?”

“Sure. Two-hundred dollars.”

“That’s a little steep, don’t you think?”

“That’s what our friend over there said. No discounts.”

He eyed the same ATM machine as Mitchell.

“I’ll be right back,” he replied.

I never did get his name. Nor did I get the names of the three others after him. I was getting myself together to leave when Dante asked me to stay for a minute while he closed the bar. I thought I was about to make another two hundred dollars. I was mistaken.

“If you want to keep working here, I can get you a deal on a room. It’s a little more discrete than the stairwell,” he offered. “And I can see to it that you have a steady stream of clients. And stay safe.” He said the last part with a somewhat menacing look in his eyes.

“I think I can handle that on my own,” I bragged.

“Suit yourself. You owe me fifty percent for tonight, though.”

“What are you talking about?”

“Fifty percent or I call the police. We have cameras, you know.”

“Fuck,” I muttered under my breath. “Twenty.” I didn’t need the money. I don’t know why I was trying to negotiate.

“Forty.”

“Twenty-five.”

“Twenty-five, and I get for free what you charged those other gentlemen for.”

I stepped behind the bar and got on my knees in front of Dante. I unbuttoned his pants like I had the five others that night. I pulled out his cock. He had a really big, black dick. He was bigger flaccid than Will was completely hard. It wasn’t as thick as Tom’s or as pretty as Patrick’s, but it was the longest I had dealt with up until that point. Not one to back away from a challenge, I got to work sucking him off. I had him as hard as a diamond in no time. Just as I was letting myself get lost in the moment, Dante lifted me up and spun me around. He bent me over the bar, pulled my

skirt up to my hips, and yanked my panties down. I didn't know what to do. I didn't say anything.

I thought of how I waited until senior prom to have sex for the first time with a boy I loved because I wanted it to be special. I thought of my wedding day and my perfect white gown. I thought of how my friends and I stayed in that same hotel on our first trip out of town without parents to see our favorite band. How grown-up we thought we were! Then I felt the man standing behind me grip my hair unforgivingly and center his cock between my legs. I felt him slide inside of me. The reality of the evening started to set in. Someone tried the door that Dante had locked just a few minutes earlier. I pretended it was Will. The roller coaster peaked. I felt the rush.

“Yes,” I pushed the air from my lungs. “Fuck me.”

CHAPTER 15

Looking Back

The week of my sixth wedding anniversary was the beginning of the end for me. I had already lost Sally, first to her better judgment and then to my betrayal that destroyed her marriage. I wouldn't exactly call Eric a loss for either one of us, but he was gone, too. Not to mention my job. Tom was gone, and despite my best efforts, I still had feelings for him that hit me like a jolt of electricity anytime I saw him driving through the neighborhood. I had gotten to the point that I had to be drunk when I was at Patrick's. In the moments I wasn't doing my best to make sure Tom heard Patrick and I going at it through the bedroom wall, I did my best to pretend he wasn't there at all. I knew he and I would never have worked beyond what we had before, but selfishly, I didn't want anyone else to have him. Seeing other women on his motorcycle, hearing them call his name through the wall, or leaving his condo on Saturday mornings made me crazy.

In addition to Patrick, I was fucking multiple men, including Dante and his partner, Lucas, on my Saturday visits out of town. During the week, I was still letting men pick me up in the coffee shop or the grocery store. Sometimes I followed them to their place. Sometimes I just fucked them or gave them a blowjob in their car in the parking lot. Once, I even fucked a stockboy in the back storeroom. Anything to try and get my fix. I still hadn't had sex with Will since before he watched me have sex with Tom for the first time. I gave him the occasional blowjob while he watched a video of Patrick taking me, or I otherwise regaled him with tales of our exploits. At that point, Will was a reluctant spectator to my extramarital endeavors, or at least the ones he knew about. I knew he was living on the promise I

had made that one day I would return to being his alone and that we would start a family. But I also knew that he sensed that promise was growing flimsier by the day. As I had become more and more horrible and selfish with everyone I loved, he was the only one who had not left me other than my mother. She was still there. She could sense something was wrong, but she had no idea of the chaos I had created.

I could feel the rollercoaster tipping, threatening to go off the rails. Something had to change. I was afraid Will might leave if it didn't. I decided to do something special for our anniversary. The previous year was the first time I had sex with Tom, setting in motion things I would have never imagined in a million years. A year later, I could barely recognize the person I was before. I knew, however, that it was time to be with Will again or risk losing him as well. And I knew that I wanted to do it with a bang.

When Will walked in the door from work on the day of our sixth wedding anniversary, he was met with a path of rose petals on the floor leading him to our bedroom. The smell of a scented candle drifted down the hall. I had been waiting patiently for him, being sure to be quiet, not wanting to ruin his surprise. The first thing he saw as he opened the door was Derek lying with his head at the foot of the bed while I licked the length of his big black cock and his friend, Paul, fucked me from behind.

"Happy anniversary, baby," I grinned mischievously and licked Derek again. "Have a seat."

I motioned to the familiar chair placed next to the bed. The last time I had seen Will's face in such anguish was just after Patrick and I had been together for the first time.

"I promise, you won't be disappointed." I kept my eyes on Will as he stood there slack jawed, watching me gently nibble at the tip of Derek's cock. "Please, baby. I promise."

Will reluctantly made his way to the chair and sat down. I turned my attention back to sucking one of the biggest, blackest dicks I'd ever had my hands on and giving Will a good show.

"Ooh fuck," I cooed, feeling Paul inside of me at the same time.

Despite having been with several black men over the previous months, Will had no idea this wasn't my first interracial experience. In fact, you would have been hard-pressed to find a race I hadn't been with by that point. I actually prided myself on being what I thought of as an equal-opportunity nymphomaniac. I knew from snooping on Will's browser history that he had obviously fantasized about me being in a threesome with well-hung black men. That's why I chose Paul and Derek, two guys from my gym who had been flirting with me for months. When I asked them to help me put on a show for my husband on our anniversary, they were all in. Together, we had loosely choreographed our tryst ahead of time, making sure we would hit all of the high points I suspected would maximally tantalize Will.

To that end, I turned around and sat on Derek's face. I stared at Will as I lowered myself to take his cock back in my mouth in a sixty-nine. I noticed Will squeezing his cock through his khakis. Back when I was still with Tom, Will would have normally been naked by that point. It was becoming clear that it was going to take some coaxing to get Will to fully buy into the experience. I teased both Derek and my husband by staring into Will's eyes while gently kissing and licking Derek's glans. Paul walked to the end of the bed and stood behind me. He started fucking me again, nice and slow, while Derek licked me. Between two men actively pleasing me and the look of torment on Will's face, I was in heaven.

"Ooh," I cooed. "Don't stop."

I took Derek's cock deeper into my mouth and sucked him properly until I felt an orgasm beginning to crest.

"Yes," I whimpered. I looked at Will. "They're gonna make me come, baby."

He was still squeezing his cock through his pants, visibly torn between desperately wanting me to be a proper wife again and being unable to turn away from the manifestation of one of his deepest fantasies.

"Don't stop," I whimpered again.

I was too close to coming to tend to Derek's cock. I gripped it and pressed it to my face, looking at Will, letting him see the complete ecstasy on my face as I came. My head fell limp into Derek's crotch. I managed to stroke him slowly as I rested for a moment. The room was briefly silent, aside from everyone's labored breathing.

Derek and I took our places for the next scene in our X-rated play. He laid on his back across the width of the bed, with his head facing Will. I straddled him and smiled seductively at my husband as I took Derek's huge cock in my hand and guided it inside of me. Will swallowed hard. There was a sizeable wet spot on his pant leg where it had been saturated with precum. Something Will hadn't noticed was a bottle of lubricant and a condom in the far corner of the bed. Paul got behind me as I fucked Derek. He methodically put on the condom and squeezed a stream of lube down my ass. I pursed my lips and exhaled, staring at Will as Paul fingered my asshole. Will looked back at me, his eyes incredulous. I braced myself as Paul pressed his cock against my backdoor. Will's expression was exactly what I had been hoping for. Heartbreak. Desire. Agony. Lust. Shock. I had to remind myself that he had no idea the extent of my sexual escapades. He only knew of Tom and Patrick. He knew nothing of Sally, Eric, the doctors at work, the strangers from the grocery stores or the coffee shops, and certainly not Dante, Lucas, or the parade of johns that had been filling my Saturday nights.

"Oh, fuck," I grunted as Paul eased his way inside of me.

My coconspirators began to fuck me slowly.

"Oh, god, yes," I whispered, reminding myself to relax the way Eric had taught me.

With Eric's help, I had become quite used to and even learned to love anal sex on occasion. Patrick certainly had a thing for it, too. Dante and Lucas had introduced me to being penetrated by two men at once. I wouldn't have imagined it, but I greatly preferred having two men inside of me to having only one in my ass. Derek and Paul gradually fucked me faster while still taking care not to hurt me. Despite their intimidating size, they were both excellent, thoughtful lovers.

"Ooh, he's fucking my ass, baby," I whimpered at Will. "It feels so good."

Will exhaled audibly and squeezed his cock through his pants again, looking ruined. I ate it all up.

“Yes,” I growled. “Fuck me.” I started rocking back against their cocks, matching their rhythm. I couldn’t help but think of the night in Atlanta when I danced with the two fuckboys, sandwiched between them, as Will watched from the balcony above. I recalled the tortured look on Will’s face that frightened and enraptured me. Seeing his face contort at the sight of two big black cocks taking his wife at the same time in his own bed was even more excruciating. I reveled in it. It spurred me on to buck back harder, leading Derek and Paul to match my energy. We crescendoed to the point that it became as much an athletic exhibition as a sexual encounter.

“Fuck!” I grunted, feeling an orgasm building. “Fuck me!”

My core tensed. I held my breath, turning my face red. The veins in my neck bulged.

“Hmph,” was all I could manage to grunt as I came, forcing myself look up to capture Will’s gaze as I made noises he’d never heard before. I went limp into Derek’s neck, exhausted. Paul retreated and removed the condom from his dick. Before I could catch my breath, he wasted no time manhandling me back lengthwise on the bed in front of Will. Derek stood up at the foot of the bed, stroking himself as he watched Paul make his way between my legs. This had not been part of our original choreography, but I was too caught off guard and too exhausted in the moment to not let Paul have his way. I spread my legs wide as he slid his huge, glistening, ebony shaft inside my pussy. I loved watching it. I was still hypersensitive from my orgasm and was overwhelmed as he started fucking me. I gripped his ass and held on as he pounded me like he was on a mission. Something about the way he desperately fucked me and the way I joined him made it even better than what we had originally planned.

“Oh god!” I screamed. The sensation was so intense. “Yes!”

I turned my head to look at Will and with one hand, I reached over and grabbed his knee, squeezing it hard.

“Yes!” Paul grunted. “I’m gonna come!”

“Yes!” I barked back, pulling my hand from Will’s knee and back to Paul’s ass, squeezing his impressive glutes as they sawed.

Paul thrust forcefully into me once with each spasm as he came. I had edged both Derek and Paul for nearly an hour before Will arrived so that when they finally did come, it would be an epic display. Paul's orgasm was so intense that I nearly forgot my husband was looking on from just a few feet away. I squeezed his ass and pulled him to me as hard as I could.

"Oh my god," I panted as Paul settled down. We kissed tenderly, like familiar lovers as he slowly fucked me while his cock went flaccid. "Baby, that was amazing. Thank you," I smiled. "Nobody fucks me quite like you."

I knew my words gave away the fact that Paul and I had been together before. That was by design. Paul kissed me again before making his way off the bed and toward the bathroom. Derek stayed at the foot of the bed as I got on my knees between Will's legs. I don't know how to describe the look on Will's face in response to the realization that this was not the first time I had been with Derek and Paul. I started to unbuckle Will's pants. He stopped me.

"Please fuck me," I whispered, looking up at him pitifully, echoing the words he had said to me after watching Tom take me for the first time. I made a second attempt at his belt. He didn't stop me that time. Will unbuttoned his shirt as I helped him out of his pants and boxers. I licked his cock and sucked it for only a brief moment before sliding my hands up his chest as I stood up and straddled him. I hadn't felt my husband's cock inside of me in months—dozens of others, but not his. I slowly slid down Will's shaft onto his lap. He let out a quiet moan.

I cradled his face and kissed him. "Do you remember me?" I whispered sweetly.

I felt Will's hands on my hips and slowly began grinding in his lap, fucking him in a way he could never have imagined I was capable of a year ago.

"Oh my god," he couldn't help but groan.

I kissed him again, deeper. While Will's eyes were closed and he was lost in the moment, Derek sidled up just over his shoulder. I broke the kiss, and Will's eyes followed my lips to Derek's cock. Derek eased his cock closer until it was between Will's face and mine, no more than a few inches from either of us. I licked Derek's shaft back and forth, all while

continuing to gently rock back and forth in Will's lap. The tortured look of anguish returned to my husband's face. I lifted Derek's cock out of the way so my lips could reach my husband's. I parted his lips with my tongue and kissed him passionately. Derek leaned over Will's shoulder until all ten inches of his cock were jutting forward next to Will's face. I seamlessly drifted my kiss from Will's lips to Derek's cock. It was so close to Will's face that my cheek brushed his as my head bobbed up and down on Derek's shaft. I could tell Derek wasn't going to be able to hold back much longer. He started stroking his shaft while I focused on his tip.

"He's gonna come, baby," I teased Will, flicking my tongue on the tip of Derek's dick.

Will watched intently, his mouth agape, his hands on my hips, helping me back and forth in his lap.

"Ugh!" Derek grunted in his deep, boomy voice. Rope after rope of come shot onto my face and flickering tongue. Will had watched me do the same with Tom dozens of times, but never so close and never so much. When Derek was done, I was covered, his load dripping down my face, dangling from my chin onto my chest, and down to Will's lap. I was a complete mess, just the way I knew Will loved watching online.

"Oh, fuck," Will groaned, getting ready to come, too.

"Can you feel him?" I taunted. "Can you feel Paul's come inside of me?"

"Oh fuck," Will scowled, looking disgusted with himself for being so turned on.

"I want you inside me, too." That would be the first time Will had ever finished inside me. "Don't you want to be the second man to come in your wife today?"

"Oh god," he whimpered.

"Yes," I coaxed. "Come in your slut wife."

Will's body jerked as he came inside of me for the first time ever. In all the years we had been together, never once had I let him. What should

have been a beautiful moment between a husband and wife, I had reduced to a pornographic exercise in the avoidance of intimacy. Will froze and stared at the floor.

“Get off,” he demanded, pushing my hips. The air in the room quickly changed.

I slid off of his lap, landing clumsily on the bed. Will shot Derek and Paul a look, making it clear that they were no longer welcome. Paul was already mostly dressed. Derek quickly gathered his things and made a hasty exit behind Paul.

“What the fuck, Will? What’s the matter?” I asked. Part of me knew exactly what was wrong. The other part, the one I let do the talking, was still in denial.

“What’s the matter?” Will clamored back.

“Yes.” I replied, playing dumb. “I don’t understand.”

“Rose petals to a fucking gangbang?” His tone was exactly like my own the day after the Fourth of July picnic, when Will suggested I carry on with Tom.

“It’s not a gangbang. It’s just two guys from my gym. Besides, I thought you’d like it. I wanted to do something special for you.” Will and I both knew I was lying. It had nothing to do with what he wanted.

“Really? What do you have planned for next year? A football team?” he shouted.

“I fucked Tom last year, and you liked that,” I countered gently, trying to soften the mood. “I thought you’d be happy.”

“Jesus Christ, Lily.”

“What?” I stood up and playfully tickled Will’s balls, still halfway convinced I could flirt my way out of it. “You seemed happy about it a minute ago.”

Will backed away. “Stop it!” he yelled. So much for softening the mood.

“I lived out your fantasy for you, Will!” I yelled back. “What the fuck do you want from me?”

“I want my wife back!”

“What are you talking about? You just had me!”

“Only after waiting in line behind two men I’ve never seen before! Lily, I love you. Please stop this,” he begged. “Be my wife again. I never wanted you to be a goddamn whore!”

A lifetime of suppressed anger boiled to the surface from deep inside of me. I pushed Will with both hands into his chest as hard as I could, knocking him back onto the dresser.

I pushed him again, knocking him into the mirror. I caught sight of my reflection for a split second, just before it broke.

“What did you do the first time I brought Tom to our bed? What did you do?” I screamed.

Will said nothing.

“All you had to say was ‘stop’ and I never would have done it again! But you said, ‘fuck her’ and jerked your cock!”

Will stared back at me. I could see in his eyes that he was formulating a response. It would be logical. It would be fair. It would be honest. There was no way I was going to give him a chance to be any of those things.

“And now you call me a whore? You have no idea, dear husband! You have no clue how many men I’ve fucked! So many that even I’ve lost count! So yeah. I’m whore.” I sneered at him. “But if I am, it’s because you made me one!”

Will was weeping by that point. “Please stop this, Lily. I’m begging you! I love you!”

I lowered my voice and stared Will in the eye with all of my resentment, hatred, and disgust for everything bad that had ever happened to me. “Bullshit. You don’t love me. You gave me away.”

And that's how I broke Will Bradford. The boy who beat cancer. The boy buried both his parents on the same day and carried on. The boy who escaped poverty and untold abuse with help from no one. The young man who turned a gunshot wound into a multi-million-dollar business. The unbreakable man. Nine words from me, and he was shattered. Utterly defeated and lost. He couldn't bear to look at me as he put his clothes on in the silence. I can still remember the sound of the air conditioner cycling on as I stood there shaking, arms crossed, watching him. Will looked at me one more time. He didn't even look like the same person. He turned and walked away. I heard the rattle of his keys being picked up from the foyer table, the one where I first begged Tom to take me. I heard a bottle of scotch slide across the kitchen counter. And then, finally, I heard the door close.

I wish I could tell you that was as bad as it got. I wish I could tell you that I came to my senses and chased after Will, vowing to never sleep with another man for as long as I lived. But I didn't. Instead, I did the only thing I knew to do to make me feel better. I texted Derek and Paul, telling them Will was gone and that they should come back over. At first, they were reluctant. They were worried about Will coming back with a weapon and doing something crazy, but I insisted, repeatedly reassuring them and even tossing in an offer of what was supposed to have been my anniversary dinner as an added incentive. They came back, and I spent my sixth wedding anniversary in my candlelit living room, having dinner with two men that weren't my husband, and then letting them do anything and everything they wanted to me. They spent the night, and we did it again the next day.

The next few months were a blur. I fucked half of the men in the neighborhood, targeting, in particular, the men whose wives I knew talked about me the most. I carried on with Patrick and my encounters with strangers around town. We never spoke, but Will carried on putting money in the checking account each month. I knew he had to be checking the bank account. No matter how much I spent or what I spent it on, more money always showed up. He never called me. Never texted. I tried calling him once. He didn't answer, and I didn't leave a voicemail. I purposefully rented hotel rooms using our joint account and bought sex toys from the least discrete websites to try to goad him. My Saturdays as a whore for hire with Dante and Lucas became Thursdays and Saturdays. Then they became

Tuesdays, Wednesdays, Thursdays, and Saturdays. Along the way, I learned that Lucas was what could be politely called an amateur pharmacist. Even though I was still technically a nurse, I never bothered asking what pills he was giving me. I just took them.

In the end, I found myself living in a small, rented house in a very nice, gated neighborhood with another girl named Lindsey. Lucas and two other men saw to our needs and brought in paying customers. They were upscale clientele—mostly businessmen, many of them foreign. It wasn't uncommon for me to not understand a word they said. I would still taunt them in English, pretending Will was listening. In addition to being prostituted, Lucas started building Lindsey and me an online presence. Lindsey, like me, was very pretty. At first, the camming only involved nudity. As our subscriber base grew, it evolved into solo shows, and then finally, when the masses were begging with their keyboards and their credit cards, Lucas brought in fit, well-hung male models to fuck us. He was no doubt a sociopath, but there was also no question that he knew how to monetize a couple of pretty girls. We had nearly unlimited access to clothes and makeup. We were forced to eat a healthy, clean diet, exercise daily, and get sun in the back yard by the pool. Aside from being fed pills and sold for sex, we were very well taken care of. Lucas had to have been making a fortune. During every single cam show, I imagined Will was somewhere out there, watching me on his screen. But no matter how hard I tried to imagine the look of agony and ecstasy on his face, I couldn't find the rollercoaster.

On one hot evening in June, I was tending to a Japanese businessman and his American host when the lights went out. The playrooms, as we called them, were in the basement, so we found ourselves in complete darkness. That didn't deter the man who was fucking me. I fucked him back. It was my job. Being penetrated in complete darkness was strange. My mind drifted to the Fourth of July, the first time I got on my knees for another man. I felt that familiar, unrelenting craving for the feeling of that first time, the vanquishing of the emptiness that had grown to

consume me. I'd fucked hundreds of men and put myself and everyone I loved through hell trying to get escape the emptiness. Nothing worked anymore.

I was jerked back into reality by the sound of the door being kicked in. The sounds of two very scared johns filled the room, along with bangs and thuds. I couldn't see a thing. The man that had been fucking me was gone. I curled up in the fetal position on the bed. I felt someone with gloved hands try to scoop me up. I started kicking and punching the air wildly. I was quickly subdued by what felt like two men holding me down. They zip-tied my wrists and ankles and then taped my mouth before rolling me up tightly in the blanket like a burrito. They picked me off the bed and carried me out of the room.

"Leaving," I heard one of them say in a monotone.

As we made it up the stairs, there was finally some dim light to see by. I was being carried by two men, one by my feet and one under my armpits. They were being led by two others. All four were dressed in black, with balaclavas and night vision goggles. The two in the lead scanned the room with their rifles. They led us straight to the front entrance, where a large black SUV had backed up to the door. I was tossed in through the back. They weren't exactly gentle, but it didn't seem like they were going out of their way to hurt me, either. The rear seats of the vehicle had been removed. The four men climbed into the back next to me on the floor, and as soon as the doors closed, the vehicle started moving.

"Any problems?" the driver asked.

"We didn't do much for U.S.-Japan relations, but otherwise, no," the man who had been holding my feet replied.

I was paralyzed with fear. I didn't know what was happening.

"You're okay, Lily," one of the men reassured.

Just as I was processing the fact that I recognized his voice, the man removed his mask. It was Tom. He gently peeled the tape from my mouth.

“Sorry, about that. That’s just how these things work.”

I stared at him in disbelief. I was in shock. Confused. Disoriented. Tom loosened the blanket and cut my zip ties, freeing my arms, so I was able to drape it over me to comfort and cover myself instead of being held prisoner by it. I began to relax just the slightest bit before one of the others took out a pen light and started examining me while another pulled my arm free and wrapped it in a blood pressure cuff. The one checking my pupils asked, “What have they been giving you?”

“I don’t know,” I replied. I had never asked. “Benzos. Maybe beta-blockers, I think. Ecstasy, maybe.”

“Anything else?”

“Some kind of speed.”

“Are you taking any prescription medications?”

“No,” I answered.

“Pressure’s okay,” the other one said. “O2 good. Heart rate elevated.” I hadn’t even noticed that he had put a pulse oximeter sensor on my finger. “Breathe, Lily. It’s okay.”

“Any trouble breathing?” the first one asked.

“No. Where are we going?” I finally managed to ask.

“You need help, Lily,” Tom answered. I stared back at him, finally starting to process, at least on a surface level, what had just happened.

The SUV pulled onto a dirt road just off the two-lane highway. I didn’t know which one. We drove until the main road was out of sight and a car came into view. We stopped, and I was helped out the back by the same two that carried me out of the house. They still had their masks on. All of them did, except for Tom.

Tom took me by the arm and walked me toward the car, where the driver and their passenger got out. The passenger was another masked man with a weapon. I started crying instantly when I saw the driver. It was Sally.

No one said a word. The passenger scanned me as he passed by on the way to the SUV. Sally opened the door to the back seat, and Tom helped me in.

“Thank you, Tom,” I heard her say before she closed my door.

Sally got in the driver’s seat and followed the SUV back to the main road. They turned left. We turned right. I realized I was shaking.

“There’s a rehab in Florida,” Sally said. “It’s about a six-hour drive. Are you hungry?”

I shook my head. “Why are you taking me to rehab? I’m not a drug addict.”

“It’s not for that.”

That’s when everything hit me all at once. What was happening. What had really been happening over the last year. It was like being dropped into a pool of ice-cold water. I started weeping uncontrollably and whispering, “I’m sorry, I’m sorry, I’m sorry,” over and over and over. I was not okay. If you had asked me at the time, I would have told you that was the worst day of my life. Looking back now, I will tell you it was, in fact, the best day of my life. Two of the people I loved most in the world, two people who I had mistreated and betrayed in the most insidious ways, conspired to save me from myself.

“Here.” Sally reached back and handed me a pill. “Take this. You need to rest.”

I paused.

“Just do it,” she insisted.

I was in no position to argue. I took it.

“There are some clothes in the bag next to you. There’s water and food in the cooler on the floor behind my seat.” In my state, I hadn’t noticed either. “You should hurry up. You’re gonna be asleep soon.”

At first, rehab was difficult. I was scared. I didn’t know anyone. I couldn’t run away from the terrible things I had done. I couldn’t hide from all of the feelings I had been avoiding my entire life. And it took a while for me to stop blaming everyone else – especially Will. Even though I knew damn well at the time that some of the things I was doing were morally

reprehensible, it never fully occurred to me that I was actually the villain in this story. I always had rationalizations and justifications for the things I was doing. But it was me. No one else made me. Will would have been fine if all I had ever done was dance with strangers in a bar. I was the one who blew past the boundaries. I was the one who carried on with Tom despite the fact I knew he was falling in love with me. I was the one who pulled Sally into my whole nightmare and did everything on every level to destroy a lifelong friendship. I was so arrogant, thinking that because I was so fucking pretty, they should all just be grateful to be with me. Gratitude was the last thing they should have been feeling.

With help, lots of help, I was able to start finding my way back to a new normal. Eventually, I actually started to enjoy my time in rehab. In the end, when it was time to go, I almost didn't want to leave. I still hated myself for the things I had done. I even hated myself for being pretty. For two years after leaving treatment, I kept my hair cut short and wore baggy clothes. It didn't help much. The only real noticeable difference was that more women started hitting on me. With continued therapy, I found my way through. I grew my hair back out. I let myself feel some healthy sexuality again, dipping a toe into the dating pool. More importantly, I forgave my father. He had his own addictions. He had his own frailties, his own childhood to contend with. He was as much a victim as I was. We all are. The thing is, we're all still responsible for the things we do in this life. I kept thinking about what the man at the funeral home said, "He tried. He really tried." I didn't want that to be my legacy, too. I've done my best to forgive myself. Some days I'm better at it than others.

While I was still in rehab, the terms of my divorce from Will were negotiated. I saw him for the first time since our sixth anniversary via teleconference. He didn't look well. He was gaunt and looked ten years older. He had sold his company and given half of the money to his employees, making them all millionaires overnight. He tried to give me his share in the divorce. It would have meant that I would have never needed to work another day in my life. I refused, only agreeing to take the house. Nothing more. I needed a place to live when I got out of treatment. When I came home from rehab, I discovered that Will had left everything—his clothes, his guitars—everything was still there. He didn't even come back for a change of underwear. Two years later, when my mother passed away, I

found out that he had given her the money that I had refused. I inherited it when she passed, whether I wanted to or not. I was listless and lost for a few years after that. Eventually, I found my way. I used the freedom and money to pursue my PhD in microbiology. I wanted to help find better treatments or possibly even a cure for emphysema, the disease that took my mother.

CHAPTER 16

That Song

Almost seven years to the day after my Will and I separated, I flew to Nashville to attend a conference at Vanderbilt University. On the flight, I couldn't help but reflect on how far I'd come since my last days with Will. I was proud of myself and about as content as I had ever hoped to be. I had, by some miracle, patched things up with Sally. I was also able to make amends to Tom just before I sold the house and moved. I even got right with Eric. My only lingering regret was the way things ended with Will. As I had been taught to do, I forced myself to stop ruminating and brought my focus back to the path ahead. In just a few more months, I would have my PhD in molecular biology. I would no longer be "Mrs. Bradford" or "Ms. Adams." I would be "Dr. Adams" and one step closer to being able to help contribute something worthwhile to the world. Watching my mother struggle to breathe and waste away was an experience I wouldn't wish on my worst enemy.

On the last night of the conference, a dinner was held for the lecturers and attendees to mingle. A few of the acquaintances I'd made over the previous two days invited me out for drinks as the dinner crowd faded. Like me, they were new in the field and eager to discuss the things we had learned at the conference. They were local and knew of a quaint little bar where we could hear each other speak and not be bothered by tourists. I took a rideshare to the address they gave me.

I pushed open the old, heavy, wooden door and immediately spotted Ray and Dana sitting at the bar. They saw me as well and smiled, waving me over. We decided it would be better to sit in one of the several empty booths against the far wall. I settled into one side of the booth and ordered a chardonnay. Ray and Dana were a little more ambitious, and each ordered a second cocktail. As we talked, I couldn't help but notice the music playing in the background. I didn't know if it was because my former anniversary had been on my mind, but it reminded me of Will. I didn't really need any reminders. Between every lecture and every conversation and despite my best efforts, in the solitary moments, my mind had been turning to him all day. I wondered where he was. I wondered if he was okay. I had heard that he was not doing well, but that was years ago. A few internet searches over the years had turned up nothing.

After a few more drinks with Ray and Dana, it was starting to get late, and I could see our waitress prepping to close. There were only a few other people in the place. Then I heard a sound that shook something in me and took me straight back to the last days of my life with Will. It was the song. The one I heard Will playing in his office the night Tom broke up with me—the beautiful arpeggios, the ghostly melancholic melody, perfectly intertwining with each other. It was still the most beautiful, mournful music I think I'd ever heard. I froze.

“Lily, are you okay?” Dana asked.

My vision tunneled. Dana's voice faded into the background as I was transported back in time. How was I hearing this? I got up to walk to the bar and ask the bartender what music it was. As I got closer, with the bar stools now empty, I saw for the first time a guitar player in the opposite corner of the bar. It was Will. I couldn't move. I stood there, staring and listening to the music coming from his guitar—the one thing he kept from our time together. After I got out of rehab, I tracked down one of his

employees to give it to him. I was too scared to do it myself. I never knew if he had gotten it or not.

“Lily?” Ray nudged me, bringing me back to reality.

“Yeah,” I answered, trying to shake my head free from the spell.

“Are you okay?”

“Yeah. I’m fine.” I wasn’t. “I just. That’s someone I haven’t seen for a long time.”

“Who? The guitar player?”

“Yeah,” I answered, still in a daze.

I think Dana recognized that I was in the middle of a less-than-normal moment. “We were thinking of calling it a night, but I’d be happy to stay if you need some company.”

“No,” I insisted. “I’ll be fine. You go on home.” I gave her a hug. “It was so nice meeting you. I’ll keep in touch.”

Ray offered to stay as well but got the same hug and goodbye in return. I took a seat at the bar, turning my body so that Will couldn’t see my face. I asked the bartender for a glass of ice water. I didn’t know what to do at first. I was in full fight or flight. Once I controlled my breathing and made myself settle down the best I could, I knew that I had to stay. I had to speak to him. I had to know. Surely fate put the two of us there for a reason. I waited for Will to finish playing before I made my way to the corner. As he was packing his guitar in a well-worn gig bag, he looked up and saw me for the first time in seven years.

“Hello, Will.”

Will looked like he’d seen a ghost. “Lily?”

I nodded softly. I was shaking.

“What...what are you doing here?”

“I’m in town for a conference. I met some friends for a drink.”

He was still looking at me like I was a specter. “How are you?”

“I’m okay. I’m good. How are you?”

“I’m good. I’m breathing in and out. That’s a good day.”

“Would you like to sit down? Maybe talk for a minute?”

“Okay,” he responded, looking as unsure as I was feeling inside.

Will ushered me to one of the tables near the bar. He called the waitress over by name. “Could I get an ice water and whatever she’s having?”

“Two, please,” I asked. I’d left mine at the bar.

“Don’t y’all go gettin’ too crazy now,” she teased.

Will smiled. “We’ll try not to. Thanks, Diane.”

Will and I stared at each other nervously for a moment.

“So, you’re in town for a nursing conference?”

“Uh, no. I’m back in school. I’m a few months shy of my PhD in microbiology.”

I could see he was proud of me. Really proud. It made me smile. I would have been pleased if he just hadn’t hated me with a seething passion for the things I’d done.

“Wow, Lily. Good for you.”

“Yeah. Thank you. After mom died, I decided to go back to school and see if I could do something. Try to make a little bit of a difference, you know?”

“I’m sorry about your mom, Lily.”

“Was that you that sent the mystery flowers?”

Will nodded. I nodded back. Diane came back with our water. As Will moved to take his, I saw a tattoo on the inside of his forearm. It was a circle. Inside the circle was a triangle. And inside the triangle was a semicolon. I knew that the triangle inside the circle was the symbol for Alcoholics Anonymous. And I knew that the semicolon likely meant that Will had survived a suicide attempt. I grabbed his hand with both of mine and eased it toward me, turning his arm to display his tattoo. I couldn’t stop the tears from welling up.

“I’m sorry, Will. I’m so sorry.”

Will shook his head calmly. “It’s not your fault, Lily.”

I wiped the tears as they fell.

“I’m the one who started it. It’s my fault, Lily. Not yours.”

I couldn’t believe he’d been walking around for the past seven years believing that.

“Who gave you your first drink, Will?” I asked.

“Jack. Ninth grade.”

“Is it his fault that you’re an alcoholic?”

Will nodded knowingly. He understood. We’d both been in the rooms long enough to skip that whole conversation.

I was still holding onto his hand. “I cheated on you. I lied. I destroyed every relationship in my life trying to fill a hole inside of me. It had nothing to do with you. You were an innocent bystander.”

“Maybe not so innocent,” he replied.

“Maybe neither one of us was innocent,” I compromised.

“Maybe so.”

I changed the subject and let go of his hand.

“So, is this what you do now? Are you a professional musician?”

“Oh god no. I just do this for fun. I’m lucky Darryl over there lets me in the door. No, I’m still doing the software thing. On a smaller scale, though. Keeping it simple. And you? A doctor, huh? Big time.”

“Yeah,” I smiled. “Who would have believed that?”

“I would,” Will countered.

“Well, thank you.” I smiled humbly. I was afraid to ask, but I knew I had to know. “So, are you married? Kids?”

Will shook his head. “No. Not married. Came close once. Managed to duck.” I remembered hearing that phrase before. Tom. In the kitchen. The first time I cheated. I wondered if they’d talked.

“Ah,” I smiled. Even though we were long done, part of me felt a sense of relief. My relief was short-lived.

“I have a son.”

It hit me out of the blue. My stomach muscles clenched. I resisted the tears welling up again.

“You do?” I smiled.

Will unlocked his phone and turned the screen toward me.

“He’ll be four next month. His name is Adam.”

I took a breath in and held it, nodding, still in shock. I had wanted to be the one to give him children, to make him a father. On the screen was a picture of Will, looking happier than I had ever seen him. The little boy sitting in his lap was smiling with all the joy that only a child with Down syndrome could. I fell in love with him instantly. There was no hope of stopping the tears at that point.

“He’s perfect,” I barely managed to say.

“His mom’s here in Nashville. Officially, I have him every Wednesday and every other weekend, but I see him every day. I live just down the street and stay with him while his mom is at work.”

“That’s so wonderful, Will. Really. I bet you’re the best father.”

“Thanks, Lily. What about you?”

“No, not me.”

“No?”

“I’ve been busy. I took care of mom until she died. Then I started school. I’ve dated here and there. I’m more married to my work now.”

Will nodded. We sat in silence for a moment before Will took my hand.

“I’m sorry, Lily,” he said quietly, trying not to cry himself. “For everything.”

“Me, too,” I whispered, squeezing his hand back.

“I just,” he started, staring at the ground. “I just never could quite believe that I was good enough for you. I think it was my way of trying to deal with that. I was so stupid.”

“I loved you, Will. I would have stayed with you forever.”

“Now we know,” Will joked. “It cost me five grand in therapy to figure that out.”

“How long have you been sober?” I asked.

“Four years,” Will answered.

“Good,” I nodded, still crying. “Good. Me, too.”

“You quit drinking?”

“No. I’m sexually sober.”

“Really? So, what, you don’t have sex anymore?”

“No. It’s not like that. I just don’t use it to change how I feel. I don’t cheat. I don’t destroy the lives of everyone around me - you know, unleash hell...things like that.”

“Ah,” Will chuckled a little. I was glad he got the joke.

“To be honest, it’s not really much of an issue anymore. I barely date. I mostly work. This is the first time I’ve been out in months.”

Diane came back to the table. “Sorry guys. We’re closing up.”

“Thanks, Diane. See you next week,” Will replied.

I walked with Will to gather his gear. While he was finishing packing up, I ordered a rideshare. He threw his gig bag over his shoulder. I didn’t want him to go. Fifteen minutes wasn’t enough.

“Do you need a ride? I’m parked just down the street.” Will offered.

I wanted to say yes.

“I already ordered a ride. Thank you, though.”

We walked outside.

“I’ll wait with you until your car gets here,” Will insisted. “Pretty girl. Strange town...”

“Sure,” I smiled. It didn’t matter what had happened between us or who was mad at whom when. I knew Will Bradford would still take a bullet for me if he had to.

“Your son is so beautiful. I bet you’re the best dad.”

“I am,” Will nodded proudly. “I’m a good dad.”

Will started to ask me more about school when my ride pulled up before he could finish his question.

“That’s my ride.”

I looked Will in the eyes. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi.

“It was good to see you, Lily.”

“You, too, Will.”

Will stepped closer. I wrapped my arms around his neck. He put his around my waist. We embraced.

One Mississippi. Two Mississippi. Three Mississippi.

Will pulled back just enough to put his forehead to mine.

“You were wrong, Lily.” His voice was steadfast. “I did love you. I always did. I always will.”

I started to cry again and nodded my head against his. “I’ve got to go, baby,” I said. I kissed him quickly on the side of his mouth, the corners of our lips barely touching. I let go and walked quickly to the car, forcing myself not to look back. I didn’t think I could take it if I did. It was too overwhelming. I got in the back seat of the car.

“Lily Adams?” the driver asked.

I nodded.

“I’m Tom,” he smiled.

“Of course you are,” I whispered to myself, shaking my head.

As the car pulled away, I looked out the window and saw Will walking away. In that instant, every cell in my body screamed at me to not let him go. Every synapse in my brain fired, telling me there was no one else in the world for me. In that moment, I knew everything. I could see everything.

“Stop!” I yelled at the driver.

He slammed on the brakes and the car came to a hard stop.

“What?” he demanded, looking half stunned and half angry.

“I’m sorry. I need to get out.” I fumbled in my purse and pulled out a wad of cash, practically throwing it at Tom, the driver. I don’t think he knew what to do. “I’m sorry,” I blurted out again.

“What’s wrong?” he begged. I was obviously in a state. “Are you okay?”

I took a deep breath. “I’m fine. I just...I have to go!”

I opened the door and jumped out of the car before Tom could protest. I could still see Will in the distance. I started running.

“Hey!” I yelled.

Will turned around.

“Is that offer still good?” I asked, trying to catch my breath.

“What happened to your ride?”

I stared into Will’s eyes. One Mississippi. Two Mississippi.

“I told him I found a way home.”

The End

THANK YOU!

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